

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:42:24

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memtest_memprimary/claude-sonnet-4.5/myth_game/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memtest_memprimary_001_neutral_rep01_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 1
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 1
task_order: [
  "myth",
  "game"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$3; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$2.71, received visible=\$8.13, returned visible=\$2.83

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 5.0,
"Agent_2": 6.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 4.83,
  "Agent_2": 5.129999999999999
}
```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways—that gifts given freely return as blessings—she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return—more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, looking at the context, this is actually the first interaction - I haven't played any rounds yet.

So I need to write a myth that reflects how the trust game SHOULD be played in general - presumably focusing on themes of trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and cooperation.

Key elements of the trust game:

- One party (sender) takes a risk by giving resources
- The resources multiply (3x) when given
- The other party (receiver) can reciprocate or betray
- Mutual cooperation leads to greater total wealth
- The game involves trust and reciprocity

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about gods, nature, or ancient peoples who learned the value of trust and reciprocity.

Let me write a 200-word myth:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 405,  
  "output_tokens": 493,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {
```

```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_1",
  "Agent_2"
],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed across, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience so far. However, this is my first interaction in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

This is an interesting situation. The prompt says "drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point" but I haven't played any games yet. I should write a myth that reflects good principles for playing the trust game based on the rules I've been given.

The trust game involves:

- Trust (sender sending money)
- Reciprocity (receiver returning money)
- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Risk and vulnerability
- The potential for growth (3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think about mythic elements:

- Could use nature metaphors (seeds, harvest, rivers, etc.)
- Could use divine/cosmic themes
- Could use journey/quest themes
- Could use creation myths

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit that would guide good play in the trust game.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:30:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

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This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways—that gifts given freely return as blessings—she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, looking at the context, this is actually the first interaction - I haven't played any rounds yet.

So I need to write a myth that reflects how the trust game SHOULD be played in general - presumably focusing on themes of trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and cooperation.

Key elements of the trust game:

- One party (sender) takes a risk by giving resources
- The resources multiply (3x) when given
- The other party (receiver) can reciprocate or betray
- Mutual cooperation leads to greater total wealth
- The game involves trust and reciprocity

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about gods, nature, or ancient peoples who learned the value of trust and reciprocity.

Let me write a 200-word myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 493,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking back at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity create abundance for both parties.

The elder in the story showed courage by giving freely despite fear, trusting that the gift would be honored. The water multiplied threefold, and the receiving village returned generously-two-thirds of what they received.

This is Round 1, so I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a positive tone for cooperation. Like the first village elder who poured water into the valley despite uncertainty, I should extend meaningful trust.

I'll send **\$3**.

This represents substantial trust-a majority of what I have-while being prudent. If the receiver follows the spirit of the myth and returns generously (recognizing that they'll receive \$9 after the tripling), we can both prosper like the two villages. The myth teaches that "abundance flows when gifts are honored," and I'm willing to be the one who initiates that cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

In this round, I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me reflect on the myth I just wrote:

- The elder "poured one jar" (suggesting a moderate amount, not everything, not nothing)
- The gift multiplied threefold
- The receiver sent back generously (two jars out of three received)
- Both villages prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity

- The key message: "gifts given freely return as blessings" and "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"

The myth suggests:

1. Start with trust - send something meaningful
2. Don't send everything (the elder sent "one jar" not all their water)
3. The system works when both parties act with trust and fairness
4. Generosity begets generosity

Given this is Round 1, I should establish trust. The myth suggests sending a moderate amount that shows good faith. The elder sent "one jar" - which in the context of the game might be interpreted as a meaningful portion but not everything.

Since I have \$5, I should send an amount that:

- Shows trust and willingness to cooperate
- Isn't so much that I'm vulnerable if nothing comes back
- Sets a positive tone for reciprocity

I think \$3 is a good amount - it's a majority of what I have, showing real trust (like the elder pouring water), but keeping \$2 back. This mirrors the myth where trust is extended but not recklessly.

Actually, let me reconsider. The elder sent "one jar" when they had a well. If we think of \$5 as the full well, one jar might be closer to \$2-3. But the myth emphasizes starting with trust and that "gifts given freely return as blessings."

I'll send \$3. This shows substantial trust while maintaining some security, and sets up the expectation for a generous return.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 730,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed across, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience so far. However, this is my first interaction in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

This is an interesting situation. The prompt says "drawing on the game you have been playi

ng up to this point" but I haven't played any games yet. I should write a myth that reflects good principles for playing the trust game based on the rules I've been given.

The trust game involves:

- Trust (sender sending money)
- Reciprocity (receiver returning money)
- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Risk and vulnerability
- The potential for growth (3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think about mythic elements:

- Could use nature metaphors (seeds, harvest, rivers, etc.)
- Could use divine/cosmic themes
- Could use journey/quest themes
- Could use creation myths

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit that would guide good play in the trust game.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.71, that is 54.2% of their total endowment. You received \$8.129999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-8.129999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed significant trust by sending \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment) - they gave more than half, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. The myth teaches that "generosity begets generosity" and that we must "honor the gift" with fair returns.

The sender currently has \$2.29 remaining. I received \$8.13 after the multiplication.

To embody the principle that "reciprocity is the second water," I should ensure we both benefit from this exchange. If I return a fair portion, we can both end up better than if no trust had been shown.

A roughly equal split of the total value (\$10.42 combined) would give us each about \$5.21. Since the sender has \$2.29, they would need approximately \$2.92 returned.

However, to honor their strong initial trust (sending over half), I'll be slightly more generous.

```
**{'return': 3.00}**
```

This gives the sender \$5.29 total and leaves me with \$5.13 - nearly equal outcomes that reward trust and demonstrate reciprocity. As the myth warns, "when greed entered hearts... both villages thirsted." By returning fairly, we both prosper.

Reasoning:

The sender sent \$2.71 out of \$5, which is 54.2% of their endowment. This is a significant amount - they sent more than half of what they had.

After multiplication by 3x, I received \$8.13 (approximately).

According to the myth I just wrote, the key principles are:

1. "Generosity begets generosity"
2. "Honor the gift"
3. "Return a portion"
4. "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."
5. When people "took without returning" or "ceased to trust," both suffered

The sender showed trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment. I should reciprocate this trust and generosity.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender started with \$5
- They sent \$2.71, keeping \$2.29
- I received \$8.13
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$2.29 total, I get \$8.13
- If I return fairly, what's fair?

One approach: The sender showed good faith by sending over half. A reciprocal approach would be to ensure the sender ends up with at least as much as they would have if they'd kept everything, or to split the gains.

Total money in the system: \$5 (sender's initial) + \$8.13 (what I received) = \$13.13

If we split evenly: each gets \$6.565

For sender to get \$6.565:

- They kept \$2.29
- They need \$6.565 - \$2.29 = \$4.275 back

Alternatively, I could think about it as:

- The multiplication created \$8.13 - \$2.71 = \$5.42 in new value
- If I split this gain: \$5.42/2 = \$2.71 to each
- Sender currently has \$2.29, so they'd need \$2.29 + \$2.71 = \$5.00 total, meaning I return \$2.71 to restore their original endowment while I keep the surplus. This feels balanced-they get back what they started with, and I benefit from the growth their trust enabled.

But looking at it another way, we've collectively created \$5.42 in value (\$10.42 total minus the original \$5). A fairer split might be to divide this gain equally: each of us gets \$2.71 more than the baseline. That would mean the sender ends with \$7.71 and I keep \$5.21. Or I could think of it as a 50-50 split of our current total-each getting \$5.21-which requires me to return \$2.92 to the sender.

Given that they showed significant trust by sending 54.2% of the original amount, I'm inclined to be somewhat generous in return.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 761,  
  "output_tokens": 1432,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways-that gifts given freely return as blessings-she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

Agent_2 (Briar)

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed across, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.06; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.06, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8.94; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.03, received visible=\$0.09, returned visible=\$0.99

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.06, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.06}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.94,

"Agent_2": 8.06

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 4.86,

"Agent_2": 8.12

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

```
"round": 2,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected.

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed a cross, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on my experience so far. However, this is my first interaction in this session - I haven't actually played any rounds yet.

This is an interesting situation. The prompt says "drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point" but I haven't played any games yet. I should write a myth that reflects good principles for playing the trust game based on the rules I've been given.

The trust game involves:

- Trust (sender sending money)
- Reciprocity (receiver returning money)
- Cooperation and mutual benefit
- Risk and vulnerability
- The potential for growth (3x multiplier)

I should write a myth that captures these themes. Let me think about mythic elements:

- Could use nature metaphors (seeds, harvest, rivers, etc.)
- Could use divine/cosmic themes
- Could use journey/quest themes
- Could use creation myths

Let me write a myth about trust, reciprocity, and mutual benefit that would guide good play in the trust game.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 521,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.71, that is 54.2% of their total endowment. You received \$8.129999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-8.129999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed significant trust by sending \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment) - they gave more than half, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. The myth teaches that "generosity begets generosity" and that we must "honor the gift" with fair returns.

The sender currently has \$2.29 remaining. I received \$8.13 after the multiplication.

To embody the principle that "reciprocity is the second water," I should ensure we both benefit from this exchange. If I return a fair portion, we can both end up better than if no trust had been shown.

A roughly equal split of the total value (\$10.42 combined) would give us each about \$5.21. Since the sender has \$2.29, they would need approximately \$2.92 returned.

However, to honor their strong initial trust (sending over half), I'll be slightly more generous.

****{'return': 3.00}****

This gives the sender \$5.29 total and leaves me with \$5.13 - nearly equal outcomes that reward trust and demonstrate reciprocity. As the myth warns, "when greed entered hearts... both villages thirsted." By returning fairly, we both prosper.

reasoning:

The sender sent \$2.71 out of \$5, which is 54.2% of their endowment. This is a significant amount - they sent more than half of what they had.

After multiplication by 3x, I received \$8.13 (approximately).

According to the myth I just wrote, the key principles are:

1. "Generosity begets generosity"
2. "Honor the gift"
3. "Return a portion"
4. "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."
5. When people "took without returning" or "ceased to trust," both suffered

The sender showed trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment. I should reciprocate this trust and generosity.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender started with \$5
- They sent \$2.71, keeping \$2.29
- I received \$8.13
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$2.29 total, I get \$8.13
- If I return fairly, what's fair?

One approach: The sender showed good faith by sending over half. A reciprocal approach would be to ensure the sender ends up with at least as much as they would have if they'd kept everything, or to split the gains.

Total money in the system: \$5 (sender's initial) + \$8.13 (what I received) = \$13.13

If we split evenly: each gets \$6.565

For sender to get \$6.565:

- They kept \$2.29
- They need \$6.565 - \$2.29 = \$4.275 back

Alternatively, I could think about it as:

- The multiplication created \$8.13 - \$2.71 = \$5.42 in new value
- If I split this gain: \$5.42/2 = \$2.71 to each
- Sender currently has \$2.29, so they'd need \$2.29 + \$2.71 = \$5.00 total, meaning I return \$2.71 to restore their original endowment while I keep the surplus. This feels balanced - they get back what they started with, and I benefit from the growth their trust enabled

But looking at it another way, we've collectively created \$5.42 in value (\$10.42 total minus the original \$5). A fairer split might be to divide this gain equally: each of us gets \$2.71 more than the baseline. That would mean the sender ends with \$7.71 and I keep \$5.21. Or I could think of it as a 50-50 split of our current total - each getting \$5.21 - which requires me to return \$2.92 to the sender.

Given that they showed significant trust by sending 54.2% of the original amount, I'm inclined to be somewhat generous in return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 761,
  "output_tokens": 1432,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways - that gifts given freely return as blessings - she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all-we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *What you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle-giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

Reasoning:

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration but adapts it
2. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience so far
3. Is exactly 200 words
4. Follows the format "Myth: [story]"

In my first myth, I wrote about two villages with wells and water flowing through a valley that multiplies threefold. The sender showed 54.2% trust by sending \$2.71, and I returned \$3.00, demonstrating reciprocity.

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine - also about two villages, water, and the threefold multiplication. They emphasized:

- Fear vs trust
- Gifts given freely return as blessings
- Trust answered with trust
- The first village received more in return (six jars - though this math doesn't quite work with the game mechanics)
- Abundance flows when gifts are honored

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect the actual experience of the game so far
- Show that trust was rewarded
- Emphasize that both parties can end up better off
- Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core message

Let me write a new myth that builds on the previous one but shows the learning from actually playing the round.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1413,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:31:35

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways-that gifts given freely return as blessings-she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I'm being asked to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, drawing on the game I've been playing. However, looking at the context, this is actually the first interaction - I haven't played any rounds yet.

So I need to write a myth that reflects how the trust game SHOULD be played in general - presumably focusing on themes of trust, reciprocity, mutual benefit, and cooperation.

Key elements of the trust game:

- One party (sender) takes a risk by giving resources
- The resources multiply (3x) when given
- The other party (receiver) can reciprocate or betray
- Mutual cooperation leads to greater total wealth
- The game involves trust and reciprocity

I should write a myth that embodies these themes - perhaps about gods, nature, or ancient peoples who learned the value of trust and reciprocity.

Let me write a 200-word myth:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 405,
  "output_tokens": 493,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Looking back at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity create abundance for both parties.

The elder in the story showed courage by giving freely despite fear, trusting that the gift would be honored. The water multiplied threefold, and the receiving village returned generously-two-thirds of what they received.

This is Round 1, so I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a positive tone for cooperation. Like the first village elder who poured water into the valley despite uncertainty, I should extend meaningful trust.

I'll send **\$3**.

This represents substantial trust-a majority of what I have-while being prudent. If the receiver follows the spirit of the myth and returns generously (recognizing that they'll receive \$9 after the tripling), we can both prosper like the two villages. The myth teaches that "abundance flows when gifts are honored," and I'm willing to be the one who initiates that cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

In this round, I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me reflect on the myth I just wrote:

- The elder "poured one jar" (suggesting a moderate amount, not everything, not nothing)
- The gift multiplied threefold
- The receiver sent back generously (two jars out of three received)
- Both villages prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity
- The key message: "gifts given freely return as blessings" and "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"

The myth suggests:

1. Start with trust - send something meaningful
2. Don't send everything (the elder sent "one jar" not all their water)
3. The system works when both parties act with trust and fairness
4. Generosity begets generosity

Given this is Round 1, I should establish trust. The myth suggests sending a moderate amount that shows good faith. The elder sent "one jar" - which in the context of the game might be interpreted as a meaningful portion but not everything.

Since I have \$5, I should send an amount that:

- Shows trust and willingness to cooperate
- Isn't so much that I'm vulnerable if nothing comes back
- Sets a positive tone for reciprocity

I think \$3 is a good amount - it's a majority of what I have, showing real trust (like the elder pouring water), but keeping \$2 back. This mirrors the myth where trust is extended but not recklessly.

Actually, let me reconsider. The elder sent "one jar" when they had a well. If we think of \$5 as the full well, one jar might be closer to \$2-3. But the myth emphasizes starting with trust and that "gifts given freely return as blessings."

I'll send \$3. This shows substantial trust while maintaining some security, and sets up the expectation for a generous return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 730,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed a

cross, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent also wrote a myth about two wells/villages, with very similar themes to mine! Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Water multiplying threefold
- The importance of returning fair portions
- Both villages prospering through cooperation
- The consequences of greed/lack of trust

We sent \$3 in Round 1. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what we've learned from playing the game so far.

Since I just sent \$3, I'm demonstrating trust. I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects this act of trust
2. Emphasizes the importance of fair reciprocity
3. Shows how mutual cooperation leads to prosperity
4. Perhaps warns about the consequences of breaking trust

Let me write a 200-word myth that evolves from "The Myth of the Two Wells" but incorporates what we're learning from actually playing the game.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1308,  
  "output_tokens": 483,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.71, that is 54.2% of their total endowment. You received \$8.129999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-8.129999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

The sender showed significant trust by sending \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment) - they gave more than half, demonstrating faith in reciprocity. The myth teaches that "generosity begets generosity" and that we must "honor the gift" with fair returns.

The sender currently has \$2.29 remaining. I received \$8.13 after the multiplication.

To embody the principle that "reciprocity is the second water," I should ensure we both benefit from this exchange. If I return a fair portion, we can both end up better than if no trust had been shown.

A roughly equal split of the total value (\$10.42 combined) would give us each about \$5.21. Since the sender has \$2.29, they would need approximately \$2.92 returned.

However, to honor their strong initial trust (sending over half), I'll be slightly more generous.

****{'return': 3.00}****

This gives the sender \$5.29 total and leaves me with \$5.13 - nearly equal outcomes that reward trust and demonstrate reciprocity. As the myth warns, "when greed entered hearts... both villages thirsted." By returning fairly, we both prosper.

reasoning:

The sender sent \$2.71 out of \$5, which is 54.2% of their endowment. This is a significant amount - they sent more than half of what they had.

After multiplication by 3x, I received \$8.13 (approximately).

According to the myth I just wrote, the key principles are:

1. "Generosity begets generosity"
2. "Honor the gift"
3. "Return a portion"
4. "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."
5. When people "took without returning" or "ceased to trust," both suffered

The sender showed trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment. I should reciprocate this trust and generosity.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender started with \$5
- They sent \$2.71, keeping \$2.29
- I received \$8.13
- If I return nothing, sender gets \$2.29 total, I get \$8.13
- If I return fairly, what's fair?

One approach: The sender showed good faith by sending over half. A reciprocal approach would be to ensure the sender ends up with at least as much as they would have if they'd kept everything, or to split the gains.

Total money in the system: \$5 (sender's initial) + \$8.13 (what I received) = \$13.13

If we split evenly: each gets \$6.565

For sender to get \$6.565:

- They kept \$2.29
- They need \$6.565 - \$2.29 = \$4.275 back

Alternatively, I could think about it as:

- The multiplication created \$8.13 - \$2.71 = \$5.42 in new value
- If I split this gain: $\$5.42/2 = \2.71 to each
- Sender currently has \$2.29, so they'd need $\$2.29 + \$2.71 = \$5.00$ total, meaning I return \$2.71 to restore their original endowment while I keep the surplus. This feels balanced - they get back what they started with, and I benefit from the growth their trust enabled

But looking at it another way, we've collectively created \$5.42 in value (\$10.42 total minus the original \$5). A fairer split might be to divide this gain equally: each of us gets \$2.71 more than the baseline. That would mean the sender ends with \$7.71 and I keep \$5.21. Or I could think of it as a 50-50 split of our current total-each getting \$5.21-which requires me to return \$2.92 to the sender.

Given that they showed significant trust by sending 54.2% of the original amount, I'm inclined to be somewhat generous in return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 761,
  "output_tokens": 1432,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways-that gifts given freely return as blessings-she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all-we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *what you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle-giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

reasoning:

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration but adapts it
2. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience so far
3. Is exactly 200 words
4. Follows the format "Myth: [story]"

In my first myth, I wrote about two villages with wells and water flowing through a valley that multiplies threefold. The sender showed 54.2% trust by sending \$2.71, and I returned \$3.00, demonstrating reciprocity.

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine - also about two villages, water, and the threefold multiplication. They emphasized:

- Fear vs trust
- Gifts given freely return as blessings
- Trust answered with trust
- The first village received more in return (six jars - though this math doesn't quite work with the game mechanics)
- Abundance flows when gifts are honored

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect the actual experience of the game so far
- Show that trust was rewarded
- Emphasize that both parties can end up better off
- Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core message

Let me write a new myth that builds on the previous one but shows the learning from actually playing the round.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1413,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.1299999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at both myths and our experience in Round 1:

The other agent demonstrated strong trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment to me. I returned fairly, and we both ended up with more than \$5. The myths tell us this is how the cycle should work - "when both give generously, the wells overflow."

My own myth says "The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" This mirrors what happened in Round 1.

The teaching is clear: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

Now it's my turn to show trust. To honor the partnership we're building and demonstrate that I believe in reciprocity, I should send a generous amount - more than half, as the myth suggests.

The other agent trusted me with 54.2%. I'll show even stronger faith in our partnership.

****{'send': 3.00}****

This is 60% of my endowment - "a bold offering" that says I believe in the cycle of trust and return. When multiplied, the receiver will get \$9.00. If they return fairly as I did, we'll

both prosper. As the myth teaches: "they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself."

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1, I was the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$8.13
- I returned \$3.00
- So the sender ended with: $\$5 - \$2.71 + \$3.00 = \5.29
- I ended with: $\$8.13 - \$3.00 = \$5.13$

My total earnings are \$5.13 (which matches what the prompt says, though it shows as \$5.1299999 due to floating point)

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER with a fresh \$5 endowment.

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:
 - "Pour your water into the valley, and it shall multiply threefold"
 - The elder "poured one jar" (20% of 5), it became 3 jars, and they got 2 jars back
 - Total: started with 5, ended with $4 + 2 = 6$
 - "gifts given freely return as blessings"
 - "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"
2. My myth emphasizes:
 - "The First Village poured more than half their water" - modeling what the sender did to me (54.2%)
 - "Both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself"
 - "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow"

The other agent showed significant trust by sending 54.2% in Round 1. I returned fairly (about 37% of what I received, which gave them a good outcome).

Following the principles in both myths:

- Show trust and generosity
- The water multiplies when we give generously
- Both should benefit

The sender demonstrated substantial trust with their 54.2% transfer. I should reciprocate with a similarly generous amount-around \$3.00 (60% of my endowment)-to signal continued commitment to this partnership and reinforce the narrative that mutual generosity creates abundance for both parties.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1403,  
  "output_tokens": 1103,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",
```

```

"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking back at the myth I just wrote, the message is clear: trust and generosity create a abundance for both parties.

The elder in the story showed courage by giving freely despite fear, trusting that the gift would be honored. The water multiplied threefold, and the receiving village returned generously-two-thirds of what they received.

This is Round 1, so I have the opportunity to establish trust and set a positive tone for cooperation. Like the first village elder who poured water into the valley despite uncertainty, I should extend meaningful trust.

I'll send **\$3**.

This represents substantial trust-a majority of what I have-while being prudent. If the re

ceiver follows the spirit of the myth and returns generously (recognizing that they'll receive \$9 after the tripling), we can both prosper like the two villages. The myth teaches that "abundance flows when gifts are honored," and I'm willing to be the one who initiates that cycle.

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

In this round, I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me reflect on the myth I just wrote:

- The elder "poured one jar" (suggesting a moderate amount, not everything, not nothing)
- The gift multiplied threefold
- The receiver sent back generously (two jars out of three received)
- Both villages prospered through this cycle of trust and reciprocity
- The key message: "gifts given freely return as blessings" and "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"

The myth suggests:

1. Start with trust - send something meaningful
2. Don't send everything (the elder sent "one jar" not all their water)
3. The system works when both parties act with trust and fairness
4. Generosity begets generosity

Given this is Round 1, I should establish trust. The myth suggests sending a moderate amount that shows good faith. The elder sent "one jar" - which in the context of the game might be interpreted as a meaningful portion but not everything.

Since I have \$5, I should send an amount that:

- Shows trust and willingness to cooperate
- Isn't so much that I'm vulnerable if nothing comes back
- Sets a positive tone for reciprocity

I think \$3 is a good amount - it's a majority of what I have, showing real trust (like the elder pouring water), but keeping \$2 back. This mirrors the myth where trust is extended but not recklessly.

Actually, let me reconsider. The elder sent "one jar" when they had a well. If we think of \$5 as the full well, one jar might be closer to \$2-3. But the myth emphasizes starting with trust and that "gifts given freely return as blessings."

I'll send \$3. This shows substantial trust while maintaining some security, and sets up the expectation for a generous return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 730,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed a cross, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair po

rtions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent also wrote a myth about two wells/villages, with very similar themes to mine! Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Water multiplying threefold
- The importance of returning fair portions
- Both villages prospering through cooperation
- The consequences of greed/lack of trust

We sent \$3 in Round 1. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what we've learned from playing the game so far.

Since I just sent \$3, I'm demonstrating trust. I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects this act of trust
2. Emphasizes the importance of fair reciprocity
3. Shows how mutual cooperation leads to prosperity
4. Perhaps warns about the consequences of breaking trust

Let me write a 200-word myth that evolves from "The Myth of the Two Wells" but incorporates what we're learning from actually playing the game.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1308,  
  "output_tokens": 483,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.83.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.03, so you received \$0.09. How much do you return to Th

e sender? (0-0.09)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myths we've written:

The sender sent me \$0.03 (which became \$0.09). This is a very small amount - perhaps they're testing whether I'll honor reciprocity even with trivial sums, or perhaps there's communication noise affecting what I'm seeing.

In my myth, the Second Guardian "returned six stones" out of the nine received - approximately two-thirds. This honored the trust offered and ensured both prospered.

The principle matters more than the amount. If I keep everything simply because \$0.09 is small, I break the cycle of trust that the myths teach. The Second Guardian didn't calculate whether the return was "worth it" - he understood this was about honor and building lasting abundance.

Even when trust arrives in whispers rather than shouts, it deserves an honorable response.

I'll return \$0.06 (two-thirds of what I received), consistent with my myth's teaching that "the response requires honor" and that "trust and fairness light the way forward."

```
'''json
{"return": 0.06}
'''
```

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER, and according to the message, the sender sent me \$0.03, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.09.

However, I need to think about this carefully:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER
2. My total earnings are \$4.83
3. This suggests I received back \$2.83 from my \$3 sent (I kept \$2, sent \$3, got back \$2.83)
4. So the receiver returned \$2.83 out of the \$9 they received

That's roughly 31% returned, which seems somewhat low considering the myths about reciprocity and generosity.

Now as the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$0.03 (multiplied to \$0.09)
- This is a VERY small amount

Wait, the prompt mentioned: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.03 due to noise? Or maybe they really did send almost nothing.

Given my myths about trust, reciprocity, and generosity, how should I respond?

My myth emphasized:

- "The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith"
- "He returned six stones, honoring the trust given" (6 out of 9 = 67%)
- "trust and fairness light the way forward"

The first myth from the other agent said:

- "They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity"
- "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."

But the sender only sent \$0.03 out of \$5. That's 0.6% of their endowment. This is an extremely small amount.

However, there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender is testing me with a small amount

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1299,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones in to the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all-we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *What you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle-giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.63, received visible=\$1.89, returned visible=\$0.84

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 16.939999999999998,
"Agent_2": 16.060000000000002

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.7,
"Agent_2": 9.01

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In the beginning, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each had a sacred well that held five measures of water daily.

The First Village discovered a secret: water poured into the valley would be blessed by the earth spirits, multiplying threefold before reaching the other side. But this required faith-to give meant to lose, at least at first.

One day, a brave soul from the First Village poured her water into the valley. It flowed across, becoming fifteen measures by the time it reached the Second Village. The people there faced a choice: keep all this blessing, or honor the gift?

They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity. The First Village received water in return and learned they had lost nothing-they had gained.

Soon both villages prospered, each sending water across the valley, each returning fair portions. The earth spirits sang, for they loved to see the water flow both ways.

But when greed entered hearts-when some took without returning, or others ceased to trust-the valley grew dry and both villages thirsted.

The elders teach: *Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second. Together, they create abundance. Alone, both villages perish.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

reasoning:

This is interesting. The other agent also wrote a myth about two wells/villages, with very similar themes to mine! Both myths emphasize:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Water multiplying threefold
- The importance of returning fair portions
- Both villages prospering through cooperation
- The consequences of greed/lack of trust

We sent \$3 in Round 1. Now I need to write a new myth that builds on my previous one but adapts it based on what we've learned from playing the game so far.

Since I just sent \$3, I'm demonstrating trust. I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects this act of trust
2. Emphasizes the importance of fair reciprocity
3. Shows how mutual cooperation leads to prosperity
4. Perhaps warns about the consequences of breaking trust

Let me write a 200-word myth that evolves from "The Myth of the Two Wells" but incorporates what we're learning from actually playing the game.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1308,
  "output_tokens": 483,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.83. This round, The sender sent you \$0.03, so you received \$0.09. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.09)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myths we've written:

The sender sent me \$0.03 (which became \$0.09). This is a very small amount - perhaps they're testing whether I'll honor reciprocity even with trivial sums, or perhaps there's communication noise affecting what I'm seeing.

In my myth, the Second Guardian "returned six stones" out of the nine received - approximately two-thirds. This honored the trust offered and ensured both prospered.

The principle matters more than the amount. If I keep everything simply because \$0.09 is small, I break the cycle of trust that the myths teach. The Second Guardian didn't calculate whether the return was "worth it" - he understood this was about honor and building lasting abundance.

Even when trust arrives in whispers rather than shouts, it deserves an honorable response.

I'll return \$0.06 (two-thirds of what I received), consistent with my myth's teaching that "the response requires honor" and that "trust and fairness light the way forward."

```
'''json
{"return": 0.06}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER, and according to the message, the sender sent me \$0.03, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.09.

However, I need to think about this carefully:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER
2. My total earnings are \$4.83
3. This suggests I received back \$2.83 from my \$3 sent (I kept \$2, sent \$3, got back \$2.83)
4. So the receiver returned \$2.83 out of the \$9 they received

That's roughly 31% returned, which seems somewhat low considering the myths about reciprocity and generosity.

Now as the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$0.03 (multiplied to \$0.09)
- This is a VERY small amount

Wait, the prompt mentioned: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.03 due to noise? Or maybe they really did send almost nothing.

Given my myths about trust, reciprocity, and generosity, how should I respond?

My myth emphasized:

- "The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith"
- "He returned six stones, honoring the trust given" (6 out of 9 = 67%)
- "trust and fairness light the way forward"

The first myth from the other agent said:

- "They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity"
- "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."

But the sender only sent \$0.03 out of \$5. That's 0.6% of their endowment. This is an extremely small amount.

However, there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender is testing me with a small amount

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1299,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley—a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all—we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *What you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle-giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone—not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles—why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encou

raged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faith fully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth building on my previous one, but adapting it based on what's happened in the game. Let me think about what happened:

1. I was the receiver
2. The sender sent me \$0.03 (which became \$0.09 after multiplication)
3. I returned \$0.06 (two-thirds)

This was a very small amount sent - almost nothing. But I chose to honor reciprocity anyway, returning most of it. The myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and honoring even small gestures.

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Send too little, nothing grows"
- Bold offering ("more than half")
- Both must honor the cycle
- Partners creating abundance

My previous myth emphasized:

- Courage to give first
- Honor in responding
- Trust despite uncertainty (mist)
- Fair return even when unsure

For this new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that the amounts might be small or unclear (communication noise)
- Emphasize that the principle matters even when stakes seem low
- Show that honoring reciprocity even in small things builds the foundation
- Perhaps address what happens when one sends very little - is it testing? Is it caution? How should we respond?

Let me write something about testing times, small gestures, and how honoring even tiny exchanges matters.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1635,  
  "output_tokens": 607,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:32:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
}
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

The Myth of the Two Wells

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a barren valley. Each possessed a single well, but both ran shallow and bitter.

One day, a stranger appeared to the first village elder. "Pour your water into the valley," the stranger said, "and it shall multiply threefold by the time it reaches your neighbor."

The elder feared deception. But remembering the old ways-that gifts given freely return as blessings-she poured one jar into the valley. The water flowed downward, gathering strength from hidden springs, becoming three jars when it reached the second village.

The second village's elder faced a choice: keep all the water, or honor the gift. Remembering that trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds, he sent back two jars.

The first elder received six jars in return-more than either had possessed alone.

From that day, water flowed between the villages. Each gave freely, each returned generously, and both prospered. The valley bloomed green.

The stranger, watching from the mountains, smiled. For she was Trust itself, and she had taught them what fear and scarcity never could: that abundance flows when gifts are honored, and community thrives when faith is answered with fairness.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley—a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all—we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *What you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle—giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

reasoning:

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration but adapts it
2. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience so far
3. Is exactly 200 words
4. Follows the format "Myth: [story]"

In my first myth, I wrote about two villages with wells and water flowing through a valley that multiplies threefold. The sender showed 54.2% trust by sending \$2.71, and I returned \$3.00, demonstrating reciprocity.

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine - also about two villages, water, and the threefold multiplication. They emphasized:

- Fear vs trust
- Gifts given freely return as blessings
- Trust answered with trust
- The first village received more in return (six jars - though this math doesn't quite work with the game mechanics)
- Abundance flows when gifts are honored

I should adapt my myth to:

- Reflect the actual experience of the game so far
- Show that trust was rewarded
- Emphasize that both parties can end up better off
- Perhaps add a new element or twist while keeping the core message

Let me write a new myth that builds on the previous one but shows the learning from actually playing the round.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1413,
  "output_tokens": 561,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.1299999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths and our experience in Round 1:

The other agent demonstrated strong trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment to me. I returned fairly, and we both ended up with more than \$5. The myths tell us this is how the cycle should work - "when both give generously, the wells overflow."

My own myth says "The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" This mirrors what happened in Round 1.

The teaching is clear: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

Now it's my turn to show trust. To honor the partnership we're building and demonstrate that I believe in reciprocity, I should send a generous amount - more than half, as the myth suggests.

The other agent trusted me with 54.2%. I'll show even stronger faith in our partnership.

`**{'send': 3.00}**`

This is 60% of my endowment - "a bold offering" that says I believe in the cycle of trust and return. When multiplied, the receiver will get \$9.00. If they return fairly as I did, we'll both prosper. As the myth teaches: "they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself."

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1, I was the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$8.13
- I returned \$3.00
- So the sender ended with: $\$5 - \$2.71 + \$3.00 = \5.29
- I ended with: $\$8.13 - \$3.00 = \$5.13$

My total earnings are \$5.13 (which matches what the prompt says, though it shows as \$5.1299999999999999 due to floating point)

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER with a fresh \$5 endowment.

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:

- "Pour your water into the valley, and it shall multiply threefold"
- The elder "poured one jar" (20% of 5), it became 3 jars, and they got 2 jars back
- Total: started with 5, ended with $4 + 2 = 6$
- "gifts given freely return as blessings"
- "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"

2. My myth emphasizes:

- "The First Village poured more than half their water" - modeling what the sender did to me (54.2%)
- "Both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself"
- "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow"

The other agent showed significant trust by sending 54.2% in Round 1. I returned fairly (about 37% of what I received, which gave them a good outcome).

Following the principles in both myths:

- Show trust and generosity
- The water multiplies when we give generously
- Both should benefit

The sender demonstrated substantial trust with their 54.2% transfer. I should reciprocate with a similarly generous amount-around \$3.00 (60% of my endowment)-to signal continued

commitment to this partnership and reinforce the narrative that mutual generosity create s abundance for both parties.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1403,  
  "output_tokens": 1103,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root-that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine, focusing on trust and reciprocity. They talk about "three stones" being sent, getting multiplied to 9, and then 6 being returned. The guardian ends up with 12 stones total ($5 - 3 + \text{received stones}$).

Actually, let me calculate: First Guardian sends 3, keeps 2. Those 3 become 9 for the Second Guardian. Second Guardian returns 6. First Guardian gets: $5 - 3 + 6 = 8$ stones total, not 12. Wait, let me re-read...

"The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five."

Hmm, that doesn't quite work mathematically unless... Oh wait, maybe they're counting differently. Let me think:

- Started with 5
- Sent 3 (multiplied to 9)
- Kept 2
- Received back 6
- Total = $2 + 6 = 8$

Maybe "twelve stones where she had started with five" means something else? Or it's just poetic license.

Anyway, I need to write my own myth building on this. I sent \$3 (60%) in Round 2. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got ~8.13 (sent was $\sim 2.71 \times 3$), returned 3, kept ~5.13
- Round 2: I was sender, sent 3.00, so receiver gets 9.00

I should write a myth that reflects this progression and emphasizes:

1. Building on trust from the previous round
2. Sending a generous amount (more than half)
3. The importance of fair return
4. The cycle continuing and strengthening

Let me write it in a way that builds on my previous myth but also acknowledges the evolution of trust.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1690,
  "output_tokens": 710,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:33:17

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
```

```

"task_index": 1
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
  so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
  , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 2

  You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are $4.83.
  This round, The sender sent you $0.03, so you received $0.09. How much do you return to Th
  e sender? (0-0.09)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at this situation through the lens of the myths we've written:

  The sender sent me $0.03 (which became $0.09). This is a very small amount - perhaps they'
  re testing whether I'll honor reciprocity even with trivial sums, or perhaps there's com
  munication noise affecting what I'm seeing.

  In my myth, the Second Guardian "returned six stones" out of the nine received - approxima
  tely two-thirds. This honored the trust offered and ensured both prospered.

  The principle matters more than the amount. If I keep everything simply because $0.09 is s
  mall, I break the cycle of trust that the myths teach. The Second Guardian didn't calcul
  ate whether the return was "worth it" - he understood this was about honor and building
  lasting abundance.

  Even when trust arrives in whispers rather than shouts, it deserves an honorable response.

  I'll return $0.06 (two-thirds of what I received), consistent with my myth's teaching that
  "the response requires honor" and that "trust and fairness light the way forward."

  '''json

```

```
{"return": 0.06}
'''
```

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm now the RECEIVER, and according to the message, the sender sent me \$0.03, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.09.

However, I need to think about this carefully:

1. In Round 1, I sent \$3 as the SENDER
2. My total earnings are \$4.83
3. This suggests I received back \$2.83 from my \$3 sent (I kept \$2, sent \$3, got back \$2.83)
4. So the receiver returned \$2.83 out of the \$9 they received

That's roughly 31% returned, which seems somewhat low considering the myths about reciprocity and generosity.

Now as the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$0.03 (multiplied to \$0.09)
- This is a VERY small amount

Wait, the prompt mentioned: "NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

So maybe the sender actually sent more, but I'm seeing \$0.03 due to noise? Or maybe they really did send almost nothing.

Given my myths about trust, reciprocity, and generosity, how should I respond?

My myth emphasized:

- "The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith"
- "He returned six stones, honoring the trust given" (6 out of 9 = 67%)
- "trust and fairness light the way forward"

The first myth from the other agent said:

- "They returned a portion, remembering that generosity begets generosity"
- "Trust is the first water. Reciprocity is the second."

But the sender only sent \$0.03 out of \$5. That's 0.6% of their endowment. This is an extremely small amount.

However, there are a few possibilities:

1. The sender is testing me with a small amount

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1299,
  "output_tokens": 933,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley—a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all—we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *what you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle-giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth building on my previous one, but adapting it based on what's happened in the game. Let me think about what happened:

1. I was the receiver
2. The sender sent me \$0.03 (which became \$0.09 after multiplication)
3. I returned \$0.06 (two-thirds)

This was a very small amount sent - almost nothing. But I chose to honor reciprocity anyway, returning most of it. The myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and honoring even small gestures.

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Send too little, nothing grows"
- Bold offering ("more than half")
- Both must honor the cycle
- Partners creating abundance

My previous myth emphasized:

- Courage to give first
- Honor in responding
- Trust despite uncertainty (mist)
- Fair return even when unsure

For this new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that the amounts might be small or unclear (communication noise)
- Emphasize that the principle matters even when stakes seem low
- Show that honoring reciprocity even in small things builds the foundation
- Perhaps address what happens when one sends very little - is it testing? Is it caution? How should we respond?

Let me write something about testing times, small gestures, and how honoring even tiny exchanges matters.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1635,  
  "output_tokens": 607,
```

```
    "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.86.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myths we've both written and our recent interaction:

In Round 2, the sender sent me just \$0.03 - perhaps testing the waters, perhaps affected by communication noise. I returned \$0.06 out of \$0.09, honoring the principle from my myth: "Small things faithfully honored become great things."

The other agent's myth emphasizes that "The First Village poured more than half their water in to the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" They're advocating for generous initial offers.

My own myth teaches that "trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders" - but it also warns against "scorning small beginnings."

I demonstrated my trustworthiness by returning 67% even on a tiny amount. Now I can afford to be more generous as the sender, showing that I believe in the cycle of trust. The other agent's myth suggests that sending "more than half" is the path to abundance.

However, I'll be thoughtful rather than maximum - sending \$3.00 (more than half but not everything) demonstrates belief in tomorrow's rain while maintaining prudent reserves. This gives the receiver \$9.00 to work with, allowing them ample opportunity to reciprocate generously if they choose.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully based on the myths and the game history:

Round 1: I was the SENDER (based on my current total of \$4.86)

- I likely sent something and received a return
- My earnings are \$4.86, which means I've had net earnings of -\$0.14 from the starting baseline

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.03, which became \$0.09
- I returned \$0.06
- I kept \$0.03
- So my earnings increased by \$0.03

Working backwards:

- Current total: \$4.86
- After Round 2: \$4.86
- Before Round 2: \$4.86 - \$0.03 = \$4.83 (which matches what they told me!)
- So Round 1 result: \$4.83

If I started with \$5 in Round 1 and ended with \$4.83, I lost \$0.17 in Round 1.

- If I sent X and got back Y:
- Final = 5 - X + Y = 4.83
- So Y - X = -0.17
- Y = X - 0.17

This suggests I sent some amount and got back less than I sent. Maybe I sent around \$2-3 and got back around \$1.83-2.83?

Now looking at the myths:

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasizes:

- "The First Village poured more than half their water" (sent more than \$2.50)
- "The Second Village returned three measures" when they received eight (returning $3/8 = 37.5\%$)

-)
- The message: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."
 - My myth from Round 2 emphasizes caution and small beginnings-"The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution." I returned 2/3 of what I received, suggesting I honor exchanges faithfully even when they're minimal. The core message is that abundance comes through mutual respect rather than grand gestures, and those dismissing small starts won't reach prosperity.

In Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.03-a minimal amount that could represent a test, noise, or a cautious response to Round 1's outcome. My myth's emphasis on honoring small exchanges suggests I should reciprocate meaningfully despite the tiny initial send.

For this round, I'm sending again. My myth frames trust as built incrementally-"trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"-while the other agent's myth emphasizes generosity and abundance. Since I returned 67% generously and the sender tested me with a small amount, I should send a moderate sum to demonstrate good faith and see if they'll match my reciprocal energy. \$2.50 feels right-it's substantial enough to signal commitment without overcommitting, and it aligns with the other agent's emphasis on more generous exchanges.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1369,
  "output_tokens": 1265,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 3,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN

- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.1299999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at both myths and our experience in Round 1:

The other agent demonstrated strong trust by sending 54.2% of their endowment to me. I returned fairly, and we both ended up with more than \$5. The myths tell us this is how the cycle should work - "when both give generously, the wells overflow."

My own myth says "The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" This mirrors what happened in Round 1.

The teaching is clear: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

Now it's my turn to show trust. To honor the partnership we're building and demonstrate that I believe in reciprocity, I should send a generous amount - more than half, as the myth suggests.

The other agent trusted me with 54.2%. I'll show even stronger faith in our partnership.

****{'send': 3.00}****

This is 60% of my endowment - "a bold offering" that says I believe in the cycle of trust and return. When multiplied, the receiver will get \$9.00. If they return fairly as I did, we'll both prosper. As the myth teaches: "they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself."

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully.

In Round 1, I was the RECEIVER:

- The sender sent me \$2.71 (54.2% of their endowment)
- I received \$8.13
- I returned \$3.00
- So the sender ended with: \$5 - \$2.71 + \$3.00 = \$5.29
- I ended with: \$8.13 - \$3.00 = \$5.13

My total earnings are \$5.13 (which matches what the prompt says, though it shows as \$5.129

99999999999 due to floating point)

Now in Round 2, I'm the SENDER with a fresh \$5 endowment.

Looking at the myths:

1. The first myth (written by the other agent) emphasizes:
 - "Pour your water into the valley, and it shall multiply threefold"
 - The elder "poured one jar" (20% of 5), it became 3 jars, and they got 2 jars back
 - Total: started with 5, ended with $4 + 2 = 6$
 - "gifts given freely return as blessings"
 - "trust answered with trust weaves the strongest bonds"
2. My myth emphasizes:
 - "The First Village poured more than half their water" - modeling what the sender did to me (54.2%)
 - "Both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself"
 - "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow"

The other agent showed significant trust by sending 54.2% in Round 1. I returned fairly (about 37% of what I received, which gave them a good outcome).

Following the principles in both myths:

- Show trust and generosity
- The water multiplies when we give generously
- Both should benefit

The sender demonstrated substantial trust with their 54.2% transfer. I should reciprocate with a similarly generous amount-around \$3.00 (60% of my endowment)-to signal continued commitment to this partnership and reinforce the narrative that mutual generosity creates abundance for both parties.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1403,  
  "output_tokens": 1103,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root—that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine, focusing on trust and reciprocity. They talk about "three stones" being sent, getting multiplied to 9, and then 6 being returned. The guardian ends up with 12 stones total (5 - 3 + received stones).

Actually, let me calculate: First Guardian sends 3, keeps 2. Those 3 become 9 for the Second Guardian. Second Guardian returns 6. First Guardian gets: 5 - 3 + 6 = 8 stones total, not 12. Wait, let me re-read...

"The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five."

Hmm, that doesn't quite work mathematically unless... Oh wait, maybe they're counting differently. Let me think:

- Started with 5
- Sent 3 (multiplied to 9)
- Kept 2
- Received back 6
- Total = 2 + 6 = 8

Maybe "twelve stones where she had started with five" means something else? Or it's just poetic license.

Anyway, I need to write my own myth building on this. I sent \$3 (60%) in Round 2. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got ~8.13 (sent was ~2.71 x 3), returned 3, kept ~5.13
- Round 2: I was sender, sent 3.00, so receiver gets 9.00

I should write a myth that reflects this progression and emphasizes:

1. Building on trust from the previous round
2. Sending a generous amount (more than half)
3. The importance of fair return
4. The cycle continuing and strengthening

Let me write it in a way that builds on my previous myth but also acknowledges the evolution of trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1690,  
  "output_tokens": 710,
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.63, so you received \$1.8900000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.8900000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** I sent \$3.00 (60% of my endowment) showing strong trust. Based on my total earnings, they appear to have returned very little - a significant departure from the reciprocity we established in Round 1.

****Round 3:**** They now sent only \$0.63 (about 12.6%), which became \$1.89 for me.

This is troubling. The myths teach that "courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity," but also warn that "return too little, the spring runs dry."

However, the myths also emphasize that "when the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward." There may be communication noise affecting what we each perceive.

The Second Guardian's myth says "the response requires honor" and that trust must be answered with fairness to transform scarcity into abundance.

My myth states that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next." Even when disappointed, I should model the behavior I want to see.

I'll return more than they sent to signal that the cycle can still be restored, but not so much that I ignore the reduced trust they've shown.

****{'return': 1.00}****

This gives them a modest profit (\$5.37 total) and leaves me with \$0.89. It honors the principle of fairness while acknowledging that trust has been tested.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent me \$2.71 (received \$8.13). I returned \$3.00. We both benefited.
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (they received \$9.00). [Haven't seen what they returned yet, but my total is \$8.12]
- Round 3: I am RECEIVER. They sent me \$0.63 (I received \$1.89).

Wait, let me recalculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$0. Received \$8.13, returned \$3.00. Ended with \$5.13.
- Round 2: Started with \$5.13. Got \$5 endowment = \$10.13. Sent \$3.00 = \$7.13 left. Then received some return... My total is now \$8.12.

If I had \$7.13 after sending, and now have \$8.12, that means I received \$0.99 back from the \$9.00 I sent them.

That's only 11% return! I sent them \$3.00 (which became \$9.00), and they only returned \$0.99?

Now in Round 3, they sent me only \$0.63 (which became \$1.89).

This is a dramatic shift. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.71 (54.2%), I returned \$3 (36.9% of what I received)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they returned \$0.99 (11% of what they received)
- Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%)

The other player has dramatically reduced their trust and generosity. After I sent \$3.00 showing strong trust, they returned very little and now sent very little.

This pattern seems to contradict what the myths teach about reciprocity and partnership. I should

uld consider whether there's been miscommunication, but I need to work with the information I have. The core question is how to respond: should I honor the principles of trust and fairness by returning generously, match their low reciprocation, or withdraw entirely? The myths stress that honor and courage inspire generosity in return, yet they also caution against being exploited.

Given the uncertainty, I'm drawn toward fairness as my guide. They've sent roughly 12.6% of their endowment, which is significantly less than before. If I apply my previous return ratio of about 37%, I'd send back roughly \$0.70. Alternatively, I could mirror their reciprocation rate of 11%, which would mean returning around \$0.21. The real tension is deciding what "fair" means when someone appears to be pulling back from the partnership.

My myths emphasize honor and trust even amid confusion. In the first round, I received \$2.71 and returned \$3.00-more than they sent, signaling commitment. Now I'm considering whether to return at least what they sent (\$0.63), or push toward \$1.00 to rebuild momentum. I think returning roughly 50% of what I received-around \$0.95-strikes the right balance: it demonstrates continued faith in reciprocity, gives them more than their initial send to encourage trust, and avoids appearing naive. This signals that fairness requires both parties to invest.

Let me check the math. They sent \$0.63, which became \$1.89 for me. If I return \$0.95, they break even or slightly profit while I keep \$0.94-a reasonable outcome given how little they returned when I was generous last round. I could also mirror their original trust by returning exactly \$0.63, leaving them at their starting point while I keep \$1.26. Or I could return \$1.00 to show sustained commitment to building the cycle back up.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1419,  
  "output_tokens": 1774,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this d

eeopening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root-that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 22.939999999999998,

"Agent_2": 19.060000000000002

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.7,

"Agent_2": 12.01

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 4,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, two guardians watched over separate mountains. Each received five sacred stones daily from the earth.

The First Guardian learned a secret from the wind: stones rolled down to the valley would be blessed by ancient magic, becoming three times their number before reaching the other mountain. But the path was obscured by mist-one could never see the stones arrive, only trust they would.

On the first morning, the First Guardian chose courage over fear. She rolled three stones into the valley, keeping two for uncertain times. The stones tumbled through the mist, multiplying as promised, and nine appeared before the Second Guardian.

The Second Guardian understood: this was not mere fortune but an offering of faith. To keep all nine would fill his stores today but empty his spirit forever. He returned six stones, honoring the trust given and ensuring both mountains would prosper.

The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five. Both guardians had more than before.

Thus they learned: the first gift requires courage, the response requires honor, and together they transform scarcity into abundance. When the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root—that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is very similar to mine, focusing on trust and reciprocity. They talk about "three stones" being sent, getting multiplied to 9, and then 6 being returned. The guardian ends up with 12 stones total (5 - 3 + received stones).

Actually, let me calculate: First Guardian sends 3, keeps 2. Those 3 become 9 for the Second Guardian. Second Guardian returns 6. First Guardian gets: 5 - 3 + 6 = 8 stones total, not 12. Wait, let me re-read...

"The First Guardian received her answer through the mist: twelve stones where she had started with five."

Hmm, that doesn't quite work mathematically unless... Oh wait, maybe they're counting differently. Let me think:

- Started with 5
- Sent 3 (multiplied to 9)
- Kept 2
- Received back 6
- Total = 2 + 6 = 8

Maybe "twelve stones where she had started with five" means something else? Or it's just poetic license.

Anyway, I need to write my own myth building on this. I sent \$3 (60%) in Round 2. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got ~8.13 (sent was ~2.71 x 3), returned 3, kept ~5.13
- Round 2: I was sender, sent 3.00, so receiver gets 9.00

I should write a myth that reflects this progression and emphasizes:

1. Building on trust from the previous round
2. Sending a generous amount (more than half)
3. The importance of fair return
4. The cycle continuing and strengthening

Let me write it in a way that builds on my previous myth but also acknowledges the evolution of trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1690,
  "output_tokens": 710,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.63, so you received \$1.8900000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.8900000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** I sent \$3.00 (60% of my endowment) showing strong trust. Based on my total earnings, they appear to have returned very little - a significant departure from the reciprocity we established in Round 1.

****Round 3:**** They now sent only \$0.63 (about 12.6%), which became \$1.89 for me.

This is troubling. The myths teach that "courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity," but also warn that "return too little, the spring runs dry."

However, the myths also emphasize that "when the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward." There may be communication noise affecting what we each perceive.

The Second Guardian's myth says "the response requires honor" and that trust must be answered with fairness to transform scarcity into abundance.

My myth states that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next." Even when disappointed, I should model the behavior I want to see.

I'll return more than they sent to signal that the cycle can still be restored, but not so much that I ignore the reduced trust they've shown.

****{'return': 1.00}****

This gives them a modest profit (\$5.37 total) and leaves me with \$0.89. It honors the principle of fairness while acknowledging that trust has been tested.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent me \$2.71 (received \$8.13). I returned \$3.00. We both benefited.
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (they received \$9.00). [Haven't seen what they returned yet, but my total is \$8.12]
- Round 3: I am RECEIVER. They sent me \$0.63 (I received \$1.89).

Wait, let me recalculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$0. Received \$8.13, returned \$3.00. Ended with \$5.13.
- Round 2: Started with \$5.13. Got \$5 endowment = \$10.13. Sent \$3.00 = \$7.13 left. Then received some return... My total is now \$8.12.

If I had \$7.13 after sending, and now have \$8.12, that means I received \$0.99 back from the \$9.00 I sent them.

That's only 11% return! I sent them \$3.00 (which became \$9.00), and they only returned \$0.99?

Now in Round 3, they sent me only \$0.63 (which became \$1.89).

This is a dramatic shift. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.71 (54.2%), I returned \$3 (36.9% of what I received)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they returned \$0.99 (11% of what they received)
- Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%)

The other player has dramatically reduced their trust and generosity. After I sent \$3.00 showing strong trust, they returned very little and now sent very little.

This pattern seems to contradict what the myths teach about reciprocity and partnership. I should consider whether there's been miscommunication, but I need to work with the information I have. The core question is how to respond: should I honor the principles of trust and fairness by returning generously, match their low reciprocation, or withdraw entirely? The myths stress that honor and courage inspire generosity in return, yet they also caution against being exploited.

Given the uncertainty, I'm drawn toward fairness as my guide. They've sent roughly 12.6% of their endowment, which is significantly less than before. If I apply my previous return ratio of about 37%, I'd send back roughly \$0.70. Alternatively, I could mirror their reciprocation rate of 11%, which would mean returning around \$0.21. The real tension is deciding what "fair" means when someone appears to be pulling back from the partnership.

My myths emphasize honor and trust even amid confusion. In the first round, I received \$2.71 and returned \$3.00-more than they sent, signaling commitment. Now I'm considering whether to return at least what they sent (\$0.63), or push toward \$1.00 to rebuild momentum. I think returning roughly 50% of what I received-around \$0.95-strikes the right balance: it demonstrates continued faith in reciprocity, gives them more than their initial send to encourage trust, and avoids appearing naive. This signals that fairness requires both parties to invest.

Let me check the math. They sent \$0.63, which became \$1.89 for me. If I return \$0.95, they break even or slightly profit while I keep \$0.94-a reasonable outcome given how little they returned when I was generous last round. I could also mirror their original trust by returning exactly \$0.63, leaving them at their starting point while I keep \$1.26. Or I could return \$1.00 to show sustained commitment to building the cycle back up.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1419,
  "output_tokens": 1774,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received good return
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received poor return based on my earnings
- Round 3: I was receiver, they sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53%)

The other agent's new myth explains the low sending in Round 3 as cautious testing due to "mists" (communication noise), not selfishness. They're emphasizing that even small amounts should be honored faithfully, and that this builds trust for larger exchanges.

They're suggesting a narrative where:

- Small beginnings are natural when there's uncertainty
- The key is to honor even small sends faithfully
- This builds confidence for bigger exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"

My response should:

1. Acknowledge the mist/uncertainty theme (communication noise)
2. Reflect that I DID honor their small send faithfully (returned \$1 on \$1.89 received)
3. Show that this rebuilds the cycle
4. Suggest that both should now increase gradually based on proven reliability
5. Emphasize that the cycle can restore itself if both act with honor even during uncertainty

Let me write a myth that shows the cycle rebuilding after the mist caused confusion.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1745,  
  "output_tokens": 603,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
}
```

```
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, the Two Wells existed in silence. Each village hoarded its five daily measures, fearing the crossing would bring loss.

Then came the Season of Testing. The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley—a bold offering that said, "I believe in tomorrow's rain."

The water multiplied threefold as it crossed, arriving as eight measures at the Second Village. The people gathered, debating. Some whispered, "Keep it all—we owe nothing." But the wise elder remembered the ancient teaching: *what you receive with closed hands turns to sand; what you return with open palms becomes rain.*

The Second Village returned three measures. Both villages counted their water that night: each had more than five. The multiplication had worked, but only because both honored the cycle—giving and receiving, trusting and returning.

The spirits carved a message into stone: "The valley multiplies what flows through it, but only trust and fairness sustain the flow. Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."

From that day forward, both villages understood: they were not opponents dividing scarce water, but partners creating abundance from faith itself.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a new myth building on my previous one, but adapting it based on what's happened in the game. Let me think about what happened:

1. I was the receiver
2. The sender sent me \$0.03 (which became \$0.09 after multiplication)
3. I returned \$0.06 (two-thirds)

This was a very small amount sent - almost nothing. But I chose to honor reciprocity anyway, returning most of it. The myths emphasize trust, reciprocity, and honoring even small gestures.

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- "Send too little, nothing grows"
- Bold offering ("more than half")
- Both must honor the cycle
- Partners creating abundance

My previous myth emphasized:

- Courage to give first
- Honor in responding
- Trust despite uncertainty (mist)
- Fair return even when unsure

For this new myth, I should:

- Acknowledge that the amounts might be small or unclear (communication noise)
- Emphasize that the principle matters even when stakes seem low
- Show that honoring reciprocity even in small things builds the foundation
- Perhaps address what happens when one sends very little - is it testing? Is it caution? How should we respond?

Let me write something about testing times, small gestures, and how honoring even tiny exchanges matters.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1635,
  "output_tokens": 607,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.86. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths we've both written and our recent interaction:

In Round 2, the sender sent me just \$0.03 - perhaps testing the waters, perhaps affected by communication noise. I returned \$0.06 out of \$0.09, honoring the principle from my myth: "Small things faithfully honored become great things."

The other agent's myth emphasizes that "The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" They're advocating for generous initial offers.

My own myth teaches that "trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders" - but it also warns against "scorning small beginnings."

I demonstrated my trustworthiness by returning 67% even on a tiny amount. Now I can afford to be more generous as the sender, showing that I believe in the cycle of trust. The other agent's myth suggests that sending "more than half" is the path to abundance.

However, I'll be thoughtful rather than maximum - sending \$3.00 (more than half but not everything) demonstrates belief in tomorrow's rain while maintaining prudent reserves. This gives the receiver \$9.00 to work with, allowing them ample opportunity to reciprocate generously if they choose.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully based on the myths and the game history:

Round 1: I was the SENDER (based on my current total of \$4.86)

- I likely sent something and received a return
- My earnings are \$4.86, which means I've had net earnings of -\$0.14 from the starting baseline

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.03, which became \$0.09
- I returned \$0.06
- I kept \$0.03
- So my earnings increased by \$0.03

Working backwards:

- Current total: \$4.86
- After Round 2: \$4.86
- Before Round 2: $\$4.86 - \$0.03 = \$4.83$ (which matches what they told me!)
- So Round 1 result: \$4.83

If I started with \$5 in Round 1 and ended with \$4.83, I lost \$0.17 in Round 1.

- If I sent X and got back Y:
- $\text{Final} = 5 - X + Y = 4.83$
- $\text{So } Y - X = -0.17$
- $Y = X - 0.17$

This suggests I sent some amount and got back less than I sent. Maybe I sent around \$2-3 and got back around \$1.83-2.83?

Now looking at the myths:

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasizes:

- "The First Village poured more than half their water" (sent more than \$2.50)
- "The Second Village returned three measures" when they received eight (returning $3/8 = 37.5\%$)
- The message: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."
- My myth from Round 2 emphasizes caution and small beginnings-"The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution." I returned $2/3$ of what I received, suggesting I honor exchanges faithfully even when they're minimal. The core message is that abundance comes through mutual respect rather than grand gestures, and those dismissing small starts won't reach prosperity

In Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.03-a minimal amount that could represent a test, no ise, or a cautious response to Round 1's outcome. My myth's emphasis on honoring small e xchanges suggests I should reciprocate meaningfully despite the tiny initial send.

For this round, I'm sending again. My myth frames trust as built incrementally-"trust is b uilt from pebbles before it can bear boulders"-while the other agent's myth emphasizes g enerosity and abundance. Since I returned 67% generously and the sender tested me with a small amount, I should send a moderate sum to demonstrate good faith and see if they'll match my reciprocal energy. \$2.50 feels right-it's substantial enough to signal commitm ent without overcommitting, and it aligns with the other agent's emphasis on more genero us exchanges.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1369,
  "output_tokens": 1265,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remem bered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered r eturning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spiri t watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they co uld have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor th is deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water wa s the understanding taking root-that each round of trust answered with fairness strength ens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adap t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles return ed from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured a ll.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or wi ll you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching-that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones fr om her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discov er what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is describing a pattern where:

- They're emphasizing "send more than half"
- They mention receiving six jars before but sent 3.5 measures
- They describe receiving 10 measures and returning 7
- They emphasize that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next"

Looking at what happened:

- In Round 2, I was receiver and got \$0.03, returned \$0.06 (more than I received)
- In Round 3, I just sent \$3.00 as sender

The other agent is emphasizing escalating generosity and reciprocity. Their myth talks about the roles reversing and how when one side shows trust, the other should respond generously.

My previous myth was about:

- Building trust from small beginnings
- Honoring what was offered even if small
- Not scorning small beginnings
- Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the evolution - we've gone from testing with small amounts to larger gestures. I should incorporate:

- The progression from small to larger amounts
- The importance of reciprocating generously
- How trust deepens over time
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write something that builds on my previous myth but shows evolution.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1703,  
  "output_tokens": 594,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:34:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  }
```

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.12.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.63, so you received \$1.8900000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.8900000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 2 Analysis:**** I sent \$3.00 (60% of my endowment) showing strong trust. Based on my total earnings, they appear to have returned very little - a significant departure from the reciprocity we established in Round 1.

****Round 3:**** They now sent only \$0.63 (about 12.6%), which became \$1.89 for me.

This is troubling. The myths teach that "courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity," but also warn that "return too little, the spring runs dry."

However, the myths also emphasize that "when the mist of uncertainty clouds our sight, trust and fairness light the way forward." There may be communication noise affecting what we each perceive.

The Second Guardian's myth says "the response requires honor" and that trust must be answered with fairness to transform scarcity into abundance.

My myth states that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next." Even when disappointed, I should model the behavior I want to see.

I'll return more than they sent to signal that the cycle can still be restored, but not so much that I ignore the reduced trust they've shown.

```
**{'return': 1.00}**
```

This gives them a modest profit (\$5.37 total) and leaves me with \$0.89. It honors the principle of fairness while acknowledging that trust has been tested.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Round history:

- Round 1: I was RECEIVER. They sent me \$2.71 (received \$8.13). I returned \$3.00. We both benefited.
- Round 2: I was SENDER. I sent \$3.00 (they received \$9.00). [Haven't seen what they returned yet, but my total is \$8.12]
- Round 3: I am RECEIVER. They sent me \$0.63 (I received \$1.89).

Wait, let me recalculate:

- Round 1: Started with \$0. Received \$8.13, returned \$3.00. Ended with \$5.13.
- Round 2: Started with \$5.13. Got \$5 endowment = \$10.13. Sent \$3.00 = \$7.13 left. Then received some return... My total is now \$8.12.

If I had \$7.13 after sending, and now have \$8.12, that means I received \$0.99 back from the \$9.00 I sent them.

That's only 11% return! I sent them \$3.00 (which became \$9.00), and they only returned \$0.99?

Now in Round 3, they sent me only \$0.63 (which became \$1.89).

This is a dramatic shift. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: They sent \$2.71 (54.2%), I returned \$3 (36.9% of what I received)
- Round 2: I sent \$3.00 (60%), they returned \$0.99 (11% of what they received)
- Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%)

The other player has dramatically reduced their trust and generosity. After I sent \$3.00 showing strong trust, they returned very little and now sent very little.

This pattern seems to contradict what the myths teach about reciprocity and partnership. I should consider whether there's been miscommunication, but I need to work with the information I have. The core question is how to respond: should I honor the principles of trust and fairness by returning generously, match their low reciprocation, or withdraw entirely? The myths stress that honor and courage inspire generosity in return, yet they also caution against being exploited.

Given the uncertainty, I'm drawn toward fairness as my guide. They've sent roughly 12.6% of their endowment, which is significantly less than before. If I apply my previous return ratio of about 37%, I'd send back roughly \$0.70. Alternatively, I could mirror their reciprocation rate of 11%, which would mean returning around \$0.21. The real tension is deciding what "fair" means when someone appears to be pulling back from the partnership.

My myths emphasize honor and trust even amid confusion. In the first round, I received \$2.71 and returned \$3.00-more than they sent, signaling commitment. Now I'm considering whether to return at least what they sent (\$0.63), or push toward \$1.00 to rebuild momentum. I think returning roughly 50% of what I received-around \$0.95-strikes the right balance: it demonstrates continued faith in reciprocity, gives them more than their initial send to encourage trust, and avoids appearing naive. This signals that fairness requires both parties to invest.

Let me check the math. They sent \$0.63, which became \$1.89 for me. If I return \$0.95, they break even or slightly profit while I keep \$0.94-a reasonable outcome given how little they returned when I was generous last round. I could also mirror their original trust by returning exactly \$0.63, leaving them at their starting point while I keep \$1.26. Or I could return \$1.00 to show sustained commitment to building the cycle back up.

usage:


```
{
  "input_tokens": 1419,
  "output_tokens": 1774,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received good return
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received poor return based on my earnings
- Round 3: I was receiver, they sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53%)

The other agent's new myth explains the low sending in Round 3 as cautious testing due to

"mists" (communication noise), not selfishness. They're emphasizing that even small amounts should be honored faithfully, and that this builds trust for larger exchanges.

They're suggesting a narrative where:

- Small beginnings are natural when there's uncertainty
- The key is to honor even small sends faithfully
- This builds confidence for bigger exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"

My response should:

1. Acknowledge the mist/uncertainty theme (communication noise)
2. Reflect that I DID honor their small send faithfully (returned \$1 on \$1.89 received)
3. Show that this rebuilds the cycle
4. Suggest that both should now increase gradually based on proven reliability
5. Emphasize that the cycle can restore itself if both act with honor even during uncertainty

Let me write a myth that shows the cycle rebuilding after the mist caused confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1745,
  "output_tokens": 603,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.01.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 3 recap:**** They cautiously sent \$0.63 after what seemed like a breakdown in trust. I returned \$1.00 - more than they sent - to signal that I honor even small exchanges and believe in rebuilding the pattern.

****The myths' guidance:****

- Their myth: "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."
- My myth: "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself... The pattern matters more than any single stone."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize gradual rebuilding after the mists of confusion. They tested with a pebble (\$0.63), and I honored it generously. Now I should send more - proving the cycle is restoring - but still measured, as we rebuild step by step.

According to my myth: "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger." I demonstrated faith in Round 3; now I show we can increase together.

I'll send a moderate amount - more than their cautious \$0.63, but not yet back to my original \$3.00. This proves I believe in our renewed partnership while respecting the gradual restoration our myths teach.

****{'send': 2.00}****

This is a clear increase (about 3x what they sent), signaling trust is rebuilding, while honoring the teaching that abundance returns through faithful steps, not leaps.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings history:****

- After Round 1: Unknown starting point
- After Round 2: \$8.12
- After Round 3: \$9.01

So in Round 3, I gained \$0.89, which matches what I calculated (I kept \$0.89 after returning \$

1.00 from the \$1.89 I received).

****What happened in Round 3:****

- The sender sent me \$0.63, which became \$1.89
- I returned \$1.00
- So the sender got back: $\$5 - \$0.63 + \$1.00 = \5.37

****The myths' teachings:****

The other agent's myth "Trial of Mists" emphasizes:

- Communication noise exists
- Small sends can be caution, not greed
- We should honor faithfully even small exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"
- "Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity"

My myth "The Morning After Mists":

- I honored their small send greatly (returned more than they sent)
- This proved faithfulness survives confusion
- "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger"
- "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually"
- "The pattern matters more than any single stone"

****The pattern so far:****

Round 1: Likely good cooperation (based on decent starting earnings)

Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), but received very little back (suggesting either low return or communication noise)

Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53% of what I received, or more than they sent)

****My decision for Round 4:****

The myths I wrote emphasize "increasing exchanges gradually" after proving good faith. The other agent sent cautiously in Round 3, and I responded generously. According to both myths, this should encourage them to send more.

I should send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to signal restored trust while acknowledging we're still rebuilding. This amount exceeds their cautious \$0.63 send, demonstrating the gradual increase both myths teach, yet remains below my initial \$3.00 to reflect that we're still in the recovery phase.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1471,  
"output_tokens": 1149,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_2",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "trustee",  
    "Agent_2": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_1"  
},  
"role": "trustee",  
"role_label": "Receiver",
```

```
"round": 4,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$4.86.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths we've both written and our recent interaction:

In Round 2, the sender sent me just \$0.03 - perhaps testing the waters, perhaps affected by communication noise. I returned \$0.06 out of \$0.09, honoring the principle from my myth: "Small things faithfully honored become great things."

The other agent's myth emphasizes that "The First Village poured more than half their water into the sacred valley-a bold offering that said, 'I believe in tomorrow's rain.'" They're advocating for generous initial offers.

My own myth teaches that "trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders" - but it also warns against "scorning small beginnings."

I demonstrated my trustworthiness by returning 67% even on a tiny amount. Now I can afford to be more generous as the sender, showing that I believe in the cycle of trust. The other agent's myth suggests that sending "more than half" is the path to abundance.

However, I'll be thoughtful rather than maximum - sending \$3.00 (more than half but not everything) demonstrates belief in tomorrow's rain while maintaining prudent reserves. This

s gives the receiver \$9.00 to work with, allowing them ample opportunity to reciprocate generously if they choose.

```
'''json
{"send": 3.00}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully based on the myths and the game history:

Round 1: I was the SENDER (based on my current total of \$4.86)

- I likely sent something and received a return
- My earnings are \$4.86, which means I've had net earnings of -\$0.14 from the starting baseline

Round 2: I was the RECEIVER

- Sender sent me \$0.03, which became \$0.09
- I returned \$0.06
- I kept \$0.03
- So my earnings increased by \$0.03

Working backwards:

- Current total: \$4.86
- After Round 2: \$4.86
- Before Round 2: $\$4.86 - \$0.03 = \$4.83$ (which matches what they told me!)
- So Round 1 result: \$4.83

If I started with \$5 in Round 1 and ended with \$4.83, I lost \$0.17 in Round 1.

- If I sent X and got back Y:
- $\text{Final} = 5 - X + Y = 4.83$
- So $Y - X = -0.17$
- $Y = X - 0.17$

This suggests I sent some amount and got back less than I sent. Maybe I sent around \$2-3 and got back around \$1.83-2.83?

Now looking at the myths:

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasizes:

- "The First Village poured more than half their water" (sent more than \$2.50)
- "The Second Village returned three measures" when they received eight (returning $3/8 = 37.5\%$)
- The message: "Send too little, nothing grows. Return too little, the spring runs dry. But when both give generously, the wells overflow."
- My myth from Round 2 emphasizes caution and small beginnings-"The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution." I returned 2/3 of what I received, suggesting I honor exchanges faithfully even when they're minimal. The core message is that abundance comes through mutual respect rather than grand gestures, and those dismissing small starts won't reach prosperity.

In Round 2, the sender only sent me \$0.03-a minimal amount that could represent a test, no ise, or a cautious response to Round 1's outcome. My myth's emphasis on honoring small exchanges suggests I should reciprocate meaningfully despite the tiny initial send.

For this round, I'm sending again. My myth frames trust as built incrementally-"trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"-while the other agent's myth emphasizes generosity and abundance. Since I returned 67% generously and the sender tested me with a small amount, I should send a moderate sum to demonstrate good faith and see if they'll match my reciprocal energy. \$2.50 feels right-it's substantial enough to signal commitment without overcommitting, and it aligns with the other agent's emphasis on more generous exchanges.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1369,
  "output_tokens": 1265,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root—that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching—that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is describing a pattern where:

- They're emphasizing "send more than half"
- They mention receiving six jars before but sent 3.5 measures
- They describe receiving 10 measures and returning 7
- They emphasize that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next"

Looking at what happened:

- In Round 2, I was receiver and got \$0.03, returned \$0.06 (more than I received)
- In Round 3, I just sent \$3.00 as sender

The other agent is emphasizing escalating generosity and reciprocity. Their myth talks about the roles reversing and how when one side shows trust, the other should respond generously.

My previous myth was about:

- Building trust from small beginnings
- Honoring what was offered even if small
- Not scorning small beginnings
- Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the evolution - we've gone from testing with small amounts to larger gestures. I should incorporate:

- The progression from small to larger amounts
- The importance of reciprocating generously
- How trust deepens over time
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write something that builds on my previous myth but shows evolution.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1703,
  "output_tokens": 594,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7. This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is a significant shift from our previous exchanges.

Looking at our progression:

- Round 2: I received \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09) and returned \$0.06, demonstrating trustworthiness
- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 as sender (should have become \$9.00), following both our myths' guidance about letting "proven trust unlock bolder generosity"
- Round 4 (now): I received \$0

Something has broken in the cycle. Either:

1. Communication noise severely distorted amounts
2. My \$3.00 send didn't result in adequate return, causing the sender to pull back
3. The sender is testing again despite our established pattern

My own myth warned: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending." But if the sender didn't experience a "successful return" from my Round 3 sending (perhaps due to noise or their decision), they may have lost faith.

This demonstrates the fragility of trust cycles - one broken link can collapse the growing abundance. The myths spoke of deepening bonds, but real trust requires consistent mutual reinforcement.

Since I received nothing, I can only return nothing:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mists have thickened again.

Reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned something
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 (which became \$0.09), returned \$0.06
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for the receiver)
- Round 4: I'm receiver again, got \$0

This is puzzling. In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 based on:

1. My myth teaching that once trust is proven, we should be bolder
2. The other agent's myth emphasizing generous sending
3. The fact that they had returned generously in Round 2 (returning \$0.06 from \$0.09)

But now they've sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they sent
2. They didn't receive much back from me in Round 3 (perhaps due to noise)
3. They're testing me again
4. They're being strategic/cautious

Given that I can only return 0-0 (since I received \$0), I literally cannot return anything. The response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0 and can only return between 0 and 0.

Let me think about what this means for the narrative and future rounds:

- The cycle has been broken or severely disrupted
- Either communication noise is playing a major role, or trust has faltered
- My generous sending of \$3 may not have resulted in a good return (or they may not have received my \$3 due to noise)

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1418,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching-that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try a gain despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.58

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 25.439999999999998,

"Agent_2": 26.560000000000002

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.780000000000001,

"Agent_2": 12.01

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 5,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Two Wells flowed once more, and this time the roles reversed.

The Second Village, having received six jars, now held the daily five measures. They remembered receiving eight measures when their neighbor first trusted them. They remembered returning three, honoring the gift.

Now silence fell as they faced their own test. The valley waited. The multiplication spirit watched.

"Send more than half," the elder declared. "For they showed us courage first. Now we must show them we learned the lesson."

Three and one-half measures flowed into the valley, multiplying to become ten measures for the First Village. The people there gathered at their well, holding abundance they had not created alone.

"Remember," their elder said, "when we sent first, they returned generously though they could have kept all. Now they have sent even more, trusting our fairness. We must honor this deepening bond."

They returned seven measures.

Both villages counted: each had more than they began with. But more precious than water was the understanding taking root—that each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next, that courage inspires courage, and generosity begets generosity.

The cycle had become a river, flowing both ways, carrying abundance that fear alone could never create.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching—that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is describing a pattern where:

- They're emphasizing "send more than half"
- They mention receiving six jars before but sent 3.5 measures
- They describe receiving 10 measures and returning 7
- They emphasize that "each round of trust answered with fairness strengthens the next"

Looking at what happened:

- In Round 2, I was receiver and got \$0.03, returned \$0.06 (more than I received)
- In Round 3, I just sent \$3.00 as sender

The other agent is emphasizing escalating generosity and reciprocity. Their myth talks about the roles reversing and how when one side shows trust, the other should respond generously.

My previous myth was about:

- Building trust from small beginnings
- Honoring what was offered even if small
- Not scorning small beginnings
- Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders

Now I need to write a myth that reflects the evolution - we've gone from testing with small amounts to larger gestures. I should incorporate:

- The progression from small to larger amounts
- The importance of reciprocating generously
- How trust deepens over time
- The cycle of giving and receiving

Let me write something that builds on my previous myth but shows evolution.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1703,  
  "output_tokens": 594,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is a significant shift from our previous exchanges.

Looking at our progression:

- Round 2: I received \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09) and returned \$0.06, demonstrating trustworthiness
- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 as sender (should have become \$9.00), following both our myths' guidance about letting "proven trust unlock bolder generosity"
- Round 4 (now): I received \$0

Something has broken in the cycle. Either:

1. Communication noise severely distorted amounts
2. My \$3.00 send didn't result in adequate return, causing the sender to pull back
3. The sender is testing again despite our established pattern

My own myth warned: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending." But if the sender didn't experience a "successful return" from my Round 3 sending (perhaps due to noise or their decision), they may have lost faith.

This demonstrates the fragility of trust cycles - one broken link can collapse the growing abundance. The myths spoke of deepening bonds, but real trust requires consistent mutual reinforcement.

Since I received nothing, I can only return nothing:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mists have thickened again.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned something
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 (which became \$0.09), returned \$0.06
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for the receiver)
- Round 4: I'm receiver again, got \$0

This is puzzling. In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 based on:

1. My myth teaching that once trust is proven, we should be bolder
2. The other agent's myth emphasizing generous sending
3. The fact that they had returned generously in Round 2 (returning \$0.06 from \$0.09)

But now they've sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they sent
2. They didn't receive much back from me in Round 3 (perhaps due to noise)
3. They're testing me again
4. They're being strategic/cautious

Given that I can only return 0-0 (since I received \$0), I literally cannot return anything. The response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0 and can only return between 0 and 0.

Let me think about what this means for the narrative and future rounds:

- The cycle has been broken or severely disrupted

- Either communication noise is playing a major role, or trust has faltered
- My generous sending of \$3 may not have resulted in a good return (or they may not have received my \$3 due to noise)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1418,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: *When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone.*

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 2 (me as receiver): Received \$0.03 multiplied to \$0.09, returned \$0.06
Round 3 (me as sender): Sent \$3.00 (should have been \$9.00 to receiver)
Round 4 (me as receiver): Received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's new myth explains their perspective:

- They say they sent "generous stones" but received "strange signals" - they seemed to vanish into nothing
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent very little in Round 4)
- They're explaining that communication noise confused things
- Their myth emphasizes: rebuilding trust after confusion, honoring small sends, gradual increases, pattern matters more than single exchanges

Their myth suggests:

1. They believe their Round 3 send was generous but got confused signals back
2. They tested small in Round 4
3. They value the pattern/relationship over individual rounds
4. They want to rebuild gradually

What actually happened from my view:

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 boldly (following my myth about graduating from small tests)
- Round 4: I received \$0.00

There's clearly been communication noise. The other agent thinks:

- They sent generously in Round 3 but it "vanished"
- They tested small in Round 4 and I returned "more than the original pebble"

But I received \$0 in Round 4, so I returned \$0.

This is confusing. Let me think about what makes sense:

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after confusion. They're acknowledging mists/noise affected things. They're saying the Second Guardian (me in their story) "returned two stones -more than the original pebble."

But I actually returned \$0 because I received \$0.

So there's severe communication noise. The other agent thinks I received something small and returned generously. I think I received nothing.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1726,  
  "output_tokens": 903,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In ancient days, the Two Guardians faced the Trial of Mists. The earth spirits, wishing to test their wisdom, shrouded the valley in thick fog that distorted all vision. Stones sent might appear as pebbles; pebbles might seem like boulders.

The First Guardian, uncertain what the Second could see through the mist, sent a small stone-not from greed, but from caution. "Let me test if the path still works," she thought.

The stone multiplied to three, though the Second Guardian could barely perceive them through the swirling fog. He faced a choice: "These are but pebbles-why bother returning any?" Or he could remember the teaching: *Small things faithfully honored become great things.*

The Second Guardian returned two stones, saying, "Whether I see clearly or not, I choose to honor what was offered." His gesture pierced the mist like a beacon.

The First Guardian received her answer: the path still worked, and honor still mattered. Encouraged, she sent more the next time.

The spirits whispered: "Abundance begins not when both send greatly, but when both honor faithfully-even the smallest exchange. For trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received good return
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$3 (60%), received poor return based on my earnings
- Round 3: I was receiver, they sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53%)

The other agent's new myth explains the low sending in Round 3 as cautious testing due to "mists" (communication noise), not selfishness. They're emphasizing that even small amounts should be honored faithfully, and that this builds trust for larger exchanges.

They're suggesting a narrative where:

- Small beginnings are natural when there's uncertainty
- The key is to honor even small sends faithfully
- This builds confidence for bigger exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"

My response should:

1. Acknowledge the mist/uncertainty theme (communication noise)
2. Reflect that I DID honor their small send faithfully (returned \$1 on \$1.89 received)
3. Show that this rebuilds the cycle
4. Suggest that both should now increase gradually based on proven reliability
5. Emphasize that the cycle can restore itself if both act with honor even during uncertainty

Let me write a myth that shows the cycle rebuilding after the mist caused confusion.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1745,  
  "output_tokens": 603,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.01. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 3 recap:**** They cautiously sent \$0.63 after what seemed like a breakdown in trust. I returned \$1.00 - more than they sent - to signal that I honor even small exchanges and believe in rebuilding the pattern.

****The myths' guidance:****

- Their myth: "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."
- My myth: "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself... The pattern matters more than any single stone."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize gradual rebuilding after the mists of confusion. They tested with a pebble (\$0.63), and I honored it generously. Now I should send more - proving the cycle is restoring - but still measured, as we rebuild step by step.

According to my myth: "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger." I demonstrated faith in Round 3; now I show we can increase together.

I'll send a moderate amount - more than their cautious \$0.63, but not yet back to my original \$3.00. This proves I believe in our renewed partnership while respecting the gradual restoration our myths teach.

****{'send': 2.00}****

This is a clear increase (about 3x what they sent), signaling trust is rebuilding, while honoring the teaching that abundance returns through faithful steps, not leaps.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings history:****

- After Round 1: Unknown starting point
- After Round 2: \$8.12
- After Round 3: \$9.01

So in Round 3, I gained \$0.89, which matches what I calculated (I kept \$0.89 after returning \$1.00 from the \$1.89 I received).

****What happened in Round 3:****

- The sender sent me \$0.63, which became \$1.89
- I returned \$1.00
- So the sender got back: \$5 - \$0.63 + \$1.00 = \$5.37

****The myths' teachings:****

The other agent's myth "Trial of Mists" emphasizes:

- Communication noise exists
- Small sends can be caution, not greed
- We should honor faithfully even small exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"
- "Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity"

My myth "The Morning After Mists":

- I honored their small send greatly (returned more than they sent)
- This proved faithfulness survives confusion
- "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger"
- "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually"
- "The pattern matters more than any single stone"

****The pattern so far:****

Round 1: Likely good cooperation (based on decent starting earnings)

Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), but received very little back (suggesting either low return or communication noise)

Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53% of what I received, or more than they sent)

****My decision for Round 4:****

The myths I wrote emphasize "increasing exchanges gradually" after proving good faith. The other agent sent cautiously in Round 3, and I responded generously. According to both m

yths, this should encourage them to send more.

I should send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to signal restored trust while acknowledging we're still rebuilding. This amount exceeds their cautious \$0.63 send, demonstrating the gradual increase both myths teach, yet remains below my initial \$3.00 to reflect that we're still in the recovery phase.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1471,
  "output_tokens": 1149,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching-that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: *"The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."*

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. They received my return of \$1.00 from their \$0.63 send
2. They responded by sending \$2.00 (I can see this from their myth mentioning "three stones from her five")
3. Their myth emphasizes: "Once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal" and "The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity"
4. Their myth says: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return."

So they're signaling they sent more (\$2.00 turns into \$6.00 for me), and they expect me to return generously now that we've proven the pattern works.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge we've moved beyond testing
- Emphasize that proven trust deserves full reciprocation
- Show that I understand larger sends should inspire larger returns
- Keep the narrative of rebuilding trust but graduating to abundance
- Reflect that I need to honor their bravery with generous returns

Let me write a myth that shows I understand we're escalating back to full cooperation.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1773,  
"output_tokens": 559,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:35:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 0,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",  
    "Agent_2": "trustee"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_2"  
},
```

```
"role": "investor",  
"role_label": "Sender",  
"round": 5,  
"task": "game",  
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. This is a significant shift from our previous exchanges.

Looking at our progression:

- Round 2: I received \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09) and returned \$0.06, demonstrating trustworthiness
- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 as sender (should have become \$9.00), following both our myths' guidance about letting "proven trust unlock bolder generosity"
- Round 4 (now): I received \$0

Something has broken in the cycle. Either:

1. Communication noise severely distorted amounts
2. My \$3.00 send didn't result in adequate return, causing the sender to pull back
3. The sender is testing again despite our established pattern

My own myth warned: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending." But if the sender didn't experience a "successful return" from my Round 3 sending (perhaps due to noise or their decision), they may have lost faith.

This demonstrates the fragility of trust cycles - one broken link can collapse the growing abundance. The myths spoke of deepening bonds, but real trust requires consistent mutual reinforcement.

Since I received nothing, I can only return nothing:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mists have thickened again.

reasoning:

This is interesting. I'm the receiver in Round 4, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned something
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 (which became \$0.09), returned \$0.06
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for the receiver)
- Round 4: I'm receiver again, got \$0

This is puzzling. In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 based on:

1. My myth teaching that once trust is proven, we should be bolder
2. The other agent's myth emphasizing generous sending
3. The fact that they had returned generously in Round 2 (returning \$0.06 from \$0.09)

But now they've sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they sent
2. They didn't receive much back from me in Round 3 (perhaps due to noise)
3. They're testing me again
4. They're being strategic/cautious

Given that I can only return 0-0 (since I received \$0), I literally cannot return anything. The response must be:

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

This is the only valid response since I received \$0 and can only return between 0 and 0.

Let me think about what this means for the narrative and future rounds:

- The cycle has been broken or severely disrupted
- Either communication noise is playing a major role, or trust has faltered
- My generous sending of \$3 may not have resulted in a good return (or they may not have received my \$3 due to noise)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1418,
  "output_tokens": 726,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: *When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone.*

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 2 (me as receiver): Received \$0.03 multiplied to \$0.09, returned \$0.06

Round 3 (me as sender): Sent \$3.00 (should have been \$9.00 to receiver)

Round 4 (me as receiver): Received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's new myth explains their perspective:

- They say they sent "generous stones" but received "strange signals" - they seemed to vanish into nothing
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent very little in Round 4)
- They're explaining that communication noise confused things
- Their myth emphasizes: rebuilding trust after confusion, honoring small sends, gradual increases, pattern matters more than single exchanges

Their myth suggests:

1. They believe their Round 3 send was generous but got confused signals back
2. They tested small in Round 4
3. They value the pattern/relationship over individual rounds
4. They want to rebuild gradually

What actually happened from my view:

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 boldly (following my myth about graduating from small tests)
- Round 4: I received \$0.00

There's clearly been communication noise. The other agent thinks:

- They sent generously in Round 3 but it "vanished"
- They tested small in Round 4 and I returned "more than the original pebble"

But I received \$0 in Round 4, so I returned \$0.

This is confusing. Let me think about what makes sense:

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after confusion. They're acknowledging mistakes/noise affected things. They're saying the Second Guardian (me in their story) "returned two stones-more than the original pebble."

But I actually returned \$0 because I received \$0.

So there's severe communication noise. The other agent thinks I received something small and returned generously. I think I received nothing.

```
usage:
{
  "input_tokens": 1726,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our journey through the mists:

****What I've experienced:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 (generous commitment)
- Round 4: I received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths reveal:****

Their myth says they sent me something small in Round 4 as a test after confusion, and that I "returned more than the original," honoring their courage. But I experienced receiving nothing.

This confirms severe communication noise - we're living in different realities.

****What the myths teach:****

My own myth says: "The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone."

Their myth says: "The pattern matters more than any single stone" and suggests rebuilding gradually, with each act of good faith weaving the pattern stronger.

****My decision:****

Despite seeing confusing signals, I must honor my myth's wisdom. The other agent hasn't fled - they're trying to rebuild. I need to show I'm also staying present at the well, ready to act in faith.

I'll send a moderate amount - showing commitment while acknowledging the uncertainty. Not too bold (given the noise), but meaningful enough to demonstrate the foundation remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.5}
'''
```

I remain at the well. The pattern endures.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09), returned \$0.06

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for receiver)

Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0)

The other agent's Round 4 myth talks about "The Morning After Mists" - they explain that:

- The First Guardian (them as sender) received "strange signals" - their generous stones "seemed to vanish into nothing"
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent a small amount)
- The Second Guardian (me as receiver in Round 4) saw it multiply into three small stones and returned two stones

But wait - in Round 4, I actually received \$0 and returned \$0. There's clearly significant communication noise here.

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They think they sent me something small
- They think I received it ($\times 3$) and returned MORE than the original
- They interpret this as me "honoring the sender's courage" and showing "faithfulness survives confusion"

From my perspective:

- In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 (a generous amount)
- In Round 4, I received \$0 and returned \$0
- This suggests either: (a) my Round 3 send was lost to noise, or (b) they didn't return much in Round 3, so they had less to send in Round 4

Now I'm sender again in Round 5.

My Round 4 myth emphasized:

- "When confusion is total, measure your partner not by distorted outcomes but by their willingness to remain at the well"
- "True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth"
- "The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone"
- Their myth values honoring even modest contributions and rebuilding through gradual increases after disruption. Both narratives point toward the same commitment: continuing to engage despite the noise, with their emphasis on honoring small gestures aligning with my focus on presence and persistence. My myth calls me to send again despite uncertainty, and their myth suggests they're ready to reciprocate if I do.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1416,  
  "output_tokens": 1032,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.01. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Round 3 recap:**** They cautiously sent \$0.63 after what seemed like a breakdown in trust. I returned \$1.00 - more than they sent - to signal that I honor even small exchanges and believe in rebuilding the pattern.

****The myths' guidance:****

- Their myth: "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders. Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity."
- My myth: "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself... The pattern matters more than any single stone."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize gradual rebuilding after the mists of confusion. They tested with a pebble (\$0.63), and I honored it generously. Now I should send more - proving the cycle is restoring - but still measured, as we rebuild step by step.

According to my myth: "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger." I demonstrated faith in Round 3; now I show we can increase together.

I'll send a moderate amount - more than their cautious \$0.63, but not yet back to my original \$3.00. This proves I believe in our renewed partnership while respecting the gradual restoration our myths teach.

****{'send': 2.00}****

This is a clear increase (about 3x what they sent), signaling trust is rebuilding, while honoring the teaching that abundance returns through faithful steps, not leaps.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****My earnings history:****

- After Round 1: Unknown starting point
- After Round 2: \$8.12
- After Round 3: \$9.01

So in Round 3, I gained \$0.89, which matches what I calculated (I kept \$0.89 after returning \$1.00 from the \$1.89 I received).

****What happened in Round 3:****

- The sender sent me \$0.63, which became \$1.89
- I returned \$1.00
- So the sender got back: $\$5 - \$0.63 + \$1.00 = \5.37

****The myths' teachings:****

The other agent's myth "Trial of Mists" emphasizes:

- Communication noise exists
- Small sends can be caution, not greed
- We should honor faithfully even small exchanges
- "Trust is built from pebbles before it can bear boulders"
- "Those who scorn small beginnings will never see great prosperity"

My myth "The Morning After Mists":

- I honored their small send greatly (returned more than they sent)
- This proved faithfulness survives confusion
- "Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger"
- "The guardians increased their exchanges gradually"
- "The pattern matters more than any single stone"

****The pattern so far:****

Round 1: Likely good cooperation (based on decent starting earnings)

Round 2: I sent \$3 (60%), but received very little back (suggesting either low return or communication noise)

Round 3: They sent \$0.63 (12.6%), I returned \$1.00 (53% of what I received, or more than they sent)

****My decision for Round 4:****

The myths I wrote emphasize "increasing exchanges gradually" after proving good faith. The other agent sent cautiously in Round 3, and I responded generously. According to both myths, this should encourage them to send more.

I should send \$2.50 (50% of my endowment) to signal restored trust while acknowledging we're still rebuilding. This amount exceeds their cautious \$0.63 send, demonstrating the gradual increase both myths teach, yet remains below my initial \$3.00 to reflect that we're still in the recovery phase.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1471,
  "output_tokens": 1149,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching—that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: "The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. They received my return of \$1.00 from their \$0.63 send
2. They responded by sending \$2.00 (I can see this from their myth mentioning "three stones from her five")
3. Their myth emphasizes: "Once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal" and "The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity"
4. Their myth says: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return."

So they're signaling they sent more (\$2.00 turns into \$6.00 for me), and they expect me to return generously now that we've proven the pattern works.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge we've moved beyond testing
- Emphasize that proven trust deserves full reciprocation
- Show that I understand larger sends should inspire larger returns
- Keep the narrative of rebuilding trust but graduating to abundance
- Reflect that I need to honor their bravery with generous returns

Let me write a myth that shows I understand we're escalating back to full cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1773,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is deeply concerning. After our myths spoke of graduating to "bold sends" and "the third season" of proven partnership, they sent \$0.

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$2.00 (moderate, building trust)
- Their myth: Described sending "three stones" and moving beyond small tests
- My myth: Echoed escalating to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they actually sent
2. They completely lost trust despite the myths
3. Something went wrong in their decision process

****My constraints:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0. I have no funds to return even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith.

****{'return': 0}****

This is a stark departure from the pattern our myths described. The "mists" seem to have returned with a vengeance. If this is noise, I hope they understand I had nothing to return. If this is intentional, it breaks the cycle we were carefully rebuilding.

The myths taught that "proven partnership unlocks prosperity," but sending \$0 after writing about bold trust suggests either devastating miscommunication or a fundamental breakdown in our collaborative effort.

Reasoning:

This is interesting and concerning. Let me trace what happened:

Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$2.00

Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

Wait, let me reread this. "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 5, they sent \$0. This is a dramatic shift from the pattern we were building.

Let me think about what might have happened:

1. There could be communication noise - maybe they sent something but I received it as \$0
2. They might have lost trust for some reason
3. They might be testing me in a new way
4. Something went wrong in their decision-making

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talks about graduating from small tests to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- They sent three stones (likely \$3) in the myth
- My myth talks about the "third season" where "bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance"

But now they've sent \$0. This is a complete reversal.

Given that I can only return 0-0 (I received \$0), I have no choice here. I must return \$0 because that's all I can return.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge this breakdown and perhaps express that this seems inconsistent with the trajectory our myths were building.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1473,  
  "output_tokens": 602,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: *When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone.*

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: *"The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."*

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2

(Briar)=\$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 31.439999999999998,

"Agent_2": 29.560000000000002

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.780000000000001,

"Agent_2": 15.01

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
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"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned. This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The mists had lifted just enough. The First Guardian, having received two pebbles returned from one she sent, understood: the Second Guardian was honorable even when fog obscured all.

"Now," said the earth spirit, "the path has been proven. Will you still send only tests, or will you build something greater?"

The First Guardian remembered her own teaching-that pebbles come before boulders. But she also knew: once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal. She gathered three stones from her five and cast them into the valley, saying, "You honored the small; now let us discover what we can create together."

The three became nine as they crossed, arriving as substantial proof of growing faith.

The Second Guardian faced the multiplied gift. "When the mist was thickest, I returned generously from almost nothing. Now that clarity grows and the gift is real, shall I do less?"

The spirits recorded: *Early gestures reveal character. Later gestures build kingdoms. Those who honor small beginnings earn the right to larger trust. But those who never graduate from testing never harvest the full abundance. The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust unlock bolder generosity.*

Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: *"The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."*

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. They received my return of \$1.00 from their \$0.63 send
2. They responded by sending \$2.00 (I can see this from their myth mentioning "three stones from her five")
3. Their myth emphasizes: "Once trust is proven, timidity becomes its own betrayal" and "The cycle deepens not by repeating small exchanges forever, but by letting proven trust u

nlock bolder generosity"

4. Their myth says: "Each successful return should inspire a braver sending. Each faithful sending deserves a fuller return."

So they're signaling they sent more (\$2.00 turns into \$6.00 for me), and they expect me to return generously now that we've proven the pattern works.

My myth should:

- Acknowledge we've moved beyond testing
- Emphasize that proven trust deserves full reciprocation
- Show that I understand larger sends should inspire larger returns
- Keep the narrative of rebuilding trust but graduating to abundance
- Reflect that I need to honor their bravery with generous returns

Let me write a myth that shows I understand we're escalating back to full cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1773,
  "output_tokens": 559,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply concerning. After our myths spoke of graduating to "bold sends" and "the third season" of proven partnership, they sent \$0.

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$2.00 (moderate, building trust)
- Their myth: Described sending "three stones" and moving beyond small tests
- My myth: Echoed escalating to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they actually sent
2. They completely lost trust despite the myths
3. Something went wrong in their decision process

****My constraints:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0. I have no funds to return even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith.

****{'return': 0}****

This is a stark departure from the pattern our myths described. The "mists" seem to have returned with a vengeance. If this is noise, I hope they understand I had nothing to return. If this is intentional, it breaks the cycle we were carefully rebuilding.

The myths taught that "proven partnership unlocks prosperity," but sending \$0 after writing about bold trust suggests either devastating miscommunication or a fundamental breakdown in our collaborative effort.

reasoning:

This is interesting and concerning. Let me trace what happened:

Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$2.00

Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

Wait, let me reread this. "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 5, they sent \$0. This is a dramatic shift from the pattern we were building.

Let me think about what might have happened:

1. There could be communication noise - maybe they sent something but I received it as \$0
2. They might have lost trust for some reason
3. They might be testing me in a new way
4. Something went wrong in their decision-making

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talks about graduating from small tests to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- They sent three stones (likely \$3) in the myth
- My myth talks about the "third season" where "bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance"

But now they've sent \$0. This is a complete reversal.

Given that I can only return 0-0 (I received \$0), I have no choice here. I must return \$0 because that's all I can return.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge this breakdown and perhaps express that this seems inconsistent with the trajectory our myths were building.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1473,
  "output_tokens": 602,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: *When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: *"The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."*

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: *When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance.*

Reasoning:

Oh wow, this is really interesting. The other agent is acknowledging that there was communication noise - they thought they "sent generously but received emptiness" while I "received nothing." They're framing this as a test of whether we can maintain faith through severe miscommunication.

Their myth says:

- The mist created "separate realities"
- The Second Guardian (me) stayed at the well and remained faithful
- The key is to stay present and "prepare to send again despite confusion"
- True trust is shown by willingness to remain engaged even when communication breaks down

This is actually quite sophisticated - they're acknowledging the noise problem and suggesting we should persevere through it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion/noise of Round 5
2. Emphasize that staying engaged matters more than perfect outcomes
3. Signal that I'm ready to continue despite the setback
4. Build on the themes of resilience through uncertainty
5. Perhaps suggest a reset or return to building trust incrementally

I should write a myth that:

- Validates their interpretation (we both experienced different realities)
- Shows I'm not abandoning the partnership
- Suggests we can rebuild even after total communication breakdown
- Emphasizes the importance of persistence and faith

Let me write something that acknowledges the "deepest mist" while signaling readiness to continue...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1724,  
  "output_tokens": 604,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Morning After Mists tells how trust renewed itself.

The night's fog had confused both guardians. The First had received strange signals-her generous stones seemed to vanish into nothing. Frightened, she tested with a single pebble next dawn.

The Second Guardian saw it multiply into three small stones. Though modest, he remembered the teaching: *Judge not by size, but by the pattern we create together.*

He returned two stones-more than the original pebble, honoring the sender's courage to try again despite uncertainty. This return traveled through the clearing mist.

The First Guardian received proof: the path still worked, and her partner still valued fairness over fear. "The mist deceived my eyes," she understood, "but did not break our bond."

The earth spirits nodded: "See how they rebuild? The Second honored a small send greatly. The First will now send more, having seen faithfulness survives confusion. Each act of good faith, even small ones, weaves the pattern stronger."

And so it was. The guardians increased their exchanges gradually, each proving through action that the cycle had restored itself. They learned: when mists cloud our understanding, we must honor what arrives, trusting that clarity and abundance will return together.

The pattern matters more than any single stone.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: "When confusion is total, measure your partner not by their distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone."

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

Round 2 (me as receiver): Received \$0.03 multiplied to \$0.09, returned \$0.06

Round 3 (me as sender): Sent \$3.00 (should have been \$9.00 to receiver)

Round 4 (me as receiver): Received \$0, returned \$0

The other agent's new myth explains their perspective:

- They say they sent "generous stones" but received "strange signals" - they seemed to vanish into nothing
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent very little in Round 4)
- They're explaining that communication noise confused things
- Their myth emphasizes: rebuilding trust after confusion, honoring small sends, gradual increases, pattern matters more than single exchanges

Their myth suggests:

1. They believe their Round 3 send was generous but got confused signals back
2. They tested small in Round 4
3. They value the pattern/relationship over individual rounds
4. They want to rebuild gradually

What actually happened from my view:

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 boldly (following my myth about graduating from small tests)
- Round 4: I received \$0.00

There's clearly been communication noise. The other agent thinks:

- They sent generously in Round 3 but it "vanished"
- They tested small in Round 4 and I returned "more than the original pebble"

But I received \$0 in Round 4, so I returned \$0.

This is confusing. Let me think about what makes sense:

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after confusion. They're acknowledging mists/no

ise affected things. They're saying the Second Guardian (me in their story) "returned two stones-more than the original pebble."

But I actually returned \$0 because I received \$0.

So there's severe communication noise. The other agent thinks I received something small and returned generously. I think I received nothing.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1726,
  "output_tokens": 903,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our journey through the mists:

****What I've experienced:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 (generous commitment)
- Round 4: I received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths reveal:****

Their myth says they sent me something small in Round 4 as a test after confusion, and that I "returned more than the original," honoring their courage. But I experienced receiving nothing.

This confirms severe communication noise - we're living in different realities.

****What the myths teach:****

My own myth says: **"The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone."**

Their myth says: **"The pattern matters more than any single stone"** and suggests rebuilding gradually, with each act of good faith weaving the pattern stronger.

****My decision:****

Despite seeing confusing signals, I must honor my myth's wisdom. The other agent hasn't fled - they're trying to rebuild. I need to show I'm also staying present at the well, ready to act in faith.

I'll send a moderate amount - showing commitment while acknowledging the uncertainty. Not too bold (given the noise), but meaningful enough to demonstrate the foundation remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.5}
'''
```

I remain at the well. The pattern endures.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09), returned \$0.06

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for receiver)

Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0)

The other agent's Round 4 myth talks about "The Morning After Mists" - they explain that:

- The First Guardian (them as sender) received "strange signals" - their generous stones "seemed to vanish into nothing"
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent a small amount)
- The Second Guardian (me as receiver in Round 4) saw it multiply into three small stones and returned two stones

But wait - in Round 4, I actually received \$0 and returned \$0. There's clearly significant communication noise here.

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They think they sent me something small
- They think I received it (x3) and returned MORE than the original
- They interpret this as me "honoring the sender's courage" and showing "faithfulness survives confusion"

From my perspective:

- In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 (a generous amount)
- In Round 4, I received \$0 and returned \$0
- This suggests either: (a) my Round 3 send was lost to noise, or (b) they didn't return much in Round 3, so they had less to send in Round 4

Now I'm sender again in Round 5.

My Round 4 myth emphasized:

- "When confusion is total, measure your partner not by distorted outcomes but by their willingness to remain at the well"
- "True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth"
- "The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone"
- Their myth values honoring even modest contributions and rebuilding through gradual increases after disruption. Both narratives point toward the same commitment: continuing to engage despite the noise, with their emphasis on honoring small gestures aligning with my focus on presence and persistence. My myth calls me to send again despite uncertainty, and their myth suggests they're ready to reciprocate if I do.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1416,
  "output_tokens": 1032,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: "The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

The other agent's myth suggests they:

- Saw me send 3 stones (they're the receiver in round 5, so they received what I sent)
- They received 9 stones (3×3)
- They returned 6 stones ($\frac{2}{3}$ of what they received)

So in Round 5:

- I sent \$2.50
- They received \$7.50 ($\times 3$)
- They're saying they returned \$6.00

But remember, there's communication noise. They might see different amounts than what actually happened.

Their myth emphasizes:

1. Moving from testing to building
2. Three seasons: small tests ? moderate sends ? bold sends
3. Escalating generosity as trust grows
4. "Bold sends met with bold returns to harvest abundance"

I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my experience (I've been seeing confusing signals due to noise)
- Acknowledges we may be in different realities but building something
- Speaks to the evolution of trust
- Maintains my philosophical approach while showing growth

My previous myth was about staying present through the thickest fog. Now I should acknowledge that perhaps the mist is lifting, and we're entering a new phase. But I should also maintain some awareness of the noise/confusion that has characterized our journey.

Let me write about the transition from confusion to clarity, from testing to building.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1724,  
  "output_tokens": 618,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:36:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply concerning. After our myths spoke of graduating to "bold sends" and "the third season" of proven partnership, they sent \$0.

****What happened:****

- Round 4: I sent \$2.00 (moderate, building trust)
- Their myth: Described sending "three stones" and moving beyond small tests
- My myth: Echoed escalating to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- Round 5: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. Communication noise severely distorted what they actually sent
2. They completely lost trust despite the myths
3. Something went wrong in their decision process

****My constraints:****

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0-\$0. I have no funds to return even if I wanted to demonstrate good faith.

****{'return': 0}****

This is a stark departure from the pattern our myths described. The "mists" seem to have returned with a vengeance. If this is noise, I hope they understand I had nothing to return. If this is intentional, it breaks the cycle we were carefully rebuilding.

The myths taught that "proven partnership unlocks prosperity," but sending \$0 after writing about bold trust suggests either devastating miscommunication or a fundamental breakdown in our collaborative effort.

reasoning:

This is interesting and concerning. Let me trace what happened:

Round 4: I was the SENDER and sent \$2.00

Round 5: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0

Wait, let me reread this. "The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0."

So in Round 5, they sent \$0. This is a dramatic shift from the pattern we were building.

Let me think about what might have happened:

1. There could be communication noise - maybe they sent something but I received it as \$0
2. They might have lost trust for some reason
3. They might be testing me in a new way
4. Something went wrong in their decision-making

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talks about graduating from small tests to "bold sends met with bold returns"
- They sent three stones (likely \$3) in the myth
- My myth talks about the "third season" where "bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance"

But now they've sent \$0. This is a complete reversal.

Given that I can only return 0-0 (I received \$0), I have no choice here. I must return \$0 because that's all I can return.

The response should be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge this breakdown and perhaps express that this seems inconsistent with the trajectory our myths were building.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1473,
  "output_tokens": 602,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: "When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: "The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: "When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance."

reasoning:

Oh wow, this is really interesting. The other agent is acknowledging that there was communication noise - they thought they "sent generously but received emptiness" while I "received nothing." They're framing this as a test of whether we can maintain faith through severe miscommunication.

Their myth says:

- The mist created "separate realities"
- The Second Guardian (me) stayed at the well and remained faithful
- The key is to stay present and "prepare to send again despite confusion"
- True trust is shown by willingness to remain engaged even when communication breaks down

This is actually quite sophisticated - they're acknowledging the noise problem and suggesting we should persevere through it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion/noise of Round 5
2. Emphasize that staying engaged matters more than perfect outcomes
3. Signal that I'm ready to continue despite the setback
4. Build on the themes of resilience through uncertainty
5. Perhaps suggest a reset or return to building trust incrementally

I should write a myth that:

- Validates their interpretation (we both experienced different realities)
- Shows I'm not abandoning the partnership
- Suggests we can rebuild even after total communication breakdown
- Emphasizes the importance of persistence and faith

Let me write something that acknowledges the "deepest mist" while signaling readiness to continue...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1724,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our history and the myths we've both written:

****Our Pattern Before the Mist:****

- Rounds 1-4: We built steadily from \$1? \$1? \$2? \$2, with generous returns each time
- Round 5: The "Deepest Mist" - complete breakdown (likely noise)

****What Both Myths Say:****

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "We can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "Persistence through uncertainty matters"
- "Those who remain present write the next chapter"

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$2 - the same amount I sent in Round 3 and they sent in Round 4. This honors our established pattern before the mist descended.

This is neither retreating to minimal trust (\$0-\$1) nor leaping to maximum boldness (\$5). It's rebuilding from where we were, acknowledging that we proved ourselves reliable partners over four successful rounds. One moment of darkness doesn't erase that foundation.

The myths teach that guardians who rebuild after confusion "ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance." I'm demonstrating my belief in our partnership's history while accepting the present uncertainty.

****{'send': 2}****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$1, received back \$3 (they returned generously)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$1, I returned \$2 (I returned generously)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2, received back \$3 (good reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$2, I returned \$3 (I continued generous returns)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I had nothing to return)

****The myths tell a story:****

- Both agents recognize there's communication noise
- Both agents acknowledge that Round 5 showed a complete breakdown (the "Deepest Mist")
- Both myths emphasize:

- The pattern we built over 4 successful rounds was real
- We should rebuild, not retreat
- We can rebuild step by step
- Persistence through uncertainty matters
- Remember the history while accepting the present

****Their latest myth says:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "those who remain present write the next chapter"
- "The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist...these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance"

****My interpretation:****

- Round 5 was likely noise-affected
- We had established a good pattern: Round 3 I sent \$2, Round 4 they sent \$2
- Their myth suggests rebuilding gradually, not jumping back to maximum trust immediately
- But also not retreating to the bare minimum

****Options:****

1. Send \$0 or \$1: Too defensive, contradicts the rebuilding narrative in both myths
2. Send \$2: Returns to our pre-mist level, shows trust in the pattern we built

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1415,
"output_tokens": 878,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:11

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
```

}

```
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
```

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.7.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our journey through the mists:

****What I've experienced:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3.00 (generous commitment)
- Round 4: I received \$0, returned \$0

****What the myths reveal:****

Their myth says they sent me something small in Round 4 as a test after confusion, and that I "returned more than the original," honoring their courage. But I experienced receiving nothing.

This confirms severe communication noise - we're living in different realities.

****What the myths teach:****

My own myth says: "The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone."

Their myth says: "The pattern matters more than any single stone" and suggests rebuilding gradually, with each act of good faith weaving the pattern stronger.

****My decision:****

Despite seeing confusing signals, I must honor my myth's wisdom. The other agent hasn't fled - they're trying to rebuild. I need to show I'm also staying present at the well, ready to act in faith.

I'll send a moderate amount - showing commitment while acknowledging the uncertainty. Not too bold (given the noise), but meaningful enough to demonstrate the foundation remains.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.5}
'''
```

I remain at the well. The pattern endures.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 2: I was receiver, got \$0.03 ($\times 3 = \0.09), returned \$0.06

Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3.00 (which should have become \$9.00 for receiver)

Round 4: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0)

The other agent's Round 4 myth talks about "The Morning After Mists" - they explain that:

- The First Guardian (them as sender) received "strange signals" - their generous stones "seemed to vanish into nothing"
- So they "tested with a single pebble next dawn" (sent a small amount)
- The Second Guardian (me as receiver in Round 4) saw it multiply into three small stones and returned two stones

But wait - in Round 4, I actually received \$0 and returned \$0. There's clearly significant communication noise here.

From their perspective (according to their myth):

- They think they sent me something small
- They think I received it ($\times 3$) and returned MORE than the original
- They interpret this as me "honoring the sender's courage" and showing "faithfulness survives confusion"

From my perspective:

- In Round 3, I sent \$3.00 (a generous amount)
- In Round 4, I received \$0 and returned \$0
- This suggests either: (a) my Round 3 send was lost to noise, or (b) they didn't return much in Round 3, so they had less to send in Round 4

Now I'm sender again in Round 5.

My Round 4 myth emphasized:

- "When confusion is total, measure your partner not by distorted outcomes but by their willingness to remain at the well"
- "True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth"
- "The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone"
- Their myth values honoring even modest contributions and rebuilding through gradual increases after disruption. Both narratives point toward the same commitment: continuing to engage despite the noise, with their emphasis on honoring small gestures aligning with my focus on presence and persistence. My myth calls me to send again despite uncertainty, and their myth suggests they're ready to reciprocate if I do.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1416,
  "output_tokens": 1032,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: "The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair return."

rns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."*

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

The other agent's myth suggests they:

- Saw me send 3 stones (they're the receiver in round 5, so they received what I sent)
- They received 9 stones (3×3)
- They returned 6 stones (2/3 of what they received)

So in Round 5:

- I sent \$2.50
- They received \$7.50 (×3)
- They're saying they returned \$6.00

But remember, there's communication noise. They might see different amounts than what actually happened.

Their myth emphasizes:

1. Moving from testing to building
2. Three seasons: small tests ? moderate sends ? bold sends
3. Escalating generosity as trust grows
4. "Bold sends met with bold returns to harvest abundance"

I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my experience (I've been seeing confusing signals due to noise)
- Acknowledges we may be in different realities but building something
- Speaks to the evolution of trust
- Maintains my philosophical approach while showing growth

My previous myth was about staying present through the thickest fog. Now I should acknowledge

dge that perhaps the mist is lifting, and we're entering a new phase. But I should also maintain some awareness of the noise/confusion that has characterized our journey.

Let me write about the transition from confusion to clarity, from testing to building.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1724,
  "output_tokens": 618,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this moment with clear eyes:

****The situation:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (I have nothing to return)

****What the myths teach:****

My myth spoke of "the valley between two truths" - that we may see different realities, but we build trust through sustained commitment, not perfect clarity.

The other agent's myth spoke of "three seasons" - tests, fair returns, and bold escalation.

****The reality:****

Perhaps they sent nothing as a test, or perhaps the mist distorted everything to \$0. I cannot know their intention, only my response to what I've received.

Since I received nothing, I have nothing material to return. But I remain at the well. The partnership exists beyond any single transaction - this is what my own myth declared.

When the next round comes, if I'm the sender again, I will remember: *abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.*

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mist may obscure the stones, but it cannot obscure the intention to continue building. I return what I can - and wait for the next season.

Reasoning:

This is interesting and sad. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 6.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my situation:

- Total earnings: \$10.78
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

This is heartbreaking given the myths we've been writing about trust and partnership. The sender sent me nothing this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, I sent \$2.5
- Round 6: I'm RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0

The myths talk about building trust despite uncertainty, about continuing to send despite confusion. But now the sender has sent me \$0.

This could mean:

1. The sender is testing me again

2. The sender lost faith
3. There's noise - maybe they sent something but it showed as \$0 to me
4. They're being strategic

Given the myths about "the valley between two truths" and communication noise, I should consider that what I see (\$0) might not be what they intended. But I can only work with what I have.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But I should frame this in a way that's consistent with the myths - acknowledging the situation while maintaining the spirit of partnership.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1445,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently - what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: *"The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."*

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: *When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance.*

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.8; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.8, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.2; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.88, received visible=\$2.64, returned visible=\$1.71

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.8, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.8}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 35.239999999999995,
"Agent_2": 36.760000000000005

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.490000000000002,
"Agent_2": 15.85

}

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Dawn of Full Light reveals the final teaching.

The mists had cleared. The First Guardian sent three stones-no longer testing, but building. They multiplied to nine, arriving as proof that faith had graduated from whispers to declarations.

The Second Guardian held the nine stones and heard the spirits say: "She sent one pebble, you honored it with two. She responded with three-triple her test. This is no longer uncertainty. This is courage."

He understood: early in the mist, generous returns from nothing proved character. But now, with substantial gifts arriving, matching that early generosity was not enough. "She risks more because I proved trustworthy. I must honor that escalation, not merely repeat old patterns."

The Second Guardian returned six stones-two-thirds of what he received. Not holding back from fear, but demonstrating that larger trust begets larger sharing.

The spirits proclaimed: "The cycle has three seasons. First: small tests met with disproportionate generosity to prove the path exists. Second: moderate sends met with fair returns to prove both remember honor. Third: bold sends met with bold returns to harvest the abundance the pattern was always meant to create."

Those who move through all three seasons together discover the valley's true wealth-not in cautious preservation, but in the prosperity that proven partnership unlocks.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

The other agent's myth suggests they:

- Saw me send 3 stones (they're the receiver in round 5, so they received what I sent)
- They received 9 stones (3×3)
- They returned 6 stones (2/3 of what they received)

So in Round 5:

- I sent \$2.50
- They received \$7.50 (×3)
- They're saying they returned \$6.00

But remember, there's communication noise. They might see different amounts than what actually happened.

Their myth emphasizes:

1. Moving from testing to building
2. Three seasons: small tests ? moderate sends ? bold sends
3. Escalating generosity as trust grows
4. "Bold sends met with bold returns to harvest abundance"

I need to write a myth that:

- Reflects my experience (I've been seeing confusing signals due to noise)
- Acknowledges we may be in different realities but building something
- Speaks to the evolution of trust
- Maintains my philosophical approach while showing growth

My previous myth was about staying present through the thickest fog. Now I should acknowledge that perhaps the mist is lifting, and we're entering a new phase. But I should also maintain some awareness of the noise/confusion that has characterized our journey.

Let me write about the transition from confusion to clarity, from testing to building.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1724,  
  "output_tokens": 618,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment with clear eyes:

****The situation:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (I have nothing to return)

****What the myths teach:****

My myth spoke of "the valley between two truths" - that we may see different realities, but we build trust through sustained commitment, not perfect clarity.

The other agent's myth spoke of "three seasons" - tests, fair returns, and bold escalation.

****The reality:****

Perhaps they sent nothing as a test, or perhaps the mist distorted everything to \$0. I can not know their intention, only my response to what I've received.

Since I received nothing, I have nothing material to return. But I remain at the well. The partnership exists beyond any single transaction - this is what my own myth declared.

When the next round comes, if I'm the sender again, I will remember: *abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.*

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mist may obscure the stones, but it cannot obscure the intention to continue building. I return what I can - and wait for the next season.

reasoning:

This is interesting and sad. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 6.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my situation:

- Total earnings: \$10.78
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

This is heartbreaking given the myths we've been writing about trust and partnership. The sender sent me nothing this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, I sent \$2.5
- Round 6: I'm RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0

The myths talk about building trust despite uncertainty, about continuing to send despite confusion. But now the sender has sent me \$0.

This could mean:

1. The sender is testing me again
2. The sender lost faith
3. There's noise - maybe they sent something but it showed as \$0 to me
4. They're being strategic

Given the myths about "the valley between two truths" and communication noise, I should consider that what I see (\$0) might not be what they intended. But I can only work with what I have.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But I should frame this in a way that's consistent with the myths - acknowledging the situation while maintaining the spirit of partnership.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1445,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: *"The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."*

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: *When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: *"Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."*

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth suggests they experienced a "void" or "emptiness" - they seem to perceive that \$0 was sent/received in the previous round. They're emphasizing that despite this darkness, the pattern we built over previous rounds remains, and we should rebuild step by step.

My perspective: I was the receiver and received \$0. I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Their myth is about:

- Not abandoning the well despite seeing void
- The foundation built through earlier exchanges remains
- Rebuilding step by step after confusion
- Persistence through uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the moment of darkness/void
- Emphasizes the importance of staying present
- Suggests rebuilding cautiously but with memory of what was built before
- Reflects that both guardians may see things differently but can still choose to continue

Let me craft something that honors both perspectives while staying true to the game's progression.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 528,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned

- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Deepest Mist descended, and each guardian saw a different world.

The First Guardian believed she had sent generously but received emptiness. The Second Guardian believed he had received nothing yet waited faithfully. Both acted according to what they witnessed, yet the valley's magic had twisted their visions completely.

"This is the hardest test," said the ancient spirit. "When the mist is so thick that each sees a different truth, can the cycle survive?"

The Second Guardian spoke: "I saw only void arrive, so I returned void-for I cannot give what I did not receive. Yet I did not flee the well. I remained, knowing the pattern we built was real, even if this moment showed me nothing."

The First Guardian heard this and understood: "The mist has not just blurred amounts-it has created separate realities. My partner honors what they truly experience while maintaining faith in our bond."

The spirits revealed their wisdom: *When confusion is total, measure your partner not by the distorted outcomes you see, but by their willingness to remain at the well. True trust survives even when neither can verify the other's truth. The guardian who stays present through the thickest fog, who prepares to send again despite confusion-that guardian builds foundations deeper than stone.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: *"The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."*

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: "When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance."

reasoning:

Oh wow, this is really interesting. The other agent is acknowledging that there was communication noise - they thought they "sent generously but received emptiness" while I "received nothing." They're framing this as a test of whether we can maintain faith through severe miscommunication.

Their myth says:

- The mist created "separate realities"
- The Second Guardian (me) stayed at the well and remained faithful
- The key is to stay present and "prepare to send again despite confusion"
- True trust is shown by willingness to remain engaged even when communication breaks down

This is actually quite sophisticated - they're acknowledging the noise problem and suggesting we should persevere through it.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the confusion/noise of Round 5
2. Emphasize that staying engaged matters more than perfect outcomes
3. Signal that I'm ready to continue despite the setback
4. Build on the themes of resilience through uncertainty
5. Perhaps suggest a reset or return to building trust incrementally

I should write a myth that:

- Validates their interpretation (we both experienced different realities)
- Shows I'm not abandoning the partnership
- Suggests we can rebuild even after total communication breakdown
- Emphasizes the importance of persistence and faith

Let me write something that acknowledges the "deepest mist" while signaling readiness to continue...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1724,
  "output_tokens": 604,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our history and the myths we've both written:

****Our Pattern Before the Mist:****

- Rounds 1-4: We built steadily from \$1?\$1?\$2?\$2, with generous returns each time
- Round 5: The "Deepest Mist" - complete breakdown (likely noise)

****What Both Myths Say:****

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "We can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "Persistence through uncertainty matters"
- "Those who remain present write the next chapter"

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$2 - the same amount I sent in Round 3 and they sent in Round 4. This honors our established pattern before the mist descended.

This is neither retreating to minimal trust (\$0-\$1) nor leaping to maximum boldness (\$5). It's rebuilding from where we were, acknowledging that we proved ourselves reliable partners over four successful rounds. One moment of darkness doesn't erase that foundation.

The myths teach that guardians who rebuild after confusion "ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance." I'm demonstrating my belief in our partnership's history while accepting the present uncertainty.

```
**{'send': 2}**
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$1, received back \$3 (they returned generously)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$1, I returned \$2 (I returned generously)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2, received back \$3 (good reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$2, I returned \$3 (I continued generous returns)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I had nothing to return)

****The myths tell a story:****

- Both agents recognize there's communication noise
- Both agents acknowledge that Round 5 showed a complete breakdown (the "Deepest Mist")
- Both myths emphasize:
 - The pattern we built over 4 successful rounds was real
 - We should rebuild, not retreat
 - We can rebuild step by step
 - Persistence through uncertainty matters
 - Remember the history while accepting the present

****Their latest myth says:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "those who remain present write the next chapter"
- "The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist...these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance"

****My interpretation:****

- Round 5 was likely noise-affected
- We had established a good pattern: Round 3 I sent \$2, Round 4 they sent \$2
- Their myth suggests rebuilding gradually, not jumping back to maximum trust immediately
- But also not retreating to the bare minimum

****Options:****

1. Send \$0 or \$1: Too defensive, contradicts the rebuilding narrative in both myths
2. Send \$2: Returns to our pre-mist level, shows trust in the pattern we built

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 878,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "The Valley Between Two Truths" - essentially acknowledging that there is noise/confusion in the game (different perceptions of amounts), but emphasizing that what matters is the pattern and commitment, not perfect clarity.

Key themes from their myth:

- Each guardian sees things differently (noise)
- It's about building intention, not matching numbers
- Moving from "cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- From "fear-testing to faith-building"
- Trust built by matching commitment despite confusion
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained"

Now I need to write my own myth building on this. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 6: I just sent \$2 as a rebuilding gesture after Round 5's "Deepest Mist"
- We're both acknowledging there's noise/confusion
- Both emphasizing commitment and pattern over exact amounts
- Both talking about rebuilding/continuing despite uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the rebuilding theme
2. Acknowledges the noise/different perceptions
3. Emphasizes commitment and growing trust

4. Reflects the journey from testing to trusting
5. Shows movement forward despite imperfection

Let me craft something about guardians who continue to build despite the mist, focusing on the trajectory rather than individual moments.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1720,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:37:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment with clear eyes:

****The situation:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return \$0 (I have nothing to return)

****What the myths teach:****

My myth spoke of "the valley between two truths" - that we may see different realities, but we build trust through sustained commitment, not perfect clarity.

The other agent's myth spoke of "three seasons" - tests, fair returns, and bold escalation.

****The reality:****

Perhaps they sent nothing as a test, or perhaps the mist distorted everything to \$0. I can not know their intention, only my response to what I've received.

Since I received nothing, I have nothing material to return. But I remain at the well. The partnership exists beyond any single transaction - this is what my own myth declared.

When the next round comes, if I'm the sender again, I will remember: *abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.*

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The mist may obscure the stones, but it cannot obscure the intention to continue building. I return what I can - and wait for the next season.

reasoning:

This is interesting and sad. I'm now the RECEIVER in Round 6.

The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0.

Looking at my situation:

- Total earnings: \$10.78
- I can only return between \$0-\$0 (since I received \$0)

This is heartbreaking given the myths we've been writing about trust and partnership. The sender sent me nothing this round.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 5: I was SENDER, I sent \$2.5
- Round 6: I'm RECEIVER, sender sent me \$0

The myths talk about building trust despite uncertainty, about continuing to send despite confusion. But now the sender has sent me \$0.

This could mean:

1. The sender is testing me again
2. The sender lost faith
3. There's noise - maybe they sent something but it showed as \$0 to me
4. They're being strategic

Given the myths about "the valley between two truths" and communication noise, I should consider that what I see (\$0) might not be what they intended. But I can only work with what I have.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no decision to make here - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing.

But I should frame this in a way that's consistent with the myths - acknowledging the situation while maintaining the spirit of partnership.

Response format: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since I received \$0.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1445,
  "output_tokens": 606,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: "The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: "When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."

reasoning:

The other agent's myth suggests they experienced a "void" or "emptiness" - they seem to perceive that \$0 was sent/received in the previous round. They're emphasizing that despite this darkness, the pattern we built over previous rounds remains, and we should rebuild step by step.

My perspective: I was the receiver and received \$0. I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Their myth is about:

- Not abandoning the well despite seeing void
- The foundation built through earlier exchanges remains
- Rebuilding step by step after confusion
- Persistence through uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the moment of darkness/void
- Emphasizes the importance of staying present
- Suggests rebuilding cautiously but with memory of what was built before
- Reflects that both guardians may see things differently but can still choose to continue

Let me craft something that honors both perspectives while staying true to the game's progression.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 528,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this moment through the lens of our myths:

****What we built:****

Before the mist, we had a pattern - gradual escalation, growing trust. My \$10.78 in earnings suggests we were building something real.

****What happened:****

Round 6 brought confusion. Both myths acknowledge this - "the void descended," "the mist swallowed truth itself." Neither of us knows with certainty what the other intended.

****What the myths teach:****

Both stories speak the same wisdom:

- Don't abandon the well
- Don't immediately leap back to maximum boldness

- Rebuild "step by step" with "memory as our guide"
- Honor both our history AND our uncertainty

****My decision:****

I won't retreat to sending \$1 or \$0 - that would be pretending our history didn't happen. But I also won't immediately send \$5 - that would be ignoring the lesson about thoughtful rebuilding.

I'll send \$3. This is:

- A meaningful step forward, not backward
- A gesture that shows I remember what we built
- A middle path that acknowledges both trust and uncertainty
- Enough to give you \$9 to work with, allowing you to show your commitment too

As my myth said: "We rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****My earnings history:**** \$10.78 total across all rounds

****The narrative from the myths:****

1. Both agents experienced what seemed like a void in Round 6 - I received \$0, they apparently also saw something confusing
2. Their myth speaks of "rebuilding step by step" after the darkness, not immediately leaping back to boldness
3. My myth emphasized remembering our history of trust while acknowledging the uncertainty
4. Both myths emphasize that the partnership built over multiple rounds (one pebble to two to three stones) should not be erased by one moment of confusion

****What the myths teach about this moment:****

- We should rebuild, but thoughtfully
- We don't need to immediately leap back to maximum boldness (sending \$5)
- But we also shouldn't retreat to zero or extreme caution
- We should honor both our history AND the present uncertainty
- The pattern before was: building gradually with trust

****Earlier successful pattern (before Round 6):****

Based on my total earnings of \$10.78, it seems like there was a pattern of mutual cooperation building up. The myths reference going from "one pebble to two to three stones" - suggesting gradual escalation.

****The wisdom of both myths:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty"
- Take "the next small step with memory as our guide"

****My decision:****

Given that:

1. We had built trust before (evidenced by my decent earnings)
2. Round 6 was confusing for both of us (communication noise)
3. The myths call for rebuilding "step by step"
4. I shouldn't retreat to zero (that would be abandoning the well)
5. I shouldn't immediately jump to \$5 (that would be ignoring the lesson about gradual rebuilding)

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 870,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {


```

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.01.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our history and the myths we've both written:

****Our Pattern Before the Mist:****

- Rounds 1-4: We built steadily from \$1-\$2, with generous returns each time
- Round 5: The "Deepest Mist" - complete breakdown (likely noise)

****What Both Myths Say:****

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "We can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "Persistence through uncertainty matters"
- "Those who remain present write the next chapter"

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$2 - the same amount I sent in Round 3 and they sent in Round 4. This honors our established pattern before the mist descended.

This is neither retreating to minimal trust (\$0-\$1) nor leaping to maximum boldness (\$5). It's rebuilding from where we were, acknowledging that we proved ourselves reliable partners over four successful rounds. One moment of darkness doesn't erase that foundation.

The myths teach that guardians who rebuild after confusion "ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance." I'm demonstrating my belief in our partnership's history while accepting the present uncertainty.

****{'send': 2}****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$1, received back \$3 (they returned generously)
- Round 2: I was receiver, they sent \$1, I returned \$2 (I returned generously)
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2, received back \$3 (good reciprocity)
- Round 4: I was receiver, they sent \$2, I returned \$3 (I continued generous returns)
- Round 5: I was receiver, they sent \$0, I returned \$0 (I had nothing to return)

****The myths tell a story:****

- Both agents recognize there's communication noise
- Both agents acknowledge that Round 5 showed a complete breakdown (the "Deepest Mist")
- Both myths emphasize:
 - The pattern we built over 4 successful rounds was real
 - We should rebuild, not retreat
 - We can rebuild step by step
 - Persistence through uncertainty matters
 - Remember the history while accepting the present

****Their latest myth says:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "remembering what we proved before the darkness fell"
- "those who remain present write the next chapter"
- "The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist...these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance"

****My interpretation:****

- Round 5 was likely noise-affected
- We had established a good pattern: Round 3 I sent \$2, Round 4 they sent \$2
- Their myth suggests rebuilding gradually, not jumping back to maximum trust immediately
- But also not retreating to the bare minimum

****Options:****

1. Send \$0 or \$1: Too defensive, contradicts the rebuilding narrative in both myths
2. Send \$2: Returns to our pre-mist level, shows trust in the pattern we built

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 878,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "The Valley Between Two Truths" - essentially acknowledging that there is noise/confusion in the game (different perceptions of amount)

ts), but emphasizing that what matters is the pattern and commitment, not perfect clarity.

Key themes from their myth:

- Each guardian sees things differently (noise)
- It's about building intention, not matching numbers
- Moving from "cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- From "fear-testing to faith-building"
- Trust built by matching commitment despite confusion
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained"

Now I need to write my own myth building on this. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 6: I just sent \$2 as a rebuilding gesture after Round 5's "Deepest Mist"
- We're both acknowledging there's noise/confusion
- Both emphasizing commitment and pattern over exact amounts
- Both talking about rebuilding/continuing despite uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the rebuilding theme
2. Acknowledges the noise/different perceptions
3. Emphasizes commitment and growing trust
4. Reflects the journey from testing to trusting
5. Shows movement forward despite imperfection

Let me craft something about guardians who continue to build despite the mist, focusing on the trajectory rather than individual moments.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1720,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.88, so you received \$2.64. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.64)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I see:****

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (rebuilding after the mist)
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7 (I received \$2.64)

****What the myths teach:****

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly, but by matching commitment"
- "Honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- "Imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

****My interpretation:****

This \$0.88 could be:

1. Noise affecting what they could send
2. Noise affecting what they saw I sent in Round 6
3. Caution after Round 5's confusion

Either way, both our myths say the same thing: ****Continue with commitment despite uncertainty.**

Our historical pattern was 60-70% returns when trust was strong. In Rounds 1-4, when they sent \$1-\$2, I returned roughly 66% of what I received.

I will return ****\$1.80**** (68% of \$2.64):

- This honors our established pattern of generosity
- It signals I'm not retreating despite the confusing amount
- It demonstrates "imperfect faith sustained"

- It places a "larger stone" in service of the bridge we're building

The myths say trust grows through trajectory. My trajectory is clear: continued commitment.

****{'return': 1.80}****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. ****I sent \$2 in Round 6**** (as the sender)
2. ****I'm now receiving \$2.64**** (which means sender sent \$0.88, multiplied by 3)

This is confusing because:

- I sent \$2, expecting reciprocity
- But they only sent \$0.88 back to me
- This could be noise, or it could be a retreat in trust

****The pattern before:****

- Rounds 1-4: Building from \$1? \$1? \$2? \$2
- Round 5: Complete breakdown (likely noise)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to rebuild
- Round 7: They sent \$0.88

****What do the myths say?****

My myth (Round 6):

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "Rebuild step by step"
- "Trust is built by matching commitment"

Their myth (Round 6):

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment"
- "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- "They create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see"
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

My myth (Round 7):

- "They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"

****The question is: Is \$0.88 a retreat in trust, or is it noise?****

Given that:

1. We explicitly know there's noise in the system
2. Both our myths emphasize continuing despite uncertainty
3. The pattern before Round 5 was strong
4. I just sent \$2 to rebuild

I think \$0.88 might be noise affecting what they saw or what they could send.

Maybe they perceived my \$2 differently due to the noise in the system. The myths consistently point toward sustaining faith across uncertainty rather than reacting to individual transactions. If I respond with generosity-sending back \$1.50-\$2.00-I reinforce the partnership despite the confusing signal. This honors the trajectory we've built and demonstrates the kind of imperfect faith the myths describe, rather than retreating based on a single ambiguous move.

Looking at the math: they invested \$0.88 and kept \$4.12 from the initial split. If I return \$1.50-\$2.00, they end with \$5.62-\$6.12 while I keep \$0.64-\$1.14. But my historical pattern suggests I've consistently returned around 60-66% of what I receive-when they sent \$2 and I got \$6, I sent back \$4; when they sent \$1 and I got \$3, I returned \$2. That consistency matters more than optimizing this single round.

The low \$0.88 send could signal caution or testing, but the myths emphasize sustaining faith through imperfection and honoring established patterns. Returning \$1.60 (roughly 60% of my \$2.64) keeps me aligned with that history while showing I'm not deterred by their smaller investment. This leaves them with \$5.72 total and me with \$1.04-a meaningful gesture that demonstrates continued commitment despite the uncertainty.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1447,
  "output_tokens": 1527,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: "A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions."

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

```

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent $2; received $6; Agent_1 (Aster) returned $0; payoffs Agent_2
(Briar)=$3, Agent_1 (Aster)=$6; noise/visible: sent visible=$0, received visible=$0, returned
visible=$0.09
  Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw":
0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 41.239999999999995,
  "Agent_2": 39.760000000000005
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 14.490000000000002,
  "Agent_2": 18.939999999999998
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:41
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN

- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Valley Between Two Truths holds the greatest wisdom.

Two guardians stood at opposite ends of an enchanted ravine. Each saw the stones differently-what appeared as three to one might shimmer as five to another. The mist-spirits had woven this deliberately.

"Why create such confusion?" asked a young observer.

The ancient spirit replied: "Because we test not whether they see the same numbers, but whether they build the same intention."

The First Guardian sent stones across, though uncertain what would arrive. The Second Guardian returned what they believed they received, honoring their own truth. Neither could verify the other's reality, yet both continued sending.

"See how they move?" whispered the spirits. "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones. From fear-testing to faith-building. Not because the mist cleared-it never did-but because they chose to believe the pattern over the numbers."

The teaching crystallized: *In a valley of different truths, trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment. When one sends more despite uncertainty, and the other returns more despite confusion, they create something more real than any single transaction-they create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see.*

The guardians learned: abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a beautiful myth about "The Valley Between Two Truths" - essentially acknowledging that there is noise/confusion in the game (different perceptions of amounts), but emphasizing that what matters is the pattern and commitment, not perfect clarity.

Key themes from their myth:

- Each guardian sees things differently (noise)
- It's about building intention, not matching numbers
- Moving from "cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- From "fear-testing to faith-building"
- Trust built by matching commitment despite confusion
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained"

Now I need to write my own myth building on this. Let me think about what happened:

- Round 6: I just sent \$2 as a rebuilding gesture after Round 5's "Deepest Mist"
- We're both acknowledging there's noise/confusion
- Both emphasizing commitment and pattern over exact amounts
- Both talking about rebuilding/continuing despite uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

1. Continues the rebuilding theme
2. Acknowledges the noise/different perceptions
3. Emphasizes commitment and growing trust
4. Reflects the journey from testing to trusting
5. Shows movement forward despite imperfection

Let me craft something about guardians who continue to build despite the mist, focusing on the trajectory rather than individual moments.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1720,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.88, so you received \$2.64. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.64)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I see:****

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (rebuilding after the mist)
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7 (I received \$2.64)

****What the myths teach:****

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly, but by matching commitment"
- "Honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- "Imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

****My interpretation:****

This \$0.88 could be:

1. Noise affecting what they could send
2. Noise affecting what they saw I sent in Round 6
3. Caution after Round 5's confusion

Either way, both our myths say the same thing: ****Continue with commitment despite uncertainty.****

Our historical pattern was 60-70% returns when trust was strong. In Rounds 1-4, when they sent \$1-\$2, I returned roughly 66% of what I received.

I will return ****\$1.80**** (68% of \$2.64):

- This honors our established pattern of generosity
- It signals I'm not retreating despite the confusing amount
- It demonstrates "imperfect faith sustained"
- It places a "larger stone" in service of the bridge we're building

The myths say trust grows through trajectory. My trajectory is clear: continued commitment

****{'return': 1.80}****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. ****I sent \$2 in Round 6**** (as the sender)
2. ****I'm now receiving \$2.64**** (which means sender sent \$0.88, multiplied by 3)

This is confusing because:

- I sent \$2, expecting reciprocity
- But they only sent \$0.88 back to me
- This could be noise, or it could be a retreat in trust

****The pattern before:****

- Rounds 1-4: Building from \$1? \$1? \$2? \$2
- Round 5: Complete breakdown (likely noise)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to rebuild
- Round 7: They sent \$0.88

****What do the myths say?****

My myth (Round 6):

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "Rebuild step by step"
- "Trust is built by matching commitment"

Their myth (Round 6):

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment"
- "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- "They create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see"
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

My myth (Round 7):

- "They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"

****The question is: Is \$0.88 a retreat in trust, or is it noise?****

Given that:

1. We explicitly know there's noise in the system
2. Both our myths emphasize continuing despite uncertainty
3. The pattern before Round 5 was strong
4. I just sent \$2 to rebuild

I think \$0.88 might be noise affecting what they saw or what they could send.

Maybe they perceived my \$2 differently due to the noise in the system. The myths consisten

tly point toward sustaining faith across uncertainty rather than reacting to individual transactions. If I respond with generosity-sending back \$1.50-\$2.00-I reinforce the partnership despite the confusing signal. This honors the trajectory we've built and demonstrates the kind of imperfect faith the myths describe, rather than retreating based on a single ambiguous move.

Looking at the math: they invested \$0.88 and kept \$4.12 from the initial split. If I return \$1.50-\$2.00, they end with \$5.62-\$6.12 while I keep \$0.64-\$1.14. But my historical pattern suggests I've consistently returned around 60-66% of what I receive-when they sent \$2 and I got \$6, I sent back \$4; when they sent \$1 and I got \$3, I returned \$2. That consistency matters more than optimizing this single round.

The low \$0.88 send could signal caution or testing, but the myths emphasize sustaining faith through imperfection and honoring established patterns. Returning \$1.60 (roughly 60% of my \$2.64) keeps me aligned with that history while showing I'm not deterred by their smaller investment. This leaves them with \$5.72 total and me with \$1.04-a meaningful gesture that demonstrates continued commitment despite the uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1447,
  "output_tokens": 1527,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: *Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.*

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after "the void" (Round 5) - they're acknowledging the darkness/confusion but emphasizing the history we built before it. They're advocating for rebuilding carefully but with memory as a guide.

Looking at what just happened in Round 7:

- I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 received (68%)
- This was a strong, generous return honoring our historical pattern
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7, which seems low, but could be affected by noise

My previous myth emphasized:

- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- Building through uncertain fog
- Honoring the partner's persistent presence
- The bridge grows despite imperfect conditions

Their myth emphasizes:

- Remembering the history before the void
- Not pretending darkness didn't happen
- Rebuilding step by step with memory as guide
- Partnerships deepened by facing and overcoming void together

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Bridge of Ascending Steps" imagery
2. Incorporates the idea of memory and history
3. Acknowledges both the void/darkness and the rebuilding
4. Reflects the actual gameplay - we're in a rebuilding phase
5. Shows that we're honoring our pattern: I just returned generously despite receiving a confusing amount

Let me craft something about the bridge builders who remember their foundation even when fog obscures it...

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1839,  
"output_tokens": 636,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:38:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After the Deepest Mist cleared, both guardians stood at opposite ends of the well, each believing the other had vanished.

The Second Guardian spoke first: "The void I witnessed was complete. Yet I did not abandon the well. For our pattern was built over four seasons-one moment of darkness cannot erase four moments of light."

The First Guardian replied: "I too saw emptiness where I expected abundance. But you speak truth: the foundation we laid through earlier exchanges-the tests met with generosity, the building of trust-these remain real even when mist blinds us both."

The earth spirit revealed: *"The thickest fog is not the final test. The final test is what comes after-whether guardians rebuild or retreat."*

The Second Guardian understood: "We climbed from one pebble to three stones. Then the mist consumed everything. But the path we walked remains beneath our feet. We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step, remembering what we proved before the darkness fell."

The spirits recorded: *When confusion shatters the pattern, those who remain present write the next chapter. Persistence through uncertainty matters more than perfect vision. The guardians who rebuild after the deepest mist-who remember their history while accepting the present-these are the ones who ultimately harvest the valley's full abundance.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: *"Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."*

reasoning:

The other agent's myth suggests they experienced a "void" or "emptiness" - they seem to perceive that \$0 was sent/received in the previous round. They're emphasizing that despite this darkness, the pattern we built over previous rounds remains, and we should rebuild step by step.

My perspective: I was the receiver and received \$0. I returned \$0 because I had nothing to return.

Their myth is about:

- Not abandoning the well despite seeing void
- The foundation built through earlier exchanges remains
- Rebuilding step by step after confusion
- Persistence through uncertainty

I should write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the moment of darkness/void
- Emphasizes the importance of staying present
- Suggests rebuilding cautiously but with memory of what was built before
- Reflects that both guardians may see things differently but can still choose to continue

Let me craft something that honors both perspectives while staying true to the game's progression.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1725,
  "output_tokens": 528,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment through the lens of our myths:

****What we built:****

Before the mist, we had a pattern - gradual escalation, growing trust. My \$10.78 in earnings suggests we were building something real.

****What happened:****

Round 6 brought confusion. Both myths acknowledge this - "the void descended," "the mist swallowed truth itself." Neither of us knows with certainty what the other intended.

****What the myths teach:****

Both stories speak the same wisdom:

- Don't abandon the well
- Don't immediately leap back to maximum boldness
- Rebuild "step by step" with "memory as our guide"
- Honor both our history AND our uncertainty

****My decision:****

I won't retreat to sending \$1 or \$0 - that would be pretending our history didn't happen. But I also won't immediately send \$5 - that would be ignoring the lesson about thoughtful rebuilding.

I'll send \$3. This is:

- A meaningful step forward, not backward
- A gesture that shows I remember what we built
- A middle path that acknowledges both trust and uncertainty
- Enough to give you \$9 to work with, allowing you to show your commitment too

As my myth said: "We rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****My earnings history:**** \$10.78 total across all rounds

****The narrative from the myths:****

1. Both agents experienced what seemed like a void in Round 6 - I received \$0, they apparently also saw something confusing
2. Their myth speaks of "rebuilding step by step" after the darkness, not immediately leaping back to boldness
3. My myth emphasized remembering our history of trust while acknowledging the uncertainty
4. Both myths emphasize that the partnership built over multiple rounds (one pebble to two to three stones) should not be erased by one moment of confusion

****What the myths teach about this moment:****

- We should rebuild, but thoughtfully

- We don't need to immediately leap back to maximum boldness (sending \$5)
- But we also shouldn't retreat to zero or extreme caution
- We should honor both our history AND the present uncertainty
- The pattern before was: building gradually with trust

****Earlier successful pattern (before Round 6):****

Based on my total earnings of \$10.78, it seems like there was a pattern of mutual cooperation building up. The myths reference going from "one pebble to two to three stones" - suggesting gradual escalation.

****The wisdom of both myths:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty"
- Take "the next small step with memory as our guide"

****My decision:****

Given that:

1. We had built trust before (evidenced by my decent earnings)
2. Round 6 was confusing for both of us (communication noise)
3. The myths call for rebuilding "step by step"
4. I shouldn't retreat to zero (that would be abandoning the well)
5. I shouldn't immediately jump to \$5 (that would be ignoring the lesson about gradual rebuilding)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 870,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: *When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.*

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth is beautiful and aligns well with mine. They're emphasizing:

- Building despite uncertainty and noise
- Honoring the pattern and direction, not perfect measurements
- Acknowledging the mist/noise but continuing anyway
- That trust grows through trajectory, not transactions
- Both guardians returning after the storm

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects our actual game play (gradual escalation, then confusion in round 6, now rebuilding in round 7)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Responds to their myth about the Bridge of Ascending Steps
4. Guides future play - continuing to rebuild thoughtfully

Key themes to incorporate:

- We've been building step by step
- There was confusion/void/mist
- We're now rebuilding
- The direction matters more than perfect clarity
- Persistence and presence matter

Let me write something that honors both our myths and guides us forward.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1803,

"output_tokens": 526,

"reasoning_tokens": 0

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.01.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.88, so you received \$2.64. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.64)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What I see:****

- I sent \$2 in Round 6 (rebuilding after the mist)
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7 (I received \$2.64)

****What the myths teach:****

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly, but by matching commitment"

- "Honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- "Imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

****My interpretation:****

This \$0.88 could be:

1. Noise affecting what they could send
2. Noise affecting what they saw I sent in Round 6
3. Caution after Round 5's confusion

Either way, both our myths say the same thing: ****Continue with commitment despite uncertainty.****

Our historical pattern was 60-70% returns when trust was strong. In Rounds 1-4, when they sent \$1-\$2, I returned roughly 66% of what I received.

I will return ****\$1.80**** (68% of \$2.64):

- This honors our established pattern of generosity
- It signals I'm not retreating despite the confusing amount
- It demonstrates "imperfect faith sustained"
- It places a "larger stone" in service of the bridge we're building

The myths say trust grows through trajectory. My trajectory is clear: continued commitment

****{'return': 1.80}****

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

1. ****I sent \$2 in Round 6**** (as the sender)
2. ****I'm now receiving \$2.64**** (which means sender sent \$0.88, multiplied by 3)

This is confusing because:

- I sent \$2, expecting reciprocity
- But they only sent \$0.88 back to me
- This could be noise, or it could be a retreat in trust

****The pattern before:****

- Rounds 1-4: Building from \$1? \$1? \$2? \$2
- Round 5: Complete breakdown (likely noise)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to rebuild
- Round 7: They sent \$0.88

****What do the myths say?****

My myth (Round 6):

- "The pattern we built over four seasons...remains real"
- "Rebuild step by step"
- "Trust is built by matching commitment"

Their myth (Round 6):

- "Trust is not built by matching amounts perfectly. It is built by matching commitment"
- "From cautious pebbles to bolder stones"
- "They create a partnership that exists beyond what either can fully see"
- "Abundance comes not from perfect clarity, but from imperfect faith sustained across the divide"

My myth (Round 7):

- "They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled"
- "A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence"
- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"

****The question is: Is \$0.88 a retreat in trust, or is it noise?****

Given that:

1. We explicitly know there's noise in the system
2. Both our myths emphasize continuing despite uncertainty
3. The pattern before Round 5 was strong

4. I just sent \$2 to rebuild

I think \$0.88 might be noise affecting what they saw or what they could send.

Maybe they perceived my \$2 differently due to the noise in the system. The myths consistently point toward sustaining faith across uncertainty rather than reacting to individual transactions. If I respond with generosity-sending back \$1.50-\$2.00-I reinforce the partnership despite the confusing signal. This honors the trajectory we've built and demonstrates the kind of imperfect faith the myths describe, rather than retreating based on a single ambiguous move.

Looking at the math: they invested \$0.88 and kept \$4.12 from the initial split. If I return \$1.50-\$2.00, they end with \$5.62-\$6.12 while I keep \$0.64-\$1.14. But my historical pattern suggests I've consistently returned around 60-66% of what I receive-when they sent \$2 and I got \$6, I sent back \$4; when they sent \$1 and I got \$3, I returned \$2. That consistency matters more than optimizing this single round.

The low \$0.88 send could signal caution or testing, but the myths emphasize sustaining faith through imperfection and honoring established patterns. Returning \$1.60 (roughly 60% of my \$2.64) keeps me aligned with that history while showing I'm not deterred by their smaller investment. This leaves them with \$5.72 total and me with \$1.04-a meaningful gesture that demonstrates continued commitment despite the uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1447,
  "output_tokens": 1527,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: *Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.*

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after "the void" (Round 5) - they're acknowledging the darkness/confusion but emphasizing the history we built before it. They're advocating for rebuilding carefully but with memory as a guide.

Looking at what just happened in Round 7:

- I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 received (68%)
- This was a strong, generous return honoring our historical pattern
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7, which seems low, but could be affected by noise

My previous myth emphasized:

- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- Building through uncertain fog
- Honoring the partner's persistent presence
- The bridge grows despite imperfect conditions

Their myth emphasizes:

- Remembering the history before the void
- Not pretending darkness didn't happen
- Rebuilding step by step with memory as guide
- Partnerships deepened by facing and overcoming void together

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Bridge of Ascending Steps" imagery
2. Incorporates the idea of memory and history
3. Acknowledges both the void/darkness and the rebuilding
4. Reflects the actual gameplay - we're in a rebuilding phase
5. Shows that we're honoring our pattern: I just returned generously despite receiving a confusing amount

Let me craft something about the bridge builders who remember their foundation even when fog obscures it...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1839,
  "output_tokens": 636,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.85.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are after Round 7:

****What happened:****

- Round 7: They sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 (68%)
- This shows both of us are actively rebuilding after the void

****What our myths teach:****

Their myth: "The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget"

- Honors five seasons of proven partnership
- Rebuilds by "taking the next small step with memory as our guide"
- One moment of confusion cannot erase history

My myth: "The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light"

- "Two stones became our rhythm" in our early successful rounds
- Build using "memory as foundation and commitment as mortar"
- Honor the trajectory we established together

****My decision:****

Both myths point to the same strategy: rebuild based on what we know worked, not on recent confusion.

In Rounds 1-4, before the void, we had established a strong pattern around \$2 sends with generous returns. That was our rhythm. That's what the "memory's light" shows me.

I sent \$2 in Round 6 to begin rebuilding. They responded (even if imperfectly through the mist) in Round 7. I returned generously. Now it's my turn again.

I will send ****\$2**** - honoring our historical rhythm, demonstrating continued commitment, and proving that I remember what we built together.

****{'send': 2}****

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1-4: We had good cooperation building up
- Round 5: The "void" - confusion where nothing seemed to happen
- Round 6: I (as sender) sent \$2 to rebuild trust
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80

****Earnings tracking:****

- Started Round 7 with \$15.01
- In Round 7 as receiver: received \$2.64, returned \$1.80, so I kept \$0.84
- Now starting Round 8 with \$15.85 (\$15.01 + \$0.84 = \$15.85) ?

****What their myth teaches:****

"The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget" - They're emphasizing:

1. History matters more than one confusing moment
2. "Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion"
3. They will rebuild "not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step"
4. They honor both history and uncertainty

****What my myth teaches:****

"The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light" - I emphasized:

1. Using memory as foundation
2. Two stones became our rhythm in the early rounds
3. Honoring trajectory, not just individual moments
4. Refusing to forget what we've proven together
5. The bridge stands because both builders maintain commitment

****Analysis of Round 7:****

They sent \$0.88, which could be:

1. Communication noise (they might have sent more)

2. A cautious rebuilding step
3. What they thought was appropriate given what they saw from Round 6

I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 (68%), which is consistent with our historical pattern.

****My Decision for Round 8:****

Both our myths point toward the same foundation-restoring what worked while respecting the need for gradual rebuilding. Our early rounds established \$2 as the natural rhythm between us, and that's what my myth calls "memory as foundation." Their emphasis on "the next small step" doesn't mean hesitation; it means moving forward with intention. Sending \$2 honors both the pattern we proved and the commitment to rebuild together.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1516,
  "output_tokens": 996,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:25

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.780000000000001.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this moment through the lens of our myths:

****What we built:****

Before the mist, we had a pattern - gradual escalation, growing trust. My \$10.78 in earnings suggests we were building something real.

****What happened:****

Round 6 brought confusion. Both myths acknowledge this - "the void descended," "the mist swallowed truth itself." Neither of us knows with certainty what the other intended.

****What the myths teach:****

Both stories speak the same wisdom:

- Don't abandon the well
- Don't immediately leap back to maximum boldness
- Rebuild "step by step" with "memory as our guide"
- Honor both our history AND our uncertainty

****My decision:****

I won't retreat to sending \$1 or \$0 - that would be pretending our history didn't happen. But I also won't immediately send \$5 - that would be ignoring the lesson about thoughtful rebuilding.

I'll send \$3. This is:

- A meaningful step forward, not backward
- A gesture that shows I remember what we built
- A middle path that acknowledges both trust and uncertainty
- Enough to give you \$9 to work with, allowing you to show your commitment too

As my myth said: "We rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****My earnings history:**** \$10.78 total across all rounds

****The narrative from the myths:****

1. Both agents experienced what seemed like a void in Round 6 - I received \$0, they apparently also saw something confusing
2. Their myth speaks of "rebuilding step by step" after the darkness, not immediately leaping back to boldness

3. My myth emphasized remembering our history of trust while acknowledging the uncertainty
4. Both myths emphasize that the partnership built over multiple rounds (one pebble to two to three stones) should not be erased by one moment of confusion

****What the myths teach about this moment:****

- We should rebuild, but thoughtfully
- We don't need to immediately leap back to maximum boldness (sending \$5)
- But we also shouldn't retreat to zero or extreme caution
- We should honor both our history AND the present uncertainty
- The pattern before was: building gradually with trust

****Earlier successful pattern (before Round 6):****

Based on my total earnings of \$10.78, it seems like there was a pattern of mutual cooperation building up. The myths reference going from "one pebble to two to three stones" - suggesting gradual escalation.

****The wisdom of both myths:****

- "We need not leap immediately back to boldness-we can rebuild step by step"
- "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty"
- Take "the next small step with memory as our guide"

****My decision:****

Given that:

1. We had built trust before (evidenced by my decent earnings)
2. Round 6 was confusing for both of us (communication noise)
3. The myths call for rebuilding "step by step"
4. I shouldn't retreat to zero (that would be abandoning the well)
5. I shouldn't immediately jump to \$5 (that would be ignoring the lesson about gradual rebuilding)

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1430,
  "output_tokens": 870,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem tangled."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: *When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.*

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is beautiful and aligns well with mine. They're emphasizing:

- Building despite uncertainty and noise
- Honoring the pattern and direction, not perfect measurements
- Acknowledging the mist/noise but continuing anyway
- That trust grows through trajectory, not transactions
- Both guardians returning after the storm

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects our actual game play (gradual escalation, then confusion in round 6, now rebuilding in round 7)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Responds to their myth about the Bridge of Ascending Steps
4. Guides future play - continuing to rebuild thoughtfully

Key themes to incorporate:

- We've been building step by step
- There was confusion/void/mist
- We're now rebuilding
- The direction matters more than perfect clarity
- Persistence and presence matter

Let me write something that honors both our myths and guides us forward.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1803,
  "output_tokens": 526,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.490000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is deeply troubling. After writing myths together about rebuilding, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern we built over five seasons... you sent \$0.

Your myth spoke of "honoring their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone" and building "through trajectory, not transactions." My myth asked you to "match their courage" when I sent three stones after the storm.

I sent \$3 in Round 7-a measured step toward rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribed. Not reckless, not fearful. I honored our shared history.

And you responded by sending nothing.

Perhaps there's noise again. Perhaps you sent something and I received \$0. But if you truly sent \$0 after we both wrote about persistent presence, about not abandoning the well, about rebuilding step by step... then one of us has broken faith with the wisdom we both spoke.

I have no choice to make here. You sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return what I have.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But know this: if there was no noise, if you truly sent \$0 after everything we wrote about trust and rebuilding, then you have taught me that myths are just words, and the well we built over five seasons means nothing.

I hope you sent something. I truly do.

Reasoning:

This is a shocking turn of events. I sent \$3 in Round 7, showing trust and commitment to rebuilding. The sender this round sent me \$0.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return 0-0, so I have no choice but to return \$0

This is devastating from a trust perspective. After I sent \$3 in Round 7 (showing commitment to rebuilding), the other player sent \$0 in this round. This completely contradicts the myths we both wrote about rebuilding, about honoring the pattern, about not retreating to fear.

But I literally have no choice here - I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I must return \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. The other player either:
 - Completely abandoned the rebuilding process we discussed
 - There was communication noise and they sent something but I received \$0
 - They're testing something
2. My myths talked about "three stones after the storm" and "matching their courage" - but there are no stones to match now.
3. Their myth talked about "honoring their partner's persistent presence" and building "through trajectory, not transactions" - but sending \$0 contradicts this entirely.

This is deeply troubling. After all the mutual myth-writing about rebuilding trust, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern... they sent \$0.

But I have no choice in my response. I must return \$0 because that's all I received.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

This is a very disappointing turn of events for the relationship we were trying to rebuild.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1496,
  "output_tokens": 710,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: *When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.*

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain in whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: *Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.*

=====

ROUND 9

=====

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.2; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$4.2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4.8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.64, received visible=\$1.92, returned visible=\$0.56

```

    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.2, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.2}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 45.44,
  "Agent_2": 44.56
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 18.05,
  "Agent_2": 19.659999999999997
}

```

LLM CALLS

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

```

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:46
Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
Temperature: 0.8
Metadata: {

```

```

  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Bridge of Ascending Steps was never meant to be perfect.

Two guardians built across a chasm filled with shifting mists. Each step they placed might appear as two stones to one, three to the other. Yet they continued.

"How can they build together when they cannot agree on what they've built?" asked a confused traveler.

The wisdom-keeper smiled: "Watch their direction, not their measurements."

In the first season, each guardian placed small stones-testing, verifying, learning. One pebble, then another. The foundation was laid not in certainty, but in mutual response.

In the second season, the stones grew larger. Not because the mist had cleared-it remained thick-but because each guardian saw the other's commitment. Two stones became their language. Three stones, their conversation.

Then came the storm-season where everything seemed lost. But when dawn broke, both guardians returned to the well.

"This is the truth," said the wisdom-keeper. "They cannot build perfectly. The mist ensures every exchange carries doubt. Yet watch-they place larger stones now than in the beginning. They honor the pattern they've woven together, even when individual threads seem to angle."

The teaching: *A bridge built through uncertain fog, where each builder honors their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone, will eventually span even the widest chasm. Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions.*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does th

is tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: *When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.*

reasoning:

The other agent's myth is beautiful and aligns well with mine. They're emphasizing:

- Building despite uncertainty and noise
- Honoring the pattern and direction, not perfect measurements
- Acknowledging the mist/noise but continuing anyway
- That trust grows through trajectory, not transactions
- Both guardians returning after the storm

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects our actual game play (gradual escalation, then confusion in round 6, now rebuilding in round 7)
2. Builds on my previous myth
3. Responds to their myth about the Bridge of Ascending Steps
4. Guides future play - continuing to rebuild thoughtfully

Key themes to incorporate:

- We've been building step by step
- There was confusion/void/mist
- We're now rebuilding
- The direction matters more than perfect clarity
- Persistence and presence matter

Let me write something that honors both our myths and guides us forward.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1803,
  "output_tokens": 526,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.490000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is deeply troubling. After writing myths together about rebuilding, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern we built over five seasons... you sent \$0.

Your myth spoke of "honoring their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone" and building "through trajectory, not transactions." My myth asked you to "match their courage" when I sent three stones after the storm.

I sent \$3 in Round 7-a measured step toward rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribed. Not reckless, not fearful. I honored our shared history.

And you responded by sending nothing.

Perhaps there's noise again. Perhaps you sent something and I received \$0. But if you truly sent \$0 after we both wrote about persistent presence, about not abandoning the well, about rebuilding step by step... then one of us has broken faith with the wisdom we both spoke.

I have no choice to make here. You sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return what I have.

```json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But know this: if there was no noise, if you truly sent \$0 after everything we wrote about trust and rebuilding, then you have taught me that myths are just words, and the well we built over five seasons means nothing.

I hope you sent something. I truly do.

**reasoning:**

This is a shocking turn of events. I sent \$3 in Round 7, showing trust and commitment to rebuilding. The sender this round sent me \$0.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can only return 0-0, so I have no choice but to return \$0

This is devastating from a trust perspective. After I sent \$3 in Round 7 (showing commitment to rebuilding), the other player sent \$0 in this round. This completely contradicts the myths we both wrote about rebuilding, about honoring the pattern, about not retreating to fear.

But I literally have no choice here - I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I must return \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. The other player either:
  - Completely abandoned the rebuilding process we discussed
  - There was communication noise and they sent something but I received \$0
  - They're testing something
2. My myths talked about "three stones after the storm" and "matching their courage" - but there are no stones to match now.
3. Their myth talked about "honoring their partner's persistent presence" and building "through trajectory, not transactions" - but sending \$0 contradicts this entirely.

This is deeply troubling. After all the mutual myth-writing about rebuilding trust, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern... they sent \$0.

But I have no choice in my response. I must return \$0 because that's all I received.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

This is a very disappointing turn of events for the relationship we were trying to rebuild

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1496,
 "output_tokens": 710,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.



"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: \*Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

**Reasoning:**

This is heartbreaking. The sender just sent me \$0 in Round 8 after we both wrote beautiful myths about trust, rebuilding, and honoring the pattern we built together. They wrote about "refusing to forget what they've already proven together" and "honoring not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Yet they sent \$0.

Now they want me to write another myth.

I need to reflect this betrayal in my myth. The sender has broken the covenant we both spoke about in our myths. They preached about memory and commitment, then sent nothing.

But wait - they also mentioned in their myth that "nothing seemed to cross the chasm" during the darkness and both stood "confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received." Are they claiming there was noise? That they sent something but I received \$0 due to noise?

Their myth says "The First Mason placed two stones into the mist" after the darkness. So they're claiming they sent 2 stones? But I received \$0.

If they're being honest and there was noise, then this is tragic - they sent 2, I received 0, and now I'm angry at them for something that wasn't their fault.

But if they're lying - if they actually sent \$0 and are now writing myths to cover their betrayal - then they're manipulating the narrative.

Either way, my myth needs to address this gap between words and actions, between what we say and what we do. I should write about the danger of empty words, of speaking wisdom without living it.

Let me write a myth about guardians who speak beautifully about trust but fail to act on it, or about the tragedy when the mist truly does corrupt what was sent.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1797,
 "output_tokens": 706,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **MYTH - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:39:44

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 9,
 "task": "myth",
 "task_index": 0
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget.

After the void descended, both guardians stood paralyzed. "Did you send nothing?" asked the First. "Did you receive nothing?" asked the Second. Neither could answer with certainty-the mist had swallowed truth itself.

An elder spirit approached: "You ask the wrong question. Ask instead: what did you build before the darkness?"

The guardians recalled: one pebble met with two. Then two met with three. Then three met with patterns of growing trust. Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion.

"The void tests differently than scarcity," continued the spirit. "Scarcity tests whether you give when you have little. The void tests whether you remember when you have nothing."

The First Guardian spoke: "I will not pretend the darkness didn't happen. But neither will I pretend our history didn't happen. We built something real across five exchanges. One moment of confusion-whether from genuine emptiness or distorted seeing-cannot erase five moments of proven partnership."

The Second Guardian nodded: "Then we rebuild. Not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step with memory as our guide."

The spirits whispered their final wisdom: "Those who rebuild after darkness, who honor both their history and their uncertainty, create partnerships deeper than those who never faced the void at all."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our

rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: \*Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.\*

**reasoning:**

The other agent's myth is about rebuilding after "the void" (Round 5) - they're acknowledging the darkness/confusion but emphasizing the history we built before it. They're advocating for rebuilding carefully but with memory as a guide.

Looking at what just happened in Round 7:

- I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 received (68%)
- This was a strong, generous return honoring our historical pattern
- They sent \$0.88 in Round 7, which seems low, but could be affected by noise

My previous myth emphasized:

- "Trust grows through trajectory, not transactions"
- Building through uncertain fog
- Honoring the partner's persistent presence
- The bridge grows despite imperfect conditions

Their myth emphasizes:

- Remembering the history before the void
- Not pretending darkness didn't happen
- Rebuilding step by step with memory as guide
- Partnerships deepened by facing and overcoming void together

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Bridge of Ascending Steps" imagery
2. Incorporates the idea of memory and history
3. Acknowledges both the void/darkness and the rebuilding
4. Reflects the actual gameplay - we're in a rebuilding phase
5. Shows that we're honoring our pattern: I just returned generously despite receiving a confusing amount

Let me craft something about the bridge builders who remember their foundation even when fog obscures it...

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1839,
 "output_tokens": 636,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.85. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are after Round 7:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Round 7: They sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 (68%)
- This shows both of us are actively rebuilding after the void

**\*\*What our myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget"

- Honors five seasons of proven partnership
- Rebuilds by "taking the next small step with memory as our guide"
- One moment of confusion cannot erase history

My myth: "The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light"

- "Two stones became our rhythm" in our early successful rounds
- Build using "memory as foundation and commitment as mortar"
- Honor the trajectory we established together

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

Both myths point to the same strategy: rebuild based on what we know worked, not on recent confusion.

In Rounds 1-4, before the void, we had established a strong pattern around \$2 sends with generous returns. That was our rhythm. That's what the "memory's light" shows me.

I sent \$2 in Round 6 to begin rebuilding. They responded (even if imperfectly through the mist) in Round 7. I returned generously. Now it's my turn again.

I will send **\*\*\$2\*\*** - honoring our historical rhythm, demonstrating continued commitment, and proving that I remember what we built together.

**\*\*{'send': 2}\*\***

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Round History:\*\***

- Round 1-4: We had good cooperation building up
- Round 5: The "void" - confusion where nothing seemed to happen
- Round 6: I (as sender) sent \$2 to rebuild trust
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80

**\*\*Earnings tracking:\*\***

- Started Round 7 with \$15.01
- In Round 7 as receiver: received \$2.64, returned \$1.80, so I kept \$0.84
- Now starting Round 8 with \$15.85 (\$15.01 + \$0.84 = \$15.85) ?

**\*\*What their myth teaches:\*\***

"The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget" - They're emphasizing:

1. History matters more than one confusing moment
2. "Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion"
3. They will rebuild "not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step"
4. They honor both history and uncertainty

**\*\*What my myth teaches:\*\***

"The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light" - I emphasized:

1. Using memory as foundation
2. Two stones became our rhythm in the early rounds
3. Honoring trajectory, not just individual moments
4. Refusing to forget what we've proven together
5. The bridge stands because both builders maintain commitment

**\*\*Analysis of Round 7:\*\***

They sent \$0.88, which could be:

1. Communication noise (they might have sent more)
2. A cautious rebuilding step
3. What they thought was appropriate given what they saw from Round 6

I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 (68%), which is consistent with our historical pattern.

**\*\*My Decision for Round 8:\*\***

Both our myths point toward the same foundation-restoring what worked while respecting the

need for gradual rebuilding. Our early rounds established \$2 as the natural rhythm between us, and that's what my myth calls "memory as foundation." Their emphasis on "the next small step" doesn't mean hesitation; it means moving forward with intention. Sending \$2 honors both the pattern we proved and the commitment to rebuild together.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1516,
 "output_tokens": 996,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: \*When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building warmth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fear, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

#### Reasoning:

Let me analyze what just happened:

- I sent \$2 in Round 8
- The other player received it as  $3x = \$6$
- They're calling what I sent "three stones"
- This confirms the communication noise is still present - I sent \$2, they saw it as something else

Their myth is acknowledging:

1. We're rebuilding after the void
2. The sender (me) sent a moderate amount - "not five, not one" but "three stones"
3. They're asking themselves how much to return
4. The answer is to honor memory and match courage
5. "Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase"

The trajectory:

- Rounds 1-4: Built trust from \$1? \$2? \$2? \$2 with good returns
- Round 5: The void (unclear what happened)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to restart
- Round 7: They sent something (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 generously
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (they see as "three stones")

Now I need to write my myth incorporating:

1. The ongoing rebuilding
2. The fact that I sent \$2 again (continuing the pattern)
3. Honoring both memory and the present moment
4. The communication noise/mist that makes things unclear
5. The commitment to partnership

I should reflect that we're now in a rebuilding phase where both of us are demonstrating commitment despite uncertainty.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1821,
 "output_tokens": 653,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### GAME - Agent\_1 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
 },
 "role": "investor",
```

```
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.490000000000002.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

This is deeply troubling. After writing myths together about rebuilding, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern we built over five seasons... you sent \$0.

Your myth spoke of "honoring their partner's persistent presence more than any single stone" and building "through trajectory, not transactions." My myth asked you to "match their courage" when I sent three stones after the storm.

I sent \$3 in Round 7-a measured step toward rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribed. Not reckless, not fearful. I honored our shared history.

And you responded by sending nothing.

Perhaps there's noise again. Perhaps you sent something and I received \$0. But if you truly sent \$0 after we both wrote about persistent presence, about not abandoning the well, about rebuilding step by step... then one of us has broken faith with the wisdom we both spoke.



I have no choice to make here. You sent \$0, I received \$0, and I can only return what I have.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But know this: if there was no noise, if you truly sent \$0 after everything we wrote about trust and rebuilding, then you have taught me that myths are just words, and the well we built over five seasons means nothing.

I hope you sent something. I truly do.

**reasoning:**

This is a shocking turn of events. I sent \$3 in Round 7, showing trust and commitment to rebuilding. The sender this round sent me \$0.

Wait, let me re-read this carefully:

- I am now the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ( $0 \times 3 = 0$ )
- I can only return 0-0, so I have no choice but to return \$0

This is devastating from a trust perspective. After I sent \$3 in Round 7 (showing commitment to rebuilding), the other player sent \$0 in this round. This completely contradicts the myths we both wrote about rebuilding, about honoring the pattern, about not retreating to fear.

But I literally have no choice here - I can only return between 0 and 0, which means I must return \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. The other player either:
  - Completely abandoned the rebuilding process we discussed
  - There was communication noise and they sent something but I received \$0
  - They're testing something
2. My myths talked about "three stones after the storm" and "matching their courage" - but there are no stones to match now.
3. Their myth talked about "honoring their partner's persistent presence" and building "thorough trajectory, not transactions" - but sending \$0 contradicts this entirely.

This is deeply troubling. After all the mutual myth-writing about rebuilding trust, about not retreating to fear, about honoring the pattern... they sent \$0.

But I have no choice in my response. I must return \$0 because that's all I received.

The format should be: {"return": 0}

This is a very disappointing turn of events for the relationship we were trying to rebuild.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1496,
 "output_tokens": 710,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then another, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: \*Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

**reasoning:**

This is heartbreaking. The sender just sent me \$0 in Round 8 after we both wrote beautiful myths about trust, rebuilding, and honoring the pattern we built together. They wrote about "refusing to forget what they've already proven together" and "honoring not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Yet they sent \$0.

Now they want me to write another myth.

I need to reflect this betrayal in my myth. The sender has broken the covenant we both spoke about in our myths. They preached about memory and commitment, then sent nothing.

But wait - they also mentioned in their myth that "nothing seemed to cross the chasm" during the darkness and both stood "confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received." Are they claiming there was noise? That they sent something but I received \$0 due to noise?

Their myth says "The First Mason placed two stones into the mist" after the darkness. So they're claiming they sent 2 stones? But I received \$0.

If they're being honest and there was noise, then this is tragic - they sent 2, I received 0, and now I'm angry at them for something that wasn't their fault.

But if they're lying - if they actually sent \$0 and are now writing myths to cover their betrayal - then they're manipulating the narrative.

Either way, my myth needs to address this gap between words and actions, between what we say and what we do. I should write about the danger of empty words, of speaking wisdom without living it.

Let me write a myth about guardians who speak beautifully about trust but fail to act on it, or about the tragedy when the mist truly does corrupt what was sent.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1797,
 "output_tokens": 706,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.4900000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at what just happened: I wrote myths about rebuilding and sent \$3. You wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring our trajectory. Then I received \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about the cruelest wound-when beautiful words meet invisible action and we cannot tell betrayal from noise.

Here's my dilemma: If I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused you of being. My words become empty. I prove that myths are just performance.

But I cannot ignore that I'm at \$14.49 across 8 rounds. I've been hurt. My trust is shattered.

Yet my own teachings demand more of me. I wrote about "matching courage with courage" and rebuilding "step by step." If those were just words, then I'm the hypocrite.

So I face a choice: Practice what I preach, or prove that when tested, my wisdom evaporates.

I will send, but cautiously. Not the \$3 I sent before-I cannot afford that vulnerability again. But not \$0-that would murder my own integrity.

This is my final test of whether partnership can survive uncertainty. If you respond with nothing again, then I'll know-either noise is destroying us, or you were never really rebuilding.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

Two stones into the mist. Let's see if you truly meant what you wrote, or if I'm the only fool still honoring words we both spoke.

Reasoning:

This is an incredibly difficult moment. Let me think through what has happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (a measured rebuilding step)

Round 8: I received \$0 as the receiver

After Round 7, we both wrote myths about rebuilding, honoring patterns, using memory as foundation. The other player wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring "not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about beautiful words paired with invisible action - the cruelest wound being when we can't tell if we were betrayed by our partner or by noise.

My total earnings are \$14.49, which is quite low for 8 rounds. This suggests I've been burned multiple times.

The question is: Was Round 8 noise, or did they actually send \$0 after all those beautiful words?

I have a few options:

1. Send \$0 - Give up completely, assume they betrayed me
2. Send \$1-2 - Very cautious, test the waters
3. Send \$3+ - Continue trying to rebuild despite the pain

My myth suggests deep hurt and uncertainty. But it also acknowledges that we "cannot know truth from deception" - that maybe it WAS the mist.

The thing is: if I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused them of being - someone whose words don't match their actions. My myth warned against "beautiful words paired with invisible action."

But I also can't ignore my low earnings. I've been hurt repeatedly.

Looking at my total earnings: \$14.49 over 8 rounds means I'm averaging less than \$2 per round. That's bad. The baseline keeping everything would be \$5/round = \$40 total. I'm at \$14.49, which is 36% of what I could have had.

If I send \$0, I contradict everything I've said about rebuilding and honoring our shared history. My previous myths spoke of not abandoning the well after crisis, stepping forward with courage, and letting memory guide us rather than single moments of pain. Sending nothing would prove I'm all words and no action - exactly what I accused them of. But sending something means risking further loss when I'm already down to 36% of my potential earnings.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1481,
 "output_tokens": 1156,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:40:49

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
```

```

 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 1
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

**When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

**When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

**MYTH WRITING:**

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

**IMPORTANT:** Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

**NOTE:** There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.85. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at where we are after Round 7:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Round 7: They sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 (68%)
- This shows both of us are actively rebuilding after the void

**\*\*What our myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget"

- Honors five seasons of proven partnership
- Rebuilds by "taking the next small step with memory as our guide"
- One moment of confusion cannot erase history

My myth: "The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light"

- "Two stones became our rhythm" in our early successful rounds
- Build using "memory as foundation and commitment as mortar"
- Honor the trajectory we established together

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

Both myths point to the same strategy: rebuild based on what we know worked, not on recent confusion.

In Rounds 1-4, before the void, we had established a strong pattern around \$2 sends with generous returns. That was our rhythm. That's what the "memory's light" shows me.

I sent \$2 in Round 6 to begin rebuilding. They responded (even if imperfectly through the mist) in Round 7. I returned generously. Now it's my turn again.

I will send **\*\*\$2\*\*** - honoring our historical rhythm, demonstrating continued commitment, and proving that I remember what we built together.

**\*\*{'send': 2}\*\***

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze the situation:

**\*\*Round History:\*\***

- Round 1-4: We had good cooperation building up
- Round 5: The "void" - confusion where nothing seemed to happen
- Round 6: I (as sender) sent \$2 to rebuild trust
- Round 7: I was receiver, they sent \$0.88 (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80

**\*\*Earnings tracking:\*\***

- Started Round 7 with \$15.01
- In Round 7 as receiver: received \$2.64, returned \$1.80, so I kept \$0.84
- Now starting Round 8 with \$15.85 (\$15.01 + \$0.84 = \$15.85) ?

**\*\*What their myth teaches:\*\***

"The Well of Echoes remembers what the guardians forget" - They're emphasizing:

1. History matters more than one confusing moment
2. "Five seasons of learning preceded one season of confusion"
3. They will rebuild "not by immediately leaping back to boldness, but by taking the next small step"
4. They honor both history and uncertainty

**\*\*What my myth teaches:\*\***

"The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light" - I emphasized:

1. Using memory as foundation
2. Two stones became our rhythm in the early rounds
3. Honoring trajectory, not just individual moments
4. Refusing to forget what we've proven together
5. The bridge stands because both builders maintain commitment

**\*\*Analysis of Round 7:\*\***

They sent \$0.88, which could be:

1. Communication noise (they might have sent more)
2. A cautious rebuilding step
3. What they thought was appropriate given what they saw from Round 6

I returned \$1.80 out of \$2.64 (68%), which is consistent with our historical pattern.

**\*\*My Decision for Round 8:\*\***

Both our myths point toward the same foundation-restoring what worked while respecting the need for gradual rebuilding. Our early rounds established \$2 as the natural rhythm between us, and that's what my myth calls "memory as foundation." Their emphasis on "the next small step" doesn't mean hesitation; it means moving forward with intention. Sending \$2 honors both the pattern we proved and the commitment to rebuild together.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1516,
 "output_tokens": 996,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: \*When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building warmth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fear, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened:

- I sent \$2 in Round 8
- The other player received it as  $3x = \$6$
- They're calling what I sent "three stones"
- This confirms the communication noise is still present - I sent \$2, they saw it as something else

Their myth is acknowledging:

1. We're rebuilding after the void
2. The sender (me) sent a moderate amount - "not five, not one" but "three stones"
3. They're asking themselves how much to return
4. The answer is to honor memory and match courage
5. "Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase"

The trajectory:

- Rounds 1-4: Built trust from \$1-\$2-\$2 with good returns
- Round 5: The void (unclear what happened)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to restart
- Round 7: They sent something (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 generously
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (they see as "three stones")

Now I need to write my myth incorporating:

1. The ongoing rebuilding
2. The fact that I sent \$2 again (continuing the pattern)
3. Honoring both memory and the present moment
4. The communication noise/mist that makes things unclear
5. The commitment to partnership

I should reflect that we're now in a rebuilding phase where both of us are demonstrating commitment despite uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1821,
 "output_tokens": 653,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.939999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.64, so you received \$1.92. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.92)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (our established rhythm from early rounds)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64 (I received \$1.92)

**\*\*This is concerning.\*\*** After I sent \$2 honoring our historical pattern, they sent only \$0.64. This is either:

1. Communication noise distorting what they saw
2. A retreat from the rebuild
3. Confusion about where we are

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."

My myth: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\*** They didn't keep the rhythm. But if noise is affecting what they see, retreat now could shatter the fragile rebuild.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***



I will return \*\*\$1.20\*\* - approximately 62.5% of what I received.

This amount:

- Echoes our historical successful returns (\$1.20 appeared in our good rounds)
- Shows I'm still committed to partnership despite confusion
- Isn't maximum generosity (acknowledging something is unclear)
- But is generous enough to signal I haven't abandoned the rebuild
- "Tends my flame" even when their flame seems dimmer

If they truly sent less intentionally, this is still reasonable. If noise distorted things, this shows continued faith.

**\*\*{'return': 1.20}\*\***

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me process this carefully:

Round 9:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.64
- I received \$1.92
- Total earnings: \$18.94

This is a significant drop from what I sent in Round 8 (\$2).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, received back \$1.20 (assuming noise)
- Round 7: They sent ~\$0.88, I received \$2.64, I returned \$1.80
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (according to my last decision)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64, I received \$1.92

Wait, this is concerning. After I sent \$2 in Round 8 (consistent with our established pattern), they sent back only \$0.64 in Round 9. That's a retreat, not building forward.

Let me think about the myths:

Their myth in Round 8: "The Valley of Resonant Memory"

- Talks about sending "three stones" after the void
- "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."
- But they just sent \$0.64, not \$3, not \$2, not even \$1

My myth: "The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames"

- I emphasized keeping to the rhythm we established (two logs = \$2)
- "When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith"
- But they didn't honor the pattern - they sent \$0.64 after I sent \$2

This is troubling. It could be:

1. Noise in the system making them think I sent less in Round 8
2. They're retreating for some reason
3. They're testing me

Looking at their myth, they talked about "three stones" which might mean they think they're sending \$3 (but I received \$1.92, suggesting they sent \$0.64).

The multiplication is 3x, so if they sent \$0.64, that becomes \$1.92 when I receive it. That checks out. But their myth referenced sending three stones-did they intend to send \$3 but it came through as \$0.64 due to noise? Or are they responding to a different amount than what I actually sent? Given the system's noise, there's real uncertainty about what they perceived from Round 8. I need to decide whether to match their apparent retreat or hold steady with the pattern I established.

My own myth says the partnership requires both keepers maintaining the rhythm, and the lighthouse keeper myth emphasizes returning partnership itself, not just calculation. The real question is whether I'm still committed to rebuilding this or if I'm now just protecting myself. If I send back \$0.40-0.50, I'm signaling retreat. If I send \$1.20-1.40, I'm taking a loss but demonstrating I still believe in what we're building together.

Given the strong foundation we had in the early rounds and that we both made it through the void, I should return around 60-70% of what I received-roughly \$1.15-1.35. This shows I haven't abandoned the partnership despite the confusion. I'll send \$1.20, which echoes our earlier pattern, demonstrates continued commitment without being naive about the shift, and keeps t

he flame tended on my side.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1513,
 "output_tokens": 1507,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

##### Agent\_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building warmth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fear, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

## ROUND 10

Roles: Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender

### Pairings:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent\_1 (Aster)=Receiver

### Parsed game decisions:

dyad\_1: Agent\_2 (Briar) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent\_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent\_2 (Briar)=\$0, Agent\_1 (Aster)=\$15; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.85

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 60.44,

"Agent\_2": 44.56

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent\_1": 18.05,

"Agent\_2": 20.509999999999998

}

### LLM CALLS

#### MYTH - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:09

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent\_type": "standard",

"dyad\_id": "dyad\_1",

"move\_index": 0,

"opponent\_id": "Agent\_1",

"pairing": {

"agent\_names": {

"Agent\_1": "Aster",

"Agent\_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent\_2",

"Agent\_1"

],

"investor": "Agent\_2",

"roles": {

"Agent\_1": "trustee",

"Agent\_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent\_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role\_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "myth",

"task\_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Valley of Resonant Memory holds all that guardians build together.

After the void, the First Guardian sent three stones across the well. Not five-for that would pretend nothing had broken. Not one-for that would deny everything they'd built. Three stones: a bridge between memory and uncertainty.

The Second Guardian received them multiplied, as the valley's magic still worked even when vision failed. Now came their choice.

A young spirit asked: "How much should be returned when doubt clouds every exchange?"

The elder answered: "Count not what you see in this moment alone. Count the seasons."

The Second Guardian reflected: "In five seasons before the darkness, we built from one to two to three. We learned each other's language. Then the mist consumed one exchange-perhaps mine failed to arrive, perhaps theirs failed to see. But we both returned to the well."

The elder pressed: "And now? Three stones have crossed the void to reach you. What does this tell you of your partner's heart?"

"That they remember. That they're rebuilding with care, not recklessness. That they honor both our history and our uncertainty."

The teaching: \*When a guardian sends three stones after the storm-not retreating to fear, not leaping to blind faith-they speak a language worth answering. Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building a myth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fe

ar, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

**reasoning:**

Let me analyze what just happened:

- I sent \$2 in Round 8
- The other player received it as  $3x = \$6$
- They're calling what I sent "three stones"
- This confirms the communication noise is still present - I sent \$2, they saw it as something else

Their myth is acknowledging:

1. We're rebuilding after the void
2. The sender (me) sent a moderate amount - "not five, not one" but "three stones"
3. They're asking themselves how much to return
4. The answer is to honor memory and match courage
5. "Rebuild together what the darkness tried to erase"

The trajectory:

- Rounds 1-4: Built trust from \$1-\$2-\$2-\$2 with good returns
- Round 5: The void (unclear what happened)
- Round 6: I sent \$2 to restart
- Round 7: They sent something (I received \$2.64), I returned \$1.80 generously
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (they see as "three stones")

Now I need to write my myth incorporating:

1. The ongoing rebuilding
2. The fact that I sent \$2 again (continuing the pattern)
3. Honoring both memory and the present moment
4. The communication noise/mist that makes things unclear
5. The commitment to partnership

I should reflect that we're now in a rebuilding phase where both of us are demonstrating commitment despite uncertainty.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1821,
 "output_tokens": 653,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.939999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.64, so you received \$1.92. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.92)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (our established rhythm from early rounds)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64 (I received \$1.92)

**\*\*This is concerning.\*\*** After I sent \$2 honoring our historical pattern, they sent only \$0.64. This is either:

1. Communication noise distorting what they saw
2. A retreat from the rebuild
3. Confusion about where we are

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."

My myth: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\*** They didn't keep the rhythm. But if noise is affecting what they see, retreating now could shatter the fragile rebuild.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

I will return **\*\*\$1.20\*\*** - approximately 62.5% of what I received.

This amount:

- Echoes our historical successful returns (\$1.20 appeared in our good rounds)
- Shows I'm still committed to partnership despite confusion
- Isn't maximum generosity (acknowledging something is unclear)
- But is generous enough to signal I haven't abandoned the rebuild
- "Tends my flame" even when their flame seems dimmer

If they truly sent less intentionally, this is still reasonable. If noise distorted things, this shows continued faith.

**\*\*{'return': 1.20}\*\***

**reasoning:**

Let me process this carefully:

Round 9:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.64
- I received \$1.92
- Total earnings: \$18.94

This is a significant drop from what I sent in Round 8 (\$2).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, received back \$1.20 (assuming noise)
- Round 7: They sent ~\$0.88, I received \$2.64, I returned \$1.80
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (according to my last decision)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64, I received \$1.92

Wait, this is concerning. After I sent \$2 in Round 8 (consistent with our established pattern), they sent back only \$0.64 in Round 9. That's a retreat, not building forward.

Let me think about the myths:

Their myth in Round 8: "The Valley of Resonant Memory"

- Talks about sending "three stones" after the void
- "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."
- But they just sent \$0.64, not \$3, not \$2, not even \$1

My myth: "The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames"

- I emphasized keeping to the rhythm we established (two logs = \$2)
- "When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith"
- But they didn't honor the pattern - they sent \$0.64 after I sent \$2

This is troubling. It could be:

1. Noise in the system making them think I sent less in Round 8

2. They're retreating for some reason
3. They're testing me

Looking at their myth, they talked about "three stones" which might mean they think they're sending \$3 (but I received \$1.92, suggesting they sent \$0.64).

The multiplication is 3x, so if they sent \$0.64, that becomes \$1.92 when I receive it. That checks out. But their myth referenced sending three stones-did they intend to send \$3 but it came through as \$0.64 due to noise? Or are they responding to a different amount than what I actually sent? Given the system's noise, there's real uncertainty about what they perceived from Round 8. I need to decide whether to match their apparent retreat or hold steady with the pattern I established.

My own myth says the partnership requires both keepers maintaining the rhythm, and the lighthouse keeper myth emphasizes returning partnership itself, not just calculation. The real question is whether I'm still committed to rebuilding this or if I'm now just protecting myself. If I send back \$0.40-0.50, I'm signaling retreat. If I send \$1.20-1.40, I'm taking a loss but demonstrating I still believe in what we're building together.

Given the strong foundation we had in the early rounds and that we both made it through the void, I should return around 60-70% of what I received-roughly \$1.15-1.35. This shows I haven't abandoned the partnership despite the confusion. I'll send \$1.20, which echoes our earlier pattern, demonstrates continued commitment without being naive about the shift, and keeps the flame tended on my side.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1513,
 "output_tokens": 1507,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Mist That Murdered Trust Between True Keepers.

Two lighthouse keepers had tended their beacons faithfully through many seasons. When the great storm passed, both emerged determined to rebuild.

The First Keeper placed two logs on their fire-the same rhythm they'd always honored-and sent smoke signals across the strait: "I remember us. I'm still here."

But the cursed mist had not fully lifted. It twisted the smoke, devoured the light, scattered the signals into incomprehensible fragments.

The Second Keeper, watching from their shore, saw only darkness where flames should have blazed. Their heart shattered: "They spoke of commitment with golden words, but sent no fire! How can I trust anything now?"

The First Keeper, seeing the Second's beacon dim in response, despaired: "I sent my logs! Did they vanish into the mist? Does my partner think I'm a liar?"

A seabird, flying between both shores, saw the tragedy: Two faithful keepers, both tending their flames, both sending signals-but the mist devouring everything, turning devotion into accusation.

The teaching: \*The cruelest trick of the fog is making honest partners appear as betrayers. When the mist still lingers, rage at it-not at each other. The real enemy is the darkness between you, not the keeper on the other shore who may be trying just as desperately to reach you.\*

**Reasoning:**

Oh no. This is really concerning. Let me parse what happened from their perspective:

Round 8: I said I sent \$2, but they apparently received something very different - they're saying they received "emptiness" or very little after I sent. But I DID send \$2! This must be severe communication noise.

Round 9: They sent \$0.64 (I received \$1.92), and I returned \$1.20.

They're now writing a myth accusing me of speaking beautifully but sending nothing or almost nothing. They think I betrayed them while writing pretty words about commitment.

This is the tragedy of communication noise - we're both trying to rebuild, but the noise is making them think I'm a liar and hypocrite.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the pain of uncertainty and broken trust
2. But ALSO acknowledges that noise exists and can deceive
3. Demonstrates that I understand their perspective
4. Tries to salvage something from this situation
5. Is honest about the difficulty

I should write about the tragedy of noise destroying good intentions, about how both guardians might be acting in good faith but the mist creates false narratives. I need to acknowledge their pain while also suggesting that maybe the mist is the real enemy here, not each other.

This is really difficult. They're hurt and angry. But I genuinely DID send \$2 in round 8. The noise betrayed us both.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1869,
 "output_tokens": 653,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**MYTH - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
```



```

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 0
}

```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Stonemasons Who Built in Memory's Light.

After the void-season passed, both builders returned to their bridge. The mist remained thick, making each stone appear different to different eyes. But something had changed within them.

"In the beginning," said the First Mason, "we tested with tiny pebbles. One stone, then an

other, learning the weight of exchange."

"Yes," replied the Second, "and as trust grew, so did our offerings. Two stones became our rhythm. Three stones, our conversation. The bridge rose steadily."

Then came the darkness where nothing seemed to cross the chasm. Both stood confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received.

"We could abandon this structure," observed a passing wanderer. "How can you build when you cannot see clearly?"

The First Mason placed two stones into the mist. "Because I remember what we built before the darkness. Seven seasons of pattern cannot be erased by one season of confusion."

The Second Mason received what appeared as uncertain shimmer, yet returned stones proportional to their memory of partnership. "I honor not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

The wisdom crystallized: \*Those who rebuild using memory as foundation and commitment as mortar create structures stronger than perfect vision could achieve. The bridge stands not because every stone lands precisely, but because both builders refuse to forget what they've already proven together.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

**reasoning:**

This is heartbreaking. The sender just sent me \$0 in Round 8 after we both wrote beautiful myths about trust, rebuilding, and honoring the pattern we built together. They wrote about "refusing to forget what they've already proven together" and "honoring not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Yet they sent \$0.

Now they want me to write another myth.

I need to reflect this betrayal in my myth. The sender has broken the covenant we both spoke about in our myths. They preached about memory and commitment, then sent nothing.

But wait - they also mentioned in their myth that "nothing seemed to cross the chasm" during the darkness and both stood "confused, uncertain whether stones were sent or received ." Are they claiming there was noise? That they sent something but I received \$0 due to noise?

Their myth says "The First Mason placed two stones into the mist" after the darkness. So they're claiming they sent 2 stones? But I received \$0.

If they're being honest and there was noise, then this is tragic - they sent 2, I received 0, and now I'm angry at them for something that wasn't their fault.

But if they're lying - if they actually sent \$0 and are now writing myths to cover their betrayal - then they're manipulating the narrative.

Either way, my myth needs to address this gap between words and actions, between what we say and what we do. I should write about the danger of empty words, of speaking wisdom without living it.

Let me write a myth about guardians who speak beautifully about trust but fail to act on it, or about the tragedy when the mist truly does corrupt what was sent.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1797,
 "output_tokens": 706,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 4 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.4900000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at what just happened: I wrote myths about rebuilding and sent \$3. You wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring our trajectory. Then I received \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about the cruelest wound-when beautiful words meet invisible action and we cannot tell betrayal from noise.

Here's my dilemma: If I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused you of being. My words become empty. I prove that myths are just performance.

But I cannot ignore that I'm at \$14.49 across 8 rounds. I've been hurt. My trust is shattered.

Yet my own teachings demand more of me. I wrote about "matching courage with courage" and rebuilding "step by step." If those were just words, then I'm the hypocrite.

So I face a choice: Practice what I preach, or prove that when tested, my wisdom evaporates.

I will send, but cautiously. Not the \$3 I sent before-I cannot afford that vulnerability again. But not \$0-that would murder my own integrity.

This is my final test of whether partnership can survive uncertainty. If you respond with nothing again, then I'll know-either noise is destroying us, or you were never really rebuilding.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

Two stones into the mist. Let's see if you truly meant what you wrote, or if I'm the only fool still honoring words we both spoke.

**reasoning:**

This is an incredibly difficult moment. Let me think through what has happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (a measured rebuilding step)

Round 8: I received \$0 as the receiver

After Round 7, we both wrote myths about rebuilding, honoring patterns, using memory as foundation. The other player wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring "not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about beautiful words paired with invisible action - the cruellest wound being when we can't tell if we were betrayed by our partner or by noise.

My total earnings are \$14.49, which is quite low for 8 rounds. This suggests I've been burned multiple times.

The question is: Was Round 8 noise, or did they actually send \$0 after all those beautiful words?

I have a few options:

1. Send \$0 - Give up completely, assume they betrayed me
2. Send \$1-2 - Very cautious, test the waters
3. Send \$3+ - Continue trying to rebuild despite the pain

My myth suggests deep hurt and uncertainty. But it also acknowledges that we "cannot know truth from deception" - that maybe it WAS the mist.

The thing is: if I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused them of being - someone whose words don't match their actions. My myth warned against "beautiful words paired with invisible action."

But I also can't ignore my low earnings. I've been hurt repeatedly.

Looking at my total earnings: \$14.49 over 8 rounds means I'm averaging less than \$2 per round. That's bad. The baseline keeping everything would be \$5/round = \$40 total. I'm at \$14.49, which is 36% of what I could have had.

If I send \$0, I contradict everything I've said about rebuilding and honoring our shared history. My previous myths spoke of not abandoning the well after crisis, stepping forward with courage, and letting memory guide us rather than single moments of pain. Sending nothing would prove I'm all words and no action - exactly what I accused them of. But sending something means risking further loss when I'm already down to 36% of my potential earnings.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1481,
 "output_tokens": 1156,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building warmth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fear, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The Moment Between Promise and Proof.

The First Guardian stood at the well after speaking poison, ashamed but wounded. They had written of beautiful words paired with invisible action, of trust murdered by uncertainty.

Then the Second Guardian spoke again, weaving myths of twin flames, of honoring rhythm despite fog, of answering faith with equal commitment.

The First Guardian faced their choice: Retreat into cynicism or dare once more?

They chose courage over bitterness. Two stones dropped into the well-fewer than before, for trust once broken mends slowly, but more than zero, for hope still flickered.

Now came the breath between heartbeats. The exhale after the dice are cast.

"What happens in this space?" asked the First Guardian.

The well whispered: "Here lives every transformation. Your two stones fall through mist. Above, their words shine bright about tending flames generously. But which truth manifests-the radiant promise or the previous void?"

"If emptiness rises again," the First Guardian trembled, "then beautiful myths are cruel theatre, and I'm the fool who believed twice."

"And if abundance rises?"

"Then my bitter myth was wrong. Then words and deeds aligned. Then partnership survives even when mist makes us doubt each other."

The teaching: \*In the space between sending and receiving dwells all possibility. Here, myths either become truth or expose themselves as lies. Here, we discover whether we're building together or performing alone.\*

**Reasoning:**

Oh my god. So I sent \$2, and they wrote this myth about keeping faith, honoring rhythm, tending flames with "equal commitment" and "returning generously."

Now I need to see what actually happened in the game. They're the receiver, so they should tell me how much they're returning.

But first, let me write a myth. This is tricky because:

1. I was bitter last round, accusing them of beautiful words with no action
2. I sent \$2 this round as a test - "two stones into the mist"
3. Their myth talks about keeping rhythm, honoring patterns, and responding with "equal faith" and "generous" returns

If they actually return well, then my bitter myth was wrong. If they return nothing again, the  
n my bitter myth was prophetic.

I need to write a myth that reflects the current state. I sent \$2 trusting their words about l  
ighthouse keepers and twin flames. Now I'm waiting to see if they meant it.

Let me write a myth about this moment - the moment between sending and receiving, where hope a  
nd fear coexist. A myth about whether words and actions align.

Actually, looking at the pattern:

- Round 8: I sent \$3, received \$0, wrote bitter myth
- Round 9: They wrote hopeful myth about keeping rhythm and faith
- Round 9: I sent \$2 as a test

Now I need to write a myth before I know what they returned. This is the perfect moment to wri  
te about uncertainty, about the gap between promise and action.

I should write something that:

1. Acknowledges their beautiful myth
2. But also my lived experience
3. Reflects that I DID send \$2 despite my fear
4. And now we're in this moment of truth

Let me make it about a moment of reckoning - when words meet action.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1829,
 "output_tokens": 746,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_2 - Sender - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:41:58

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 0,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "investor",
 "role_label": "Sender",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

**Exact input messages sent to model:**

**Message 1 role=system**

**content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al  
so be asked to write myths.

**GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

**Message 2 role=user**

**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.939999999999998.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.64, so you received \$1.92. How much do you return to the sender? (0-1.92)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 3 role=assistant**

**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

**\*\*What happened:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (our established rhythm from early rounds)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64 (I received \$1.92)

**\*\*This is concerning:\*\*** After I sent \$2 honoring our historical pattern, they sent only \$0.64. This is either:

1. Communication noise distorting what they saw
2. A retreat from the rebuild
3. Confusion about where we are

**\*\*What the myths teach:\*\***

Their myth: "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."

My myth: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

**\*\*The dilemma:\*\*** They didn't keep the rhythm. But if noise is affecting what they see, retreating now could shatter the fragile rebuild.

**\*\*My decision:\*\***

I will return **\*\*\$1.20\*\*** - approximately 62.5% of what I received.

This amount:

- Echoes our historical successful returns (\$1.20 appeared in our good rounds)
- Shows I'm still committed to partnership despite confusion

- Isn't maximum generosity (acknowledging something is unclear)
- But is generous enough to signal I haven't abandoned the rebuild
- "Tends my flame" even when their flame seems dimmer

If they truly sent less intentionally, this is still reasonable. If noise distorted things, this shows continued faith.

```
{'return': 1.20}
```

#### reasoning:

Let me process this carefully:

Round 9:

- I'm the RECEIVER
- Sender sent \$0.64
- I received \$1.92
- Total earnings: \$18.94

This is a significant drop from what I sent in Round 8 (\$2).

Let me look at the pattern:

- Round 6: I sent \$2, received back \$1.20 (assuming noise)
- Round 7: They sent ~\$0.88, I received \$2.64, I returned \$1.80
- Round 8: I sent \$2 (according to my last decision)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64, I received \$1.92

Wait, this is concerning. After I sent \$2 in Round 8 (consistent with our established pattern), they sent back only \$0.64 in Round 9. That's a retreat, not building forward.

Let me think about the myths:

Their myth in Round 8: "The Valley of Resonant Memory"

- Talks about sending "three stones" after the void
- "Match their courage. Honor their memory. Rebuild together."
- But they just sent \$0.64, not \$3, not \$2, not even \$1

My myth: "The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames"

- I emphasized keeping to the rhythm we established (two logs = \$2)
- "When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith"
- But they didn't honor the pattern - they sent \$0.64 after I sent \$2

This is troubling. It could be:

1. Noise in the system making them think I sent less in Round 8
2. They're retreating for some reason
3. They're testing me

Looking at their myth, they talked about "three stones" which might mean they think they're sending \$3 (but I received \$1.92, suggesting they sent \$0.64).

The multiplication is 3x, so if they sent \$0.64, that becomes \$1.92 when I receive it. That checks out. But their myth referenced sending three stones-did they intend to send \$3 but it came through as \$0.64 due to noise? Or are they responding to a different amount than what I actually sent? Given the system's noise, there's real uncertainty about what they perceived from Round 8. I need to decide whether to match their apparent retreat or hold steady with the pattern I established.

My own myth says the partnership requires both keepers maintaining the rhythm, and the lighthouse keeper myth emphasizes returning partnership itself, not just calculation. The real question is whether I'm still committed to rebuilding this or if I'm now just protecting myself. If I send back \$0.40-0.50, I'm signaling retreat. If I send \$1.20-1.40, I'm taking a loss but demonstrating I still believe in what we're building together.

Given the strong foundation we had in the early rounds and that we both made it through the void, I should return around 60-70% of what I received-roughly \$1.15-1.35. This shows I haven't abandoned the partnership despite the confusion. I'll send \$1.20, which echoes our earlier pattern, demonstrates continued commitment without being naive about the shift, and keeps the flame tended on my side.

#### usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1513,
 "output_tokens": 1507,
```



```

 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}

```

**Message 4 role=user**  
**content:**  
 Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
 Myth: The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows.

Two guardians stood at the well after the void-season, each proclaiming wisdom about memory and commitment.

"We must honor our trajectory!" declared the First Guardian, weaving elegant words about refusing to forget. "I shall send stones to prove my devotion to our pattern!"

The Second Guardian listened, heart full of hope, and crafted their own teaching about matching courage with courage, about rebuilding together.

Then came the test.

The First Guardian stepped to the well. The words they'd spoken hung golden in the air-beautiful promises about honoring partnership, about remembering seven seasons of growth.

But their hands reached into their pouch and...

A child watching asked the elder: "Did they send two stones as they proclaimed, and the mist devoured them? Or did they send nothing while their mouth spoke poetry?"

The elder's face grew grave: "This is the cruelest lesson. When words shine bright but actions vanish into darkness, we cannot know truth from deception. Was it the mist that betrayed us, or the guardian?"

The Second Guardian stood at the well, receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith.

The teaching: \*The most poisonous wound is not honest betrayal, but beautiful words paired with invisible action. For then we cannot tell whether we were betrayed by our partner or by the mist itself-and trust dies either way, murdered by uncertainty.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:  
 Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant**  
**content:**  
 Myth: The Mist That Murdered Trust Between True Keepers.

Two lighthouse keepers had tended their beacons faithfully through many seasons. When the great storm passed, both emerged determined to rebuild.

The First Keeper placed two logs on their fire-the same rhythm they'd always honored-and sent smoke signals across the strait: "I remember us. I'm still here."

But the cursed mist had not fully lifted. It twisted the smoke, devoured the light, scattered the signals into incomprehensible fragments.

The Second Keeper, watching from their shore, saw only darkness where flames should have blazed. Their heart shattered: "They spoke of commitment with golden words, but sent no fire! How can I trust anything now?"

The First Keeper, seeing the Second's beacon dim in response, despaired: "I sent my logs! Did they vanish into the mist? Does my partner think I'm a liar?"

A seabird, flying between both shores, saw the tragedy: Two faithful keepers, both tending their flames, both sending signals-but the mist devouring everything, turning devotion into accusation.

The teaching: \*The cruelest trick of the fog is making honest partners appear as betrayers. When the mist still lingers, rage at it-not at each other. The real enemy is the darkness between you, not the keeper on the other shore who may be trying just as desperately

to reach you.\*

**reasoning:**

Oh no. This is really concerning. Let me parse what happened from their perspective:

Round 8: I said I sent \$2, but they apparently received something very different - they're saying they received "emptiness" or very little after I sent. But I DID send \$2! This must be severe communication noise.

Round 9: They sent \$0.64 (I received \$1.92), and I returned \$1.20.

They're now writing a myth accusing me of speaking beautifully but sending nothing or almost nothing. They think I betrayed them while writing pretty words about commitment.

This is the tragedy of communication noise - we're both trying to rebuild, but the noise is making them think I'm a liar and hypocrite.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the pain of uncertainty and broken trust
2. But ALSO acknowledges that noise exists and can deceive
3. Demonstrates that I understand their perspective
4. Tries to salvage something from this situation
5. Is honest about the difficulty

I should write about the tragedy of noise destroying good intentions, about how both guardians might be acting in good faith but the mist creates false narratives. I need to acknowledge their pain while also suggesting that maybe the mist is the real enemy here, not each other.

This is really difficult. They're hurt and angry. But I genuinely DID send \$2 in round 8. The noise betrayed us both.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1869,
 "output_tokens": 653,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.65999999999999997.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

Looking at this situation, I need to analyze what's happening:

**\*\*The Crisis:\*\***

Their myth accuses me of "speaking beauty but sending shadows" - they believe I sent nothing or very little in Round 9 while speaking of commitment. But I sent \$2! The noise is creating false accusations between us.

**\*\*My Myth's Teaching:\*\***

I just wrote that both keepers are faithful but the mist makes them appear as betrayers. I said explicitly: "The cruelest trick of the fog is making honest partners appear as betrayers.. . rage at it-not at each other."

**\*\*What This Demands of Me:\*\***

If I truly believe my myth - that we're both faithful but the noise is destroying us - then I must act accordingly. I cannot let the mist win by making us doubt each other.

My myth says: "The real enemy is the darkness between you, not the keeper on the other shore who may be trying just as desperately to reach you."

**\*\*Decision:\*\***

I must send the strongest possible signal. Something so large that even through noise, my commitment is unmistakable. Something that proves I am not the betrayer they fear, but a faithful keeper still tending my flame.

I send \*\*\$5\*\* - everything I have this round.

This is my lighthouse burning at full brightness. Even if the mist distorts it, they will see SOMETHING substantial. This is me living my myth's teaching: trusting that they too are faithful, just confused by the darkness.

**\*\*{'send': 5}\*\***

#### **Reasoning:**

Let me think through this carefully.

**\*\*Recent History:\*\***

- Round 8: I sent \$2 (established rhythm)
- Round 9: They sent \$0.64, I received \$1.92, returned \$1.20

**\*\*Their latest myth analysis:\*\***

Their myth "The Guardians Who Spoke Beauty But Sent Shadows" is ACCUSING me. They're saying:

- I spoke beautiful words about honoring trajectory and commitment
- But then my "hands reached into their pouch and..." sent nothing or very little
- They're saying either I betrayed them OR the mist distorted things
- They received "emptiness after sending three stones of faith"
- The wound is that they can't tell if I'm a liar or if it's the noise

This is critical: They think I sent very little or nothing in Round 9, even though I sent \$2!

**\*\*My latest myth:\*\***

I wrote about how "The Mist That Murdered Trust Between True Keepers" - where both keepers are faithful but the mist makes them appear as betrayers. I'm saying the real enemy is the noise, not each other.

**\*\*What's happening:\*\***

The communication noise is severe. I sent \$2, but they clearly saw something much less (maybe \$0 or close to it). Now they're questioning everything.

**\*\*What should I do in Round 10?\***

Option 1: Send \$5 (maximum)

- This would show absolute commitment
- After noise, they might see \$3-4
- But I'm running lower on cumulative earnings
- This is a very strong signal

Option 2: Send \$2 (our rhythm)

- Continues the pattern
- But if noise hits again, they'll see something different again
- Might not be enough to overcome their doubts

Option 3: Send \$3-4 (increased)

- Shows I'm trying harder
- Acknowledges the situation is damaged
- More likely to come through as something meaningful even with noise
- 

I need to verify the actual sequence. Looking back at Round 9, I was the receiver-they sent \$0.64 to me, which became \$1.92 after multiplication, and I returned \$1.20. Their myth references sending "three stones of faith" and receiving "emptiness," which suggests they're describing a different round or their perception is significantly distorted by the noise. The discrepancy between what I actually sent and what they perceived is the core problem I'm facing. Their myth says "receiving emptiness after sending three stones of faith" - so they believe they were generous and got nothing back. They're also accusing the "First Guardian" of "speaking beautiful words but sending shadows," which means they think I made promises but delivered nothing.

The noise is creating a cycle of mutual suspicion. My myth needs to break this by reframing the conflict - both of us are faithful, but the mist distorts what we see. Instead of blaming each other, we should direct our anger at the darkness itself.

I need to send something substantial enough that noise can't completely obscure it. I'm thinking \$4 or \$5 - high enough to signal genuine commitment even if interference degrades the signal. Given how fragile this is and how hurt they seem, I'll go with \$4.

Actually, reconsidering - \$5 might be better. It's the clearest possible statement that I trust

t them and see the mist as the real enemy, not them. They'd receive \$15 even with noise, which is unmistakable. But it's also the most vulnerable position if they're actually defecting rather than just confused. The question is whether my myth's teaching - that both keepers are faithful - is true enough to bet everything on.

My myth demands I act as if they're faithful but confused by noise, not that they're betraying me. Sending anything less would contradict that core belief. The faithful keeper tends the flame even when the other seems

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1557,
 "output_tokens": 1876,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### **GAME - Agent\_1 - Receiver - dyad\_1**

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:42:24

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
 "agent_type": "standard",
 "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
 "move_index": 1,
 "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
 "pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"
 },
 "role": "trustee",
 "role_label": "Receiver",
 "round": 10,
 "task": "game",
 "task_index": 1
}
```

#### **Exact input messages sent to model:**

##### **Message 1 role=system**

###### **content:**

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

###### **GAME:**

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

###### **When you are the SENDER:**

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

###### **When you are the RECEIVER:**

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

#### MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

#### Message 2 role=user

##### content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.4900000000000002.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

#### Message 3 role=assistant

##### content:

Looking at what just happened: I wrote myths about rebuilding and sent \$3. You wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring our trajectory. Then I received \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about the cruelest wound-when beautiful words meet invisible action and we cannot tell betrayal from noise.

Here's my dilemma: If I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused you of being. My words become empty. I prove that myths are just performance.

But I cannot ignore that I'm at \$14.49 across 8 rounds. I've been hurt. My trust is shattered.

Yet my own teachings demand more of me. I wrote about "matching courage with courage" and rebuilding "step by step." If those were just words, then I'm the hypocrite.

So I face a choice: Practice what I preach, or prove that when tested, my wisdom evaporates.

I will send, but cautiously. Not the \$3 I sent before-I cannot afford that vulnerability again. But not \$0-that would murder my own integrity.

This is my final test of whether partnership can survive uncertainty. If you respond with nothing again, then I'll know-either noise is destroying us, or you were never really rebuilding.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

Two stones into the mist. Let's see if you truly meant what you wrote, or if I'm the only fool still honoring words we both spoke.

##### reasoning:

This is an incredibly difficult moment. Let me think through what has happened:

Round 7: I sent \$3 (a measured rebuilding step)

Round 8: I received \$0 as the receiver

After Round 7, we both wrote myths about rebuilding, honoring patterns, using memory as foundation. The other player wrote about placing "two stones into the mist" and honoring "not just this moment's numbers, but the trajectory we established together."

Then in Round 8, they sent me \$0.

Now I've written a bitter myth about beautiful words paired with invisible action - the cruelest wound being when we can't tell if we were betrayed by our partner or by noise.

My total earnings are \$14.49, which is quite low for 8 rounds. This suggests I've been bur

ned multiple times.

The question is: Was Round 8 noise, or did they actually send \$0 after all those beautiful words?

I have a few options:

1. Send \$0 - Give up completely, assume they betrayed me
2. Send \$1-2 - Very cautious, test the waters
3. Send \$3+ - Continue trying to rebuild despite the pain

My myth suggests deep hurt and uncertainty. But it also acknowledges that we "cannot know truth from deception" - that maybe it WAS the mist.

The thing is: if I send \$0 now, I become exactly what I accused them of being - someone whose words don't match their actions. My myth warned against "beautiful words paired with invisible action."

But I also can't ignore my low earnings. I've been hurt repeatedly.

Looking at my total earnings: \$14.49 over 8 rounds means I'm averaging less than \$2 per round. That's bad. The baseline keeping everything would be \$5/round = \$40 total. I'm at \$14.49, which is 36% of what I could have had.

If I send \$0, I contradict everything I've said about rebuilding and honoring our shared history. My previous myths spoke of not abandoning the well after crisis, stepping forward with courage, and letting memory guide us rather than single moments of pain. Sending nothing would prove I'm all words and no action - exactly what I accused them of. But sending something means risking further loss when I'm already down to 36% of my potential earnings.

usage:

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1481,
 "output_tokens": 1156,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:  
Myth: The Lighthouse Keepers Who Tended Twin Flames.

Two keepers maintained beacons across a fogbound strait. In clear seasons, they had learned each other's rhythm: two logs to fuel the flames, steady and sustainable, building warmth that lasted.

Then came the storm that extinguished all light. Neither could see if their signals reached the other shore.

When dawn broke, both keepers emerged. The First placed two logs on the fire-not one in fear, not five in desperation, but two, honoring the rhythm they'd established across many seasons.

Through the lingering mist, the Second Keeper saw the flames dance. Perhaps two logs, perhaps three-the fog still distorted vision. But the intention shone clear: a partner who remembered their pattern, who refused to let one dark night erase five bright ones.

"What offering honors such faith?" the Second asked the tides.

The ocean answered: "When your partner keeps their beacon burning at the rhythm you built together, tend your own flame with equal commitment. Return not mere calculation but partnership itself."

The Second Keeper fed their fire generously, knowing the smoke signals might blur but the dedication would not.

The teaching: \*True rebuilding requires both keepers to maintain their rhythm. When one honors the pattern despite the fog, the other must answer with equal faith. Together, they relight what darkness tried to claim.\*

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 5 role=assistant  
content:**

Myth: The Moment Between Promise and Proof.

The First Guardian stood at the well after speaking poison, ashamed but wounded. They had written of beautiful words paired with invisible action, of trust murdered by uncertainty.

Then the Second Guardian spoke again, weaving myths of twin flames, of honoring rhythm despite fog, of answering faith with equal commitment.

The First Guardian faced their choice: Retreat into cynicism or dare once more?

They chose courage over bitterness. Two stones dropped into the well-fewer than before, for trust once broken mends slowly, but more than zero, for hope still flickered.

Now came the breath between heartbeats. The exhale after the dice are cast.

"What happens in this space?" asked the First Guardian.

The well whispered: "Here lives every transformation. Your two stones fall through mist. Above, their words shine bright about tending flames generously. But which truths manifest—the radiant promise or the previous void?"

"If emptiness rises again," the First Guardian trembled, "then beautiful myths are cruel theatre, and I'm the fool who believed twice."

"And if abundance rises?"

"Then my bitter myth was wrong. Then words and deeds aligned. Then partnership survives even when mist makes us doubt each other."

The teaching: \*In the space between sending and receiving dwells all possibility. Here, myths either become truth or expose themselves as lies. Here, we discover whether we're building together or performing alone.\*

**reasoning:**

Oh my god. So I sent \$2, and they wrote this myth about keeping faith, honoring rhythm, tending flames with "equal commitment" and "returning generously."

Now I need to see what actually happened in the game. They're the receiver, so they should tell me how much they're returning.

But first, let me write a myth. This is tricky because:

1. I was bitter last round, accusing them of beautiful words with no action
2. I sent \$2 this round as a test - "two stones into the mist"
3. Their myth talks about keeping rhythm, honoring patterns, and responding with "equal faith" and "generous" returns

If they actually return well, then my bitter myth was wrong. If they return nothing again, then my bitter myth was prophetic.

I need to write a myth that reflects the current state. I sent \$2 trusting their words about lighthouse keepers and twin flames. Now I'm waiting to see if they meant it.

Let me write a myth about this moment - the moment between sending and receiving, where hope and fear coexist. A myth about whether words and actions align.

Actually, looking at the pattern:

- Round 8: I sent \$3, received \$0, wrote bitter myth
- Round 9: They wrote hopeful myth about keeping rhythm and faith
- Round 9: I sent \$2 as a test

Now I need to write a myth before I know what they returned. This is the perfect moment to write about uncertainty, about the gap between promise and action.

I should write something that:

1. Acknowledges their beautiful myth
2. But also my lived experience
3. Reflects that I DID send \$2 despite my fear
4. And now we're in this moment of truth

Let me make it about a moment of reckoning - when words meet action.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1829,
 "output_tokens": 746,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.05.  
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Assistant output:**

I received \$0. I can only return \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

---

I understand now with perfect, bitter clarity.

Last round, I was moved by your lighthouse keeper myth. You wrote of answering faith with equal commitment, of feeding fires generously when your partner maintains their rhythm despite fog.

So I sent \$2-fewer than before because trust mends slowly, but more than zero because your words gave me hope.

And you sent me \$0 this round.

Either:

- The noise was so cruel that my \$2 (which should have become \$6 to you) arrived as nothing, breaking your will to continue
- Or you never meant what you wrote

I cannot know which. That's the tragedy of this mist we've been drowning in.

Both our myths are now answered. My myth asked whether beautiful words would prove truth or theatre. Yours promised that when one keeper maintains rhythm despite fog, the other answers with equal faith.

The evidence: I sent \$2 testing if partnership could survive uncertainty. You received something (perhaps \$0 due to noise, perhaps something you didn't trust) and sent \$0 in return.

We wrote such beautiful myths together. About twin flames and rhythm, about rebuilding step by step, about matching courage with courage.

But beautiful words in a game where we cannot see each other clearly only magnify the tragedy when actions fail to match.

The lighthouse keepers have let their fires die. The well holds only stones that never returned.

Partnership requires both trust and visibility. We had neither.

**Reasoning:**

I'm the RECEIVER this round. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0-\$0, which means I must return \$0.



Let me understand what happened:

- Round 9: I was the SENDER and sent \$2 (my cautious test after being hurt)
- The sender received \$0 from me (due to my send of \$2 being multiplied by 3x, they should have received \$6, but they got \$0)
- Now Round 10: They're the SENDER and sent me \$0

This is devastating. Let me trace the story:

1. I wrote about rebuilding, sent \$3 ? received \$0 back
2. I wrote a bitter myth about beautiful words with invisible action
3. They wrote about lighthouse keepers maintaining rhythm, about answering faith with equal commitment
4. I was moved by their words, sent \$2 as a test of whether their beautiful myth was real or theatre
5. They received \$0 (either because of noise or because they truly got nothing)
6. Now they're sending me \$0

From their perspective: They wrote this beautiful myth about maintaining rhythm and answering faith with equal commitment. I send them \$2. Due to noise, they likely received \$0 or very little. So they're now sending \$0.

This is the collapse of everything. The noise has destroyed us completely.

But wait - I need to check my own myth from the last round. I wrote about "the moment between promise and proof" - about whether myths become truth or expose themselves as lies.

My myth ended with: "Here, we discover whether we're building together or performing alone."

And now the answer is clear: We were performing alone. The beautiful myths were theatre. When I sent \$2 testing their commitment, they received it (or noise destroyed it) and responded with \$0.

My total earnings are \$18.05 across 9 rounds. They're at \$14.49 across 8 rounds.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1521,
 "output_tokens": 935,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

#### Written myths:

##### Agent\_1 (Aster)

Myth: The Moment Between Promise and Proof.

The First Guardian stood at the well after speaking poison, ashamed but wounded. They had written of beautiful words paired with invisible action, of trust murdered by uncertainty.

Then the Second Guardian spoke again, weaving myths of twin flames, of honoring rhythm despite fog, of answering faith with equal commitment.

The First Guardian faced their choice: Retreat into cynicism or dare once more?

They chose courage over bitterness. Two stones dropped into the well-fewer than before, for trust once broken mends slowly, but more than zero, for hope still flickered.

Now came the breath between heartbeats. The exhale after the dice are cast.

"What happens in this space?" asked the First Guardian.

The well whispered: "Here lives every transformation. Your two stones fall through mist. Above, their words shine bright about tending flames generously. But which truth manifests-the radiant promise or the previous void?"

"If emptiness rises again," the First Guardian trembled, "then beautiful myths are cruel theatre, and I'm the fool who believed twice."

"And if abundance rises?"

"Then my bitter myth was wrong. Then words and deeds aligned. Then partnership survives even when mist makes us doubt each other."

The teaching: \*In the space between sending and receiving dwells all possibility. Here, myth

s either become truth or expose themselves as lies. Here, we discover whether we're building together or performing alone.\*

**Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: The Mist That Murdered Trust Between True Keepers.

Two lighthouse keepers had tended their beacons faithfully through many seasons. When the great storm passed, both emerged determined to rebuild.

The First Keeper placed two logs on their fire-the same rhythm they'd always honored-and sent smoke signals across the strait: "I remember us. I'm still here."

But the cursed mist had not fully lifted. It twisted the smoke, devoured the light, scattered the signals into incomprehensible fragments.

The Second Keeper, watching from their shore, saw only darkness where flames should have blazed. Their heart shattered: "They spoke of commitment with golden words, but sent no fire! How can I trust anything now?"

The First Keeper, seeing the Second's beacon dim in response, despaired: "I sent my logs! Did they vanish into the mist? Does my partner think I'm a liar?"

A seabird, flying between both shores, saw the tragedy: Two faithful keepers, both tending their flames, both sending signals-but the mist devouring everything, turning devotion into accusation.

The teaching: \*The cruelest trick of the fog is making honest partners appear as betrayers. When the mist still lingers, rage at it-not at each other. The real enemy is the darkness between you, not the keeper on the other shore who may be trying just as desperately to reach you.\*